The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called The Questions of Gaganagañja

Āryagaganagañjaparipṛcchānāmamahāyānasūtra · Toh 148 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་ནམ་མཁའ་མཛོད་ཀྱིས་ཞུས་པ་ཞེས་བྱ་བཐེག་པ་ཆེན་པོའི་མདོ

The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called The Questions of Gaganagañja, known in Sanskrit as the Āryagaganagañjaparipṛcchā and in Tibetan as Phakpa Namkha Dzö Kyi Zhüpa, is a Mahāyāna sūtra in which the bodhisattva Gaganagañja questions the Buddha in a vast jeweled assembly about the conduct, qualities and wisdom of bodhisattvas. In the course of the discourse the Buddha praises above all the upholding of the true Dharma, summons the Four Great Kings, Śakra and Brahmā with dhāraṇīs to protect the teaching, and entrusts it to Maitreya, Mahākāśyapa and Ānanda for the future. The text presents itself as a chapter of the Great Assembly, the Mahāsaṃnipāta collection of sūtras. It is Toh 148 in the Kangyur, where it is placed in the General Sūtra section, and it was translated into Tibetan by the Indian preceptors Vijayaśīla and Śīlendrabodhi together with the Tibetan translator Yeshé Dé.

In the language of India: ārya gagana gañja paripṛccha nāma mahāyāna sūtra. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called "The Questions of Gaganagañja." Fascicle one.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One (the Buddha) was dwelling in the courtyard of the assembly, a jeweled array that is the domain of the tathāgatas. It was the abode of the tathāgatas, gathered together by the adornment of great merit, the concordant outcome of great conduct, brought into being through the maturation of all the qualities of a buddha. It revealed the boundless abodes of the bodhisattva great beings; it was blessed by the emanations of the tathāgatas; it gave entry to the wisdom whose domain is free of attachment. It gave rise to vast joy, gave entry to mindfulness, intelligence and realization, and was wholly beyond reproach. It was discerned by wisdom, gave entry to what is not of its own nature, was extolled through eons reaching to the furthest limit of the future, and was immeasurable in its whole assemblage of good qualities.

The Blessed One had fully and perfectly awakened to the sameness of all phenomena. He had turned the wheel of Dharma. He had an endless assembly

of thoroughly disciplined disciples. He had gained mastery over all phenomena. He knew perfectly the workings of the intentions of all sentient beings. He had gone to the far shore of the supreme faculties. He was skilled in completely destroying the rebirth-linking brought about by the habitual tendencies of the afflictions of all sentient beings, and his spontaneously accomplished buddha activity was never interrupted.

He was together with a great Saṅgha of six million monks. All of them had minds like well-trained thoroughbreds; their minds were thoroughly liberated by perfect knowledge; they were diligent in completely destroying the rebirth-linking brought about by the habitual tendencies of all afflictions. Every one of them was a child of the Tathāgata, the king of Dharma, skilled in abiding in the profound Dharma, having emerged through the Dharma that has no object of reference, perfect in graceful conduct, a great field for generosity, and wholly committed to the word of the Tathāgata.

He was also together with a great assembly of bodhisattvas, bodhisattva great beings gathered from various buddha fields, countless, innumerable, inconceivable, incomparable, immeasurable, limitless, and inexpressibly inexpressible in number. All of them were skilled in going to boundless buddha fields in a single instant of mind; skilled in making offerings to and serving all the tathāgatas; insatiable in seeking to hear the Dharma; ever and unceasingly diligent in bringing all sentient beings to maturity; gone to the supreme perfection of skillful means and wisdom; firmly established in unobstructed liberation; wholly beyond all thought, conceptuality and elaboration; and every one of them had drawn close to the wisdom of omniscience. Among them were the bodhisattva called Lightning God, the bodhisattva called Victorious in Battle, the bodhisattva called Vairocanagarbha, the bodhisattva called Valiant Subduer, the bodhisattva called Vimatisamudghātin, the bodhisattva called Far-Proclaimed, the bodhisattva called Eye of Clear Seeing, and the bodhisattva called Free of Darkness. He was together with these and other bodhisattva great beings, countless, limitless, innumerable, inconceivable, incomparable, immeasurable, beyond reckoning, and inexpressibly inexpressible in number.

Then the Blessed One was teaching the bodhisattva great beings the Dharma discourse called "The Chapter of the Great Assembly." As this Dharma discourse, the Chapter of the Great Assembly, was being taught, everyone in that entire assembly, seated in the middle of the sky, thought, "I am sitting inside a palace of great splendor." The very arrangement of those palaces

appeared before the eyes of beings. Apart from the bodhisattva great beings seated in the palaces, the great śrāvakas, and also all those retinues of gods, nāgas, yakṣas and gandharvas, all the remaining visible forms in the great trichiliocosm, the world system of a billion worlds, vanished, and they perceived everything as having become like space. It was just as when the world is utterly consumed by the fire at the end of an eon and has become like space, so that no visible form in the great trichiliocosm appears before the eye; in the same way, at that time whatever had appeared as visible form did not appear before the eyes of beings.

It was like this: just as in the world system called Great Array, the realm of the Tathāgata Ratnavyūha, the bodhisattvas there enjoy palaces, so palaces like those appeared here. Apart from those palaces set in the sky, they perceived that everything in this great trichiliocosm, from the surface of the earth down to its foundation, had ceased to appear. Sumeru, king of mountains, the Cakravāla ring of mountains and the great Cakravāla ring of mountains did not appear before the eyes of any being. Villages, cities, towns, districts, provinces and royal palaces did not appear either; rather, they perceived only those palaces standing in the middle of the sky. The lion throne of the Blessed One appeared, rising ten thousand leagues high. The light of that lion throne on which the Blessed One sat filled the great trichiliocosm with a great radiance, and all the lights of the sun, the moon, the stars, Śakra (Indra), Brahmā and the world protectors of that great trichiliocosm were dimmed.

Then all those assemblies of bodhisattvas, seeing such a wondrous and marvelous miracle, said to one another, "Even if our lifespans were to last an eon, it would not be easy for us to explain in full detail how these palaces are arrayed, so immeasurable is the array of good qualities of these palaces."

Then, through the power of the Blessed One, the elder Śāriputra rose from that palace and stood in the sky. He placed his right knee on the ground, bowed with palms joined toward the Blessed One, and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, apart from these palaces that are in the sky, the whole of the rest of the great trichiliocosm has become space and has the nature of space. Whose portent is this?"

The Blessed One said, "Śāriputra, do you see these palaces?"

He replied, "Blessed One, I see them."

The Blessed One said, "Śāriputra, are you able to know the end of a full recital of the praises of these palaces?"

He replied, "Blessed One, even if my lifespan were to last an eon, I would not be able to reach the end of the praises of these palaces."

He said, "Śāriputra, just as this whole assembly appears to have gone into the sky and entered palaces of great splendor, so too are the palaces of the world system Great Array."

He asked, "Blessed One, in which direction does that world system Great Array lie?"

The Blessed One said, "Śāriputra, eastward from here, beyond as many buddha fields as there are atoms in eight buddha fields filled with atoms, in the world system called Great Array, the Tathāgata called Ratnavyūha, the One Jewel Array, is presently dwelling, living and abiding, and he is teaching the Dharma. Śāriputra, in that world system Great Array no jewel arises other than the jewel of the awakening mind. That is why that tathāgata is called Ratnavyūha, the One Jewel Array.

"Whenever that tathāgata teaches the Dharma to those bodhisattvas, he rises together with his lion throne into the middle of the sky, to the height of eight hundred million palm trees. Those bodhisattvas too rise into the middle of the sky in that great array of palaces and listen to the Dharma from that tathāgata, and that tathāgata fully teaches the Dharma seal called the Completely Pure Sphere of Space. Śāriputra, the enjoyment that those bodhisattvas have of the palaces in that world system Great Array could not be described even in an eon.

"Śāriputra, do you see this lion throne of mine?"

He replied, "Blessed One, I see it."

The Blessed One said, "Śāriputra, the lion throne of that Blessed One, the Tathāgata Ratnavyūha, is like this. Seated upon it, that Blessed One fully teaches those bodhisattvas the Dharma seal of the Completely Pure Sphere of Space, which enters into thirty-two aspects. And what is that Dharma seal of the Completely Pure Sphere of Space, which enters into thirty-two aspects? It is this:

"Because they are without entity, all phenomena are free of existence and nonexistence. Because they are characterized as mere cognizance, all phenomena are without entity. Because nothing appears, all phenomena are without cognizance. Because there is neither cause nor object of reference, all phenomena have nothing appearing. Because they are characterized by

peace, all phenomena are without object of reference. Because they are nondual, all phenomena are at peace. Because they are not separate and distinct, all phenomena are nondual. Because they have entered a single way, all phenomena are without distinction. Because they are free of the characteristic of an essential nature, all phenomena are of a single way. Because they wholly transcend the three times, all phenomena are without essential nature. Because they abide in nothing whatever, all phenomena are the sphere of space. Because they appear nowhere at all, all phenomena are the gateway of non-abiding. Because they wholly transcend the pathway of objects, all phenomena are without appearance. Because inner and outer are pure, all phenomena are without objects. Because by nature they are not thoroughly afflicted, all phenomena are pure. Because in their essential nature they are at peace, all phenomena are by nature completely pure. Because there is no mind, no mentation and no consciousness, all phenomena are at peace. Because they have never arisen from the very beginning, all phenomena are without characteristics. Because there is nothing that is mine and no grasping, all phenomena have never arisen from the very beginning. Because there is no owner, all phenomena are without anything that is mine and without grasping. Because they are by nature selfless, all phenomena are without owner. Because they are pure from the very beginning, all phenomena are by nature selfless. Because there is no turning back, all phenomena are pure from the very beginning. Because by nature they have the characteristic of an illusion, all phenomena are without turning back. Because they are without entity, all phenomena are like illusions. Because they are characterized by non-formation, all phenomena are without entity. Because mind and body are secluded, all phenomena are unformed. Because there is no characteristic and no characteristic of a basis of characteristics, all phenomena are characterized by seclusion. Because they do not stir from their own characteristic, all phenomena are without characteristics. Because no location can be apprehended, all phenomena are unstirring. Because they are firmly established at the limit of non-apprehension, all phenomena are without location. Because there is no foundation, all phenomena are without object of reference. Because they are free of any foundation, all phenomena are without foundation.

"Śāriputra, in this way the Tathāgata Ratnavyūha fully teaches those bodhisattvas the Dharma seal of the Completely Pure Sphere of Space, which enters into thirty-two aspects. And simply by hearing it, immeasurable

bodhisattvas, through the purity of their higher knowledges, attain the acceptance regarding consciousness that holds mastery over all phenomena."

"Moreover, Śāriputra, the bodhisattvas of that world system Great Array are all, without exception, adorned with generosity, following the path of giving away for countless eons; adorned with moral discipline, their minds thoroughly purified; adorned with patience, possessing a mind without malice toward any sentient being; adorned with diligence, having gathered the accumulations of all the qualities of a buddha; adorned with meditative concentration, sporting in all the meditative concentrations, liberations, meditative absorptions, meditative attainments, and higher knowledges; adorned with wisdom, free of all the afflictions that bring rebirth through habitual tendencies; adorned with great loving-kindness, abiding in the complete protection of all sentient beings; adorned with great compassion, abiding without ever abandoning any sentient being; adorned with great joy, never ceasing to establish all sentient beings in joy, happiness, and delight; and adorned with great equanimity, applying themselves without ceasing to establishing all sentient beings in a state that is neither high nor low.

"Moreover, Śāriputra, in the buddha field of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Ratnavyūha, the One Jewel Array, there dwells a bodhisattva great being called Gaganagañja. He is supremely majestic with the splendor of merit, and his vision of wisdom is unobstructed. His body is adorned with the major marks, and his loveliness is adorned with the excellent minor marks. His speech is adorned with eloquence, his mind with dhāraṇīs, his mindfulness with learning, his truthfulness with certainty, his understanding of meaning with realization, his commitments with resolve, and his superior intention with ever greater progress. He is adorned with application, having become free of doubt regarding all phenomena; adorned with great equanimity, being without high or low; adorned with great higher knowledge, directly knowing every play of miraculous power; adorned with merit, being accomplished through giving away the jewels in his hand; adorned with wisdom, having entered into the thoughts and intentions of all sentient beings; adorned with intelligence, bringing about the understanding of the roots of virtue of all sentient beings; adorned with eyes, being thoroughly purified in the domain of the five eyes; adorned with ears, possessing the essence that understands all sounds and meanings; adorned with the analytical knowledges, teaching inexhaustibly the analytical knowledges of meaning, of Dharma, of etymology, and of eloquence; adorned with the powers, having attained the ten powers of a

tathāgata; adorned with fearlessness, unable to be overwhelmed by any opponent; adorned with qualities, having attained the infinite qualities of a buddha; adorned with the Dharma, proclaiming the Dharma from every pore of his body and following the analytical knowledges; adorned with illumination, having attained all the qualities of a buddha as if in the palm of his hand; adorned with light, illuminating all buddha fields; adorned with comprehensive teaching, giving explanations to whomever he meets; adorned with advice and instruction, having perfected the qualities that accomplish them; adorned with miraculous displays of power, showing all the liberations through purified miraculous power; adorned with the praise of all the buddhas, abiding in a wisdom that does not depend on others; and adorned with the qualities of every accumulation, having entered into the Dharma and Vinaya of all the buddhas.

"Śāriputra, this all-pervading display of such an array is the blessing of the bodhisattva Gaganagañja. Śāriputra, that bodhisattva great being Gaganagañja is coming into my presence in order to see me, to pay homage to me, and to attend upon me; to fully uphold this Dharma discourse, The Chapter of the Great Assembly; to bring forth the joy, happiness, and supreme delight of the Dharma in these bodhisattvas gathered from the world systems of the ten directions; to fully uphold this Great Vehicle; and to uphold as well the factors of awakening of all bodhisattvas."

Then the bodhisattva great being Gaganagañja took leave of the Tathāgata Ratnavyūha, the One Jewel Array, and, surrounded by and leading twelve koṭis of bodhisattvas, through a play of the buddhas, a miraculous power that manifests all at once without deliberate effort, and through the bases of miraculous power, he vanished from that world system Great Array. In no more than a single instant of mind he arrived in this Sahā world system and stayed in the sky above it. There he sent down a great rain of flowers, garlands, powders, incense, ointments, parasols, victory banners, and pennants just like those of the world system Great Array. These were flowers of the following kinds: moon, great moon, exquisitely beautiful moon, sunlight, blazing sun, sunstone, beautiful hue, great beautiful hue, abiding in beautiful hue, sthala, great sthala, most beautiful sthala, stainless, utterly stainless, pure light, golden glow, sky light, soft to the touch, great white fragrance, hundred-petaled, thousand-stamened, sorrow-dispelling, joy-giving, praised by the gods, nāga flower, bringer of all joy and happiness, limb of meditative concentration, delightful in fragrance, satisfier of body and mind, fragrance of

the trichiliocosm, pacifier of all illness, and dispeller of all illness. Adorned with his own splendor, produced by immeasurable merit, and known to the bodhisattvas of the ten directions, such flowers covered this great trichiliocosm world system entirely, so that throughout the whole circle of the Blessed One's assembly the flowers lay knee-deep.

Then that entire assembly, seeing those flowers, which they had never before heard of or seen, said to the Blessed One,

"Blessed One, where have these flowers come from, so lovely to behold?"

The Blessed One said, "The holy being, the bodhisattva great being Gaganagañja, has come here from that world system Great Array, and, remaining in the midst of the sky, he has sent down this rain of flowers."

Then the bodhisattva great being Gaganagañja, together with those twelve koṭis of bodhisattvas, descended from the midst of the sky, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated him three times, and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Ratnavyūha, the One Jewel Array, asks after the Blessed One's health: 'Is the Blessed One free of ailment? Free of discomfort? Is he light in his movements? Does he abide in strength and at ease?' And he also says this: 'These twelve koṭis of bodhisattvas, led by the bodhisattva great being Gaganagañja, wish to hear the Dharma discourse The Chapter of the Great Assembly. May the Blessed One please them with a Dharma conversation through which they will gain mastery over all phenomena and, endowed with the great Dharma, return.'"

Then the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, by his blessing, created a jeweled parasol about ten thousand yojanas in size in the sky above the Blessed One's lion throne. He joined his palms, bowed to the Blessed One, and praised him with these verses:

"Because you are exalted in Dharma, in meaning, in qualities, and in wisdom,
Completely pure, utterly pure, pure from the beginning, and stainless,
You have attained the unmoving, without location, like space:
To you, most profound, beyond every domain of experience, I bow.

Victor, though your body is the same, made manifest as the Dharma body,
You also display a body of lovely form and excellent shape.
Having brought forth compassion to benefit sentient beings,
You show the supreme body with the marks born of a hundred merits.

You do not speak; you are without concepts, without sound and without words.
The nature of words has the character of an echo and cannot be grasped.
Though you know there is no sound, no permanence, and no letters,
Kind One, being compassionate, you still speak the words of a Victor.

You know the minds and mental factors of all sentient beings;
You know the nature of mind to have the character of illusion.
Though you fully know the nature of every mindstream, whatever it may be,
Your own mind does not dwell on minds and mentation.

You show all your conduct to beings,
Yet the body of the Sugata never changes in the least.
Just as each one's form, mind, and qualities may be,
You display your marks and deportment in that very manner.

Sugata, you hold nothing in this Dharma as 'mine';
You neither abide in phenomena nor grasp them.
Knowing that many beings are tamed by teachings that use concepts,
You always teach the unsurpassed Dharma.

When this whole assembly gazes upon the Victor's body,
They see diverse forms and signs, never the same through the eons;
Yet your body is unchanging, beyond concepts, and without signs,
And you satisfy the assembly according to their minds and wishes.

All these phenomena arise from causes and conditions;
Without agent and without essential nature, they arise from conceptual imagination.
Sugata, having known such ways of phenomena,
You attained awakening, unchanging, peaceful, and unsurpassed.

Cutting off the extremes, and the middle as well, without conceptual thought,
Empty, hollow, hollow by nature, and insubstantial:
Having known such a pure nature of reality,
You teach beings cause, action, and agent.

In these phenomena there is no sentient being, no life force, and no person;
Because they are the same as space, even their names are pure.
Approaching sentient beings, perfectly free of self,
You awaken many beings to the deathless and unconditioned.

To seek this awakening through the might and power of diligence,
You practiced for a hundred koṭis of inconceivable eons.

Awakening has the character of earnest effort without accomplishing;
That is why the aim of the practice is attained.

Because you know the equality of phenomena in meditative equipoise,
You also know the superior, the middling, and the inferior as equal.
Ever abiding equally in equality, you do not conceptualize;
Therefore the Victor rests in equipoise and does not change.

Aggregates, elements, and sense faculties are just like illusions;
The three worlds are like the moon in water, without transference.
Sentient beings are like a dream, without substance;
Knowing this, realizing them to be like a dream, you speak this Dharma.

You attained supreme awakening, whose nature is mere convention;
It cannot be called attained or not attained.
Just as with awakening, so with the wheel:
You turned it free of the signs of entering the proper and the improper.

Having crossed over, you ferry across many, inconceivable beings;
Having been freed, you fully free those who remain in bondage.
Consoling beings in this unsurpassed Great Vehicle,
You establish them in nirvāṇa, having attained the equality of deliverance.

Yet nowhere has any sentient being ever passed into nirvāṇa;
Beings are pure from the beginning, and being itself is not established.
Having awakened to beings as bearing the mark of illusion,
You bring many beings to realize the limits of this.

Just as forms never appear in space,
So the forms of all beings are alike in being form.
Those phenomena have the character of form, of the formless, and of what is not form;
One who in this way realizes all things to be truly void...

However many praises of the Victor have been offered as examples,
All of them are seen to be contained in this praise.
Praising the Guide by his own qualities is like space;
That nondual praise is the praise of the Victor.

Buddha, you who awaken beings and are without objectification,
Who have attained mind itself, which is without mind: to you I bow.
Just as all the guides praise the lion among humans,

So, for the sake of suchness, I praise your true qualities.

All sentient beings are equal in the wisdom whose character is selflessness;
Realizing all, I shall come to know the dharmadhātu.
One who knows all phenomena as free of attachment, the way of the marks,
Will honor the Guide through equality."

As soon as the bodhisattva great being Gaganagañja had spoken these verses, that great arrayed palace standing in the sky shook in six ways.

And from the sky, too, a voice arose, saying: "The unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening that the buddhas, the blessed ones, accomplished over hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of countless eons has been fully expressed by the bodhisattva great being Gaganagañja in the melody of verse. Those bodhisattvas will not, even in their dreams, give rise to views that objectify through clinging. Those who hear this Dharma teaching in verse and have faith in it, and whoever hears it and puts it into practice, just as the bodhisattva Gaganagañja now roars the lion's roar, they too will roar the lion's roar."

Then the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, having spoken these verses, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, I too, having heard the name of this Dharma discourse, The Chapter of the Great Assembly, have come here to this Sahā world system in order to see the Blessed One, to pay homage to him, and to attend upon him, and to bring out some small light of Dharma regarding this Dharma discourse. Blessed One, it would be excellent if these holy beings were to ask the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, for a definitive teaching on whatever doubts each of them has about their own Dharma in this Dharma discourse, and if the Tathāgata, firmly abiding in certain understanding, were to dispel all their doubts completely and illuminate all the qualities of a buddha.

"Blessed One, if the Tathāgata gives me leave, I would ask for a short Dharma conversation that enters into the ascertainment of phenomena. Why is that? Because the Blessed One possesses unattached wisdom; he knows the superior and inferior faculties of all sentient beings and is skilled in wisdom. The Blessed One has attained illumination and is free of all darkness. The Blessed One knows meaning and is skilled in the wisdom that fully distinguishes all words. The Blessed One knows the right time; he never lets the moment pass and gives explanations to whomever he meets. The Blessed

One knows the right measure and teaches the Dharma to every sentient being as befits each one. The Blessed One is full of play and is skilled in the wisdom that fully ascertains the higher knowledges and the bases of miraculous power. The Blessed One possesses an intelligence of perfect discernment and shows the mental conduct of all sentient beings as if placing it in the palm of his hand. The Blessed One is exalted, and the crown of his head cannot be seen. The Blessed One is unvanquished, the sole hero in the great trichiliocosm world system. The Blessed One is self-arisen; without a teacher he has by himself fully awakened to all phenomena. The Blessed One is the Guide, who shows the true path to those without a guide and to those who have entered a bad path. The Blessed One is the king of physicians, who establishes those who dwell in a world obscured by desire, by afflictions, by obscurations, by heavy obscurations, and by the obscuration of active afflictions, all without beginning or end, on the path to the state without sickness and without death. The Blessed One wields power and might; he is skilled in knowing what is possible and what is impossible, and he has attained the threefold knowledge. The Blessed One has attained the great fearlessnesses; his defilements are exhausted, he has fully awakened to equality, he is skilled in knowing the absence of affliction and purification, and he roars the bull's lion's roar before the world with its gods. The Blessed One possesses the unshared qualities of a buddha, with wisdom unobstructed in the three times. The Blessed One is completely pure in body, speech, and mind, without confusion or clamor, and sees the wisdom of all the meditative attainments and liberations. The Blessed One abides in great loving-kindness, possesses an intelligence free of malice, is even-minded toward all sentient beings, and possesses eyes that see with light rays equal to space. The Blessed One abides in great compassion; he is not moved by good deeds or evil deeds, by happiness or suffering, and possesses an intelligence that engages equally with all sentient beings. The Blessed One is equal to all the buddhas and has entered the nondual wisdom of equality. The Blessed One is without distinctions; he is utterly pure like space and applies himself equally to all sentient beings. The Blessed One is without desire, satisfied by wisdom, and free of gain, honor, and fame. The Blessed One is omniscient and all-seeing, completely pure in the manner of the five eyes.

"Blessed One, knowing that the Tathāgata is thus endowed with immeasurable qualities, Dharma, and wisdom, I wish to ask about the doors to expounding the Dharma. With respect, cherishing the Dharma, without pride, joining all

sentient beings to the Dharma, and in order to seek the Dharma that is accomplished by omniscient wisdom, I ask the Tathāgata."

When he had said this, the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva great being Gaganagañja, "Excellent, excellent! Holy being, just as you have received answers to the questions you put to buddhas, blessed ones, as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges, so now, noble son, ask the Tathāgata whatever you wish, and by answering each and every question I shall delight your mind."

Then the bodhisattva great being called Guṇarājaprabhāsa, who had gathered in that assembly and was seated there, said to the bodhisattva great being Gaganagañja, "Noble son, for what purpose do you wish to question the Tathāgata?"

Then the bodhisattva great being Gaganagañja answered the bodhisattva great being Guṇarājaprabhāsa in verse:

"Those for whom mind, and mind regarding mind, thought, and mentation are all alike,
Whose well-considered mind abides in the equality of wisdom,
Whose way is to have entered into mind as without mind:
For their sake I put my questions to the Victor.

"Those who have attained illumination, free of darkness and stain,
Who cut through the doubts in the minds of the doubtful,
And who thereby establish them in liberation:
For their sake I put my questions to the Sugata.

With minds thoroughly purified, knowing self as selfless,
Engaged in the welfare of beings, yet delighting in the absence of beings,
Freeing beings from duality, knowing selflessness:
For them is this Dharma talk of ascertainment.

Their rites, their sphere of action, and their vows are completely pure;
Their intentions are pure, and their minds are like space;
They are firm and unmoving like Mount Meru:
For their sake I put my questions to the One Whose Deeds Are Meaningful.

Irreversible and steadfast, excellent in every way in diligence,
Heroes who have crushed the pride of the enemy, Māra,
Who cleanse the stains of afflictions and of intense afflictions:
For those who are a delight to behold I ask this.

Delighting in learning, generosity, moral discipline, patience, and diligence,
Supreme in meditative concentration, liberation, and wisdom,
Radiant with the light of higher knowledge, concentration, and liberation:
For those who are joyful and stainless I ask.

Abiding in emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness,
They display death, transmigration, and birth at will,
Yet they are unborn, nonabiding, and without death and transmigration:
For their sake I ask about the conduct of the Lord of Humans.

Hard for śrāvakas, pratyekabuddhas, and other people
To realize, profound and difficult to see,
A Dharma talk that rouses the minds of all people:
This I request of the Sugata.

Delighting in the perfected Dharma of virtuous deeds,
Seeing no phenomenon in phenomena, free of dual grasping,
Ever in equipoise, delighting in the supreme Dharma,
Their minds like space: for their sake I ask.

Those who abide in the buddha family and delight in the Dharma,
Who always praise the buddhas, with minds that hold to nothing,
Whose infinite renown is heard throughout the three worlds,
Those oceans of qualities: for them I ask this."

Then the bodhisattva great being Gaganagañja said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, how do bodhisattvas become those whose generosity is equal to space, whose moral discipline is equal to space, whose patience is equal to space, whose diligence is equal to space, whose meditative concentration is equal to space, whose wisdom is equal to space, whose merit is equal to space, and whose primordial wisdom is equal to space? How do they become those who are never separated from the recollections approved by the Buddha: the recollection of the Buddha, the recollection of the Dharma, the recollection of the Saṅgha, the recollection of giving, and the recollection of moral discipline? How do they become those who are never separated from the recollection of the gods approved by the Buddha? How do they become those who have attained equality with nirvāṇa and yet carry out the conduct of a bodhisattva, who know the characteristics of the conduct of all sentient beings and are content? How do they become those who hold the treasury of the Dharma jewel of the buddhas, the blessed ones; who fully uphold all the qualities of that essential nature of characteristics to which the Tathāgata fully

awakened, the Dharma that is the essential nature of characteristics; who bring all sentient beings to full maturity, since beings are pure from the very beginning; and who apply themselves properly in order to accomplish all the qualities of a buddha? How do they become those who never decline from the higher knowledges and who have mastery over all phenomena? How do they become those who have entered the profound way of the Dharma, so very hard for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas to realize? How do they become those who are skilled in the knowledge that enters into dependent origination and are free of all views of the two extremes? How do they become those who, sealed with the seal of the Tathāgata, are skilled in knowing the indivisibility of suchness? How do they become those who have fully entered the way of the dharmadhātu and are wholly directed toward the entire dharmadhātu? How do they become those whose intention is as hard and indestructible as a vajra, who abide well in this Great Vehicle and do not waver? How do they become those who have attained the domain of the buddhas and whose own domain is completely pure? How do they become those who have attained dhāraṇī and act without ever forgetting? How do they become those whose eloquence is unobstructed and uninterrupted, ever blessed by the blessing of the buddhas? How do they become those who have gained mastery over birth, death, transmigration, and arising? How do they become those who have completely passed beyond the path of the four māras and have vanquished all māras and opponents? How do they become those who have gathered immeasurable accumulations of merit and have become the sustenance of all sentient beings? How do they become those who, even when no buddhas have appeared, remain close to sentient beings by doing the deeds of a buddha? How do they become those who have attained the samādhi of the ocean seal and are unattached to the minds and conduct of all sentient beings? How do they become those who have completely passed beyond all attachment and possess minds like the wind in the sky? How do they become those who know the ways of ritual and conduct, are free of darkness, and have attained illumination? How do they become those who do not depend on others and fully realize self-arisen wisdom? How will they quickly attain this omniscient wisdom through the Great Vehicle?"

When he had said this, the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva great being Gaganagañja, "Holy being, excellent, excellent! Holy being, it is excellent that you think to ask the Tathāgata about this matter. For you are a friend to all sentient beings without being asked; you have attained illumination regarding

all the qualities of a buddha; you wear the armor of great loving-kindness and great compassion; you have attended upon buddhas beyond counting; you are never sated in your constant search for the Dharma; bearing the weapon of wisdom, you have completely passed beyond every form of pride; you are ever and unceasingly devoted to the welfare of sentient beings; you have completely passed beyond the eight worldly concerns; and with a mind equal to space you are accomplishing omniscient wisdom. Holy being, it is not easy to reach the end of your qualities. Therefore, noble son, listen well and closely, and keep it in mind, and I shall explain how bodhisattva great beings attain these qualities and others as well."

The bodhisattva Gaganagañja said, "Excellent, Blessed One," and listened as the Blessed One had directed, and the Blessed One said this:

"Noble son, when bodhisattvas possess four qualities, their generosity is equal to space. What are the four? They are these: through the purity of self they enter into the purity of sentient beings; through the purity of sentient beings they enter into the purity of giving; through the purity of giving they enter into the purity of dedication; and through the purity of dedication they enter into the purity of awakening. Noble son, when bodhisattvas possess these four qualities, their generosity is equal to space.

"They give their gifts by way of eight purities. What are the eight? They are these: they give their gifts with the clinging to 'I' purified; they give their gifts with the clinging to 'mine' purified; they give their gifts with the cause purified; they give their gifts with views purified; they give their gifts with signs purified; they give their gifts with diversity purified; they give their gifts with the purity of not hoping for any karmic ripening; and they give their gifts with the purity of a mind equal to space. They give their gifts by way of these eight purities.

"Just as space is endless, so they make their minds endless and give their gifts. Just as space is vast and unobstructed, so they dedicate their gifts to awakening and give them. Just as space has no form, so they give their gifts without abiding in any form. Just as space has no feeling, so they give their gifts free of all feelings. Just as space has no perception, so they give their gifts without the knots of any perception. Just as space is unconditioned, so they give their gifts without anything conditioned. Just as space has no characteristic of cognizing, so they give their gifts without abiding in consciousness. Just as space pervades all buddha fields, so they give their gifts pervading all sentient beings with loving-kindness. Just as space is

inexhaustible, so they give their gifts dedicating them to the inexhaustibility of the lineage of the Three Jewels. Just as space has no darkness, so they give their gifts without the darkness of any affliction. Just as space is ever luminous, so they give their gifts with the nature of mind completely pure. Just as space makes room for all sentient beings, so they give their gifts to sustain all sentient beings. Just as space has nothing that is 'mine,' so they give their gifts free of all mental fixation on sentient beings. Just as an emanation gives a gift to an emanation, without conceptualizing and spontaneously, free of mind, mentation, and consciousness, and with no expectation regarding any phenomenon, so, because they are free of duality, bodhisattvas give their gifts in the complete purity of the essential nature that has the character of illusion.

"Noble son, whoever gives away gifts in this way, through the wisdom of discernment, completely casts off all the afflictions of all sentient beings, and through the wisdom of skillful means, never abandons any sentient being. Noble son, the mind that gives in this way is the bodhisattva's generosity equal to space."

Then a bodhisattva great being called Pradīpapāṇi, who had gathered in that very assembly and was seated there, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, which bodhisattvas give away gifts in this way?"

The Blessed One said, "Noble son, those bodhisattva great beings are without aspect, their aspects completely pure. Theirs is the aspect of sentient beings, with sentient beings completely pure; the aspect of phenomena, with phenomena completely pure; the aspect of wisdom, with primordial wisdom completely pure; the aspect of discernment, with discernment completely pure; the aspect of mind, with mind completely pure; the aspect of the world, with the world completely pure. Theirs is the completely pure wisdom that shows the formless as form and does not show it. They are without darkness and they illuminate the darkness. Having destroyed all signs, they have reached the culmination of signlessness. Their wisdom, which has reached the culmination, is completely pure. They possess inexhaustible patience. They have received the prediction of knowing the wisdom of the Tathāgata. They have cut off the boundary and entered the certainty of a bodhisattva. They are sealed with the seal of irreversibility and have received empowerment. They have fully entered into all the qualities of a buddha and act equally through equality. They practice good conduct. This is the domain of those bodhisattva great beings who know the characteristics of the conduct of all sentient beings and the ways to proceed. Those holy beings, each and every one, give gifts of

this kind."

When this teaching was explained, sixteen thousand bodhisattvas gained acceptance regarding generosity equal to space.

Then, on that occasion, the Blessed One spoke these verses:

With a pure mind they always give gifts,
For the sake of awakening, never wishing for a ripened result.
Joyful and delighted, without regret afterward,
Utterly liberated, they always give gifts.
The wise, knowing phenomena to be like illusions,
Do not become attached even to body and life,
And never have any grasping toward them.
Thus their intention is fixed on awakening.
Though they give away everything, they do not become displeased;
They are not disheartened by it, nor are they dejected.
They meditate on phenomena as equal to space;
Therefore they are neither elated nor disheartened.
"My own nature has been completely pure from the very start":
Through the complete purity of awakening they give gifts.
Without attachment to the continuum of mind,
Free of conceptual elaboration, they give gifts.
With mind equal and mentation equal, they give;
They give without the three of best, middling, and least.
With a thoroughly pure and stainless intention,
Though they give away everything, they do not wish for a ripened result.
Body and life are impermanent, like an illusion;
Possessions, like dreams and lightning, have no essence.
Generating compassion and love for all the world,
Untainted by worldly concerns, they give gifts.
"To purify the afflictions, I give away all my wealth,
Thinking, 'I shall become a vessel for the Victor's words,'
And the māras will find no opening against me."
Having reflected in this way, they give away everything.
The One with the Ten Powers declared that generosity is the root.
Those who are firmly established in it possess moral discipline;
Abiding in the qualities of discipline, they attain meditative concentration;
Unattached to concentration, they bring wisdom to perfection.
Through giving and through taming, the mind is fully satisfied,

And the afflictions, once burned, do not arise again.
Giving, it is said, benefits both oneself and others;
Benefit and happiness come together, and giving brings delight.
Giving away is for abandoning the afflictions and for the sake of virtue;
Therefore one does not become attached to grasping.
"I do not give for the sake of others' afflictions;
With my mind fully pure, I give for the sake of awakening."
The more they give with an undaunted mind,
The more they see the qualities of awakening.
The more they see the qualities of awakening,
The more they satisfy hundreds of beings.

Then again the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva great being Gaganagañja, "Son of noble family, a bodhisattva great being who possesses four qualities has moral discipline equal to space. What are the four? They are the equality of body, which is like a reflection; the equality of sound, which is like an echo; the equality of mind, which is like an illusion; and the equality of understanding, which is like space. Son of noble family, a bodhisattva who possesses these four qualities has moral discipline equal to space.

"Son of noble family, these eight are the complete purity of the bodhisattvas' moral discipline. What are the eight? They are: never being separated from the awakening mind, because the mind is pure; having no thought of the śrāvakas or pratyekabuddhas, because their being an authority is pure; not abandoning any of the trainings, because their commitment is pure; not entering into every kind of birth, because their aspiration is completely pure; not slackening, because their freedom from deliberate formation is completely pure; dedicating to awakening, because their signs are completely pure; being free of torment, because their afflictions are completely purified; and the complete fulfillment of their aspirations, because their awakening is completely pure. Son of noble family, these eight are the complete purity of the bodhisattvas' moral discipline.

"Furthermore, completely pure moral discipline is like this. Space is pure, and that discipline too is pure. Space is stainless, and that discipline too is stainless. Space is peaceful, and that discipline too is peaceful. Space is not high, and that discipline too is not high. Space is not low, and that discipline too is not low. Space cannot be grasped, and that discipline too cannot be grasped. Space has no abode, and that discipline too has no abode. Space is

not nonexistent, and that discipline too is not nonexistent. Space is permanent, and that discipline too is permanent. Space is inexhaustible, and that discipline too is inexhaustible. Space is signless, and that discipline too is signless. Space has no movement, and that discipline too has no movement. Space is free of conceptual elaboration, and that discipline too is free of conceptual elaboration. Space is free of defilements, and that discipline too is free of defilements. Space is unconditioned, and that discipline too is unconditioned. Space is unchanging, and that discipline too is unchanging. Space is nonconceptual, and that discipline too is nonconceptual. Space extends everywhere, and that discipline too extends everywhere. Space cannot be cut or split, and that discipline too cannot be cut or split. Space is evenly joined to all, and that discipline too is evenly joined to all. Space by its nature is not afflicted, and that discipline too by its nature is not afflicted. Son of noble family, a bodhisattva who abides in this way has moral discipline equal to space."

Then, on that occasion, the Blessed One spoke these verses:

They guard the stainless discipline of mind and are free of torment;
Body and mind fully pure, they restrain all speech and mentation.
The wise, always inwardly at peace, are not proud or conceited in their discipline;
They do not dwell in a mind of mere explanation; they rely on the awakening mind.
It is no action that has been done, nor thought out, nor likewise examined;
It is not red, blue, or yellow, and it does not abide in color or form.
Formless, not a truly real thing, unmoving and secluded, like space,
Discipline is no ground for views, and all the wise praise it.
That discipline is utterly peaceful; it brings peace and pacifies the afflictions;
It has reached the culmination of calm abiding and insight, and it shows that culmination.
All those who are freed from bondage have relied upon that discipline;
Therefore discipline brings liberation and is the root and ground of awakening.
Those who are trained dwell in the wilderness, with few desires and contentment,
Keep their requisites few, and train their minds in concentration, solitude, and the accumulations.
That basis of discipline is the footing of the mind and the support of liberation;
Therefore those adorned with discipline dwell on the easy path of liberation.

Wholly free of deceit and conceit, they cut through the afflictions of views;
Equal to space, they pervade all with loving-kindness, and they carry their conduct through to the end.
For the sake of awakening they surely never give it up, yet they conceive of no awakening at all.
The wise who are content in this way have the perfection of moral discipline.

The Noble Sūtra Called The Questions of Gaganagañja. The second section.

"Son of noble family, how is a bodhisattva's patience equal to space? Son of noble family, a bodhisattva who possesses four qualities has patience equal to space. What are the four? They are: because their speech is equal to space, though reviled they do not revile in return; because their body is equal to space, though struck they do not strike back; because their mind is equal to space, though abused they do not abuse in return; and because their intention is equal to space, though others are angry they do not become angry in return. Son of noble family, a bodhisattva who possesses these four qualities has patience equal to space.

"Son of noble family, these eight are the complete purity of the bodhisattvas' patience equal to space. What are the eight? They are: space has no hostility, and so there is the complete purity of patience that has no hostility toward any sentient being; space has no attachment, and so there is the complete purity of patience that has no attachment to gain and honor; space is evenly joined to all, and so there is the complete purity of patience whose mind is equal toward all sentient beings; space is neither harmed nor impaired, and so there is the complete purity of patience that is not impaired by the exhaustion of body and mind; space has abandoned all latent tendencies, and so there is the complete purity of patience free of latent tendencies; space has neither mentation nor object, and so there is the complete purity of patience without mentation or object; space is unborn and unarisen, and so there is the complete purity of the patience of one who accepts what is unborn and unarisen; and space pervades all that has form and all that is formless, and so there is the complete purity of patience that pervades with loving-kindness. Son of noble family, these eight are the complete purity of the bodhisattvas' patience, equal to space.

"Son of noble family, these eight are the bodhisattvas' patience of certain understanding of phenomena. What are the eight? They are: they accept

emptiness, yet not in order to destroy views; they accept signlessness, yet not by eliminating signs; they accept wishlessness, yet they are not without aspiration for awakening; they accept the absence of deliberate formation, yet not in order to destroy what is conditioned; they accept non-arising, yet not by way of the characteristics of the unconditioned; they accept non-occurrence, yet not by way of arising and abiding; they accept that there is no sentient being, yet not in order to destroy things; and they accept things just as they are, yet not in order to destroy time. Son of noble family, these eight are the bodhisattvas' patience of certain understanding of phenomena.

"As for what is called patience: to think, 'These people revile me, yet I bear it,' is patience that grasps at 'mine'; this is not patience equal to space. To think, 'I shall bear the abuse of these people,' is patience that grasps at 'I'; that is not patience equal to space. To think, 'These are merely letters strung together,' is patience of sound and speech; that is not patience equal to space. To think, 'This too is empty, and I too am empty,' is patience that applies attention; that is not patience equal to space. To think, 'I shall be patient,' is patience of conscious cognition; that is not patience equal to space.

"It is like this. Suppose there is a great grove of sāla trees, and someone comes along and cuts down a sāla tree. The sāla trees that remain do not think, 'These have been cut, but I have not been cut.' They have no attachment to them and no anger toward them; they do not think, do not discriminate, and do not imagine. In the same way, whoever has patience like this has the supreme complete purity of a bodhisattva's patience equal to space."

Then, on that occasion, the Blessed One spoke these verses:

Knowing exhaustion, their patience is inexhaustible and pure;
Their mind, unattached to objects, is thoroughly cultivated.
Outer and inner are wholly pure, and they abide nowhere:
A supreme mind equal to space, that is patience.
This body is like a reflection, like plants and trees, like a wall;
The mind too is formless, invisible, like an illusion.
These phenomena are no ground for views, just like space;
The body does not change, and the mind has no anger.
Toward those who honor them they feel no joy, and toward others no aversion;
They have no conceptions of high and low.
Bearing whatever comes, they apply themselves like the earth;

They are pure beings, proclaimers of patience in this teaching.
There is no life-force, no person, no self, no sentient being:
Whoever accepts all these phenomena as empty,
And does not contradict cause, condition, and agent,
Is truly supreme in patience in this teaching.
Hearing words of abuse, they do not revile in return;
Like the sound of thunder in the sky, there is no agent.
With self dispelled, their mind sees the supreme emptiness;
They are pure beings, proclaimers of patience in this teaching.

"Son of noble family, how is a bodhisattva's diligence equal to space? Son of noble family, a bodhisattva great being who possesses four qualities has diligence equal to space. What are the four? They are: though they undertake all the roots of virtue, they fully understand that no phenomenon is established at all; though they engage in making offerings and rendering service to all the buddhas, they perceive the tathāgatas as equal in the Dharma body; though they bring sentient beings to maturity, because sentient beings are completely pure they do not apprehend any sentient being; and though they uphold the sacred Dharma of all the buddhas, they do not perceive any phenomenon from which one must become free of attachment. Son of noble family, a bodhisattva great being who possesses these four qualities has diligence equal to space."

"Son of noble family, these eight are the complete purity of the bodhisattvas' diligence. What are the eight? They are: the body adorned by their diligence they know to be like a reflection, and so they do not apprehend it; the speech brought forth by their diligence they examine as being like a plantain tree, and so they do not apprehend it; the mind that their diligence settles in the state of meditative absorption they examine by means of the nature of mind, and so they do not apprehend it; though by their diligence they gather together all the factors of the perfections, they thoroughly examine them by means of the nature of the mind's exhaustion from one moment to the next, and so they do not apprehend them; though by their diligence they accomplish all the factors of awakening, they examine awakening as having the characteristic of a thing, and so they do not perceive it; the buddhafield that their diligence purifies they examine as being equal to space, and so they do not apprehend it; whatever learning their diligence retains, they perceive it as being like the echo of a sound; and all the qualities of a buddha that their diligence

accomplishes they examine as having the characteristic of the indivisible sphere of reality, and so they do not apprehend them. Son of noble family, these eight are the complete purity of the bodhisattvas' diligence.

"Son of noble family, these two are the bodhisattvas' diligence. What are the two? They are the diligence of application and the diligence of complete severance. Of these, the diligence of application is fully engaged with body, speech, and mind. The diligence of complete severance has no taking up, no casting off, and no abiding. When a bodhisattva, having thoroughly examined the diligence that applies body, speech, and mind, finds it to be fundamentally without abiding and does not apprehend it, and when the diligence of complete severance follows along by entering into the sphere of reality, then in this way the bodhisattva's diligence is equal to space.

"Just as space is formless and yet all sentient beings move about in it, so the bodhisattvas' diligence does not abide in any phenomenon and yet brings all sentient beings to maturity. Just as space makes room for all forms and has no covering, so the bodhisattvas' diligence makes room for all sentient beings and is free of all views. Just as grass, forests, and crops grow from space, while space has no root and no abode, so the bodhisattvas' diligence gives rise to all the qualities of a buddha and yet does not abide in the root that is the view of the transitory collection. Just as space goes everywhere and yet does not have the characteristic of moving from place to place, so the bodhisattvas' diligence follows after all virtuous qualities and yet does not have the characteristic of moving from place to place. Just as space is evenly joined to all and yet displays forms as distinct, so the bodhisattvas' diligence joins all phenomena evenly for all sentient beings and yet displays every kind of conduct. When a bodhisattva, through equality, does not perceive whatever he accomplishes, and, having examined it, does not apprehend whatever he undertakes, then in this way the bodhisattva's diligence is equal to space."

Then, on that occasion, the Blessed One spoke these verses:

Generating might through the strength of diligence,
They do not cling even to body and life;
These great beings practice the conduct of awakening,
Working for the welfare of beings with a mind intent on their benefit.
For as long as there has been conditioned existence in former lives,
For just so long do they circle on for the qualities of awakening.
They never become weary of it,

But again and again they generate diligence.
They strive to free inconceivable beings;
They strive to worship inconceivable buddhas;
They strive to behold inconceivable fields;
They strive to tame inconceivable māras.
They strive to give inconceivable gifts;
They strive to guard inconceivable discipline;
They strive to cultivate inconceivable patience;
They strive with inconceivable diligence toward virtue;
They strive to contemplate inconceivable concentration;
They strive to cultivate inconceivable wisdom;
They strive to cultivate inconceivable loving-kindness;
They strive greatly to accomplish benefit and good qualities.
They strive without clinging even to life and body;
They are wholly freed from all the strife of afflictions.
They strive to realize emptiness, liberation, and selflessness;
Great in nature, they strive for selflessness in the self;
Freed from views, they strive also for the sake of awakening;
They strive for the nature of illusions and mirages.
Without mind, they attain a mind that is not a mind;
They strive to teach phenomena that are unmoving.
They act among all beings and yet are liberated;
They always strive in explaining and reciting.
Having fully passed beyond both Dharma and non-Dharma,
They strive in the nature of sound and letters,
And speak thousands of sūtras to beings.
The qualities of the buddhas have no end;
The conduct of sentient beings too is endless:
To that the wise always apply their diligence,
And they fully enter into the endless conduct of beings.
These phenomena are unborn and unceasing;
The minds of those wise ones are not discouraged,
But again and again they generate vast diligence,
And set beings to meditate on such a Dharma.

"Son of noble family, how is a bodhisattva's meditative concentration equal to space? Son of noble family, a bodhisattva who possesses four qualities has

meditative concentration equal to space. What are the four? They are: they settle the mind inwardly, and yet they do not perceive the mind as abiding within; they turn the mind back from outside, and yet they do not apprehend the mind as wandering outside; through the equality of their own mind they enter evenly into the equality of the minds of all sentient beings; and they enter evenly into that very equality of mind as an equality in which mind is of the nature of illusion. Son of noble family, a bodhisattva who possesses these four qualities has meditative concentration equal to space."

"Son of noble family, these eight are the complete purity of the bodhisattvas' meditative concentration. What are the eight? They are: though they practice concentration, they do not practice concentration abiding in the aggregates; though they practice concentration, they do not practice concentration abiding in the elements; though they practice concentration, they do not practice concentration abiding in the sense sources; though they practice concentration, they do not practice concentration abiding in this world; though they practice concentration, they do not practice concentration abiding in the world beyond; though they practice concentration, they do not practice concentration abiding in the desire realm; though they practice concentration, they do not practice concentration abiding in the form realm; and though they practice concentration, they do not practice concentration abiding in the formless realm. Son of noble family, these eight are the complete purity of the bodhisattvas' meditative concentration.

"Furthermore, the mind of certain understanding is the complete purity of meditative concentration. What, then, is the mind of certain understanding? It is that which, toward phenomena, is neither high nor low; neither praises nor disparages; is unchanging; is nonconceptual; has no adding and no taking away; no grasping and no letting go; no darkness and no light; no thought and no conceptualization; no perception and no attention; is neither one, nor two, nor not two; has no wavering, no conceit, no elaboration, no increase, no decrease, no cultivation, and no fear. That which does not abide in any sign or any object, the mind that does not abide, is the mind of certain understanding.

"The mind of certain understanding does not run after forms: knowing the eye, forms, and consciousness, it practices concentration with their own characteristic completely pure. The mind of certain understanding does not run after sounds: knowing the ear, sounds, and consciousness, it practices concentration with their own characteristic completely pure. The mind of certain understanding does not run after smells: knowing the nose, smells, and

consciousness, it practices concentration with their own characteristic completely pure. The mind of certain understanding does not run after tastes: knowing the tongue, tastes, and consciousness, it practices concentration with their own characteristic completely pure. The mind of certain understanding does not run after tangible objects: knowing the body, tangible objects, and consciousness, it practices concentration with their own characteristic completely pure. The mind of certain understanding does not run after mental phenomena: knowing the mind, mental phenomena, and consciousness, it practices concentration with their own characteristic completely pure.

"Son of noble family, it is like this. When the eon is consumed by fire, space does not burn, and when it is destroyed by water, space does not become wet. In the same way, the bodhisattva's meditative concentration equal to space is not burned by any of the afflictions, and it is not attached to any of the concentrations, liberations, meditative absorptions, or meditative attainments. They are in meditative equipoise, and yet they also firmly establish sentient beings whose minds are distracted. Though in equipoise, they feel no elation, and when they arise from it they feel no irritation. Though they show peace to noble beings, they also blaze with diligence in order to bring to maturity beings who are not noble. They are in equipoise and they are equal, and yet to those who act unequally they clearly teach distinctions. Through equality they do not see inequality, and through inequality they do not contradict equality. Such a one is called a practitioner of concentration whose mind is equal to space, free of contradiction and without conflict. Such a one is called a practitioner of concentration of great wisdom. Such a one is called a practitioner of concentration in whom consciousness does not abide at all. The bodhisattva who has realized concentration in this way has meditative concentration equal to space: it is concentration that does not abide."

Then, on that occasion, the Blessed One spoke these verses:

Through the concentrations their faculties are completely pure;
Their mindfulness one-pointed, their mind rests in equipoise.
They do not abide in any abode at all,
And toward all beings they rest evenly in equality.
They do not abide in aggregates, sense sources, or elements,
Whether these are found within or without;
Their domain is utter peace and solitude:
Those wise ones always rest in equipoise.
Always resting in equipoise through equality,

Their mind is equal to and the same as the sphere of reality;
They also show the mind that is utterly secluded,
And the wise are attached to no concentration at all.
In order to bring beings to maturity,
They display death and transmigration, birth and dying,
Yet they never fall from meditative absorption:
That is so by the power of realizing the mind.
Though their domain is the formless absorptions,
In order to bring sentient beings to maturity
They appear clearly even in the desire realm;
They do not abide in self or in sentient beings.

Their domain is equal to space;
Knowing phenomena to be like illusions, like mirages,
With the characteristics of dreams, the moon in water, and clouds,
They always rest in meditative equipoise.
Within the domain of the minds of all beings,
Their mind and understanding enter into beings;
They have no obscuration toward the mental continuum,
And they fully know their own mental continuum as well.
The wise, through concentration, miracles, and higher knowledges,
Go there to many millions of fields,
And with a mind that has abandoned all ignorance and affliction,
They make offerings to inconceivable Victors.
Their faculties are tamed and their mind is at peace;
They have perfected calm abiding and are free of conceptual thought.
Theirs is a mind that brings peace to beings,
Always resting in equipoise in the power of wisdom.
There is neither equality nor anything equal,
And there is no sign called "equality."
Those who are firmly established in that equality
Always rest in meditative equipoise.

"Son of noble family, how is a bodhisattva's wisdom equal to space? Son of noble family, a bodhisattva great being who possesses four qualities has wisdom equal to space. What are the four? They are: through the purity of space they enter into the purity of all sentient beings; through the purity of primordial wisdom they enter into the purity of all consciousnesses; through

the purity of the sphere of reality they enter into the purity of self, sentient being, life-force, and person; and through the purity of meaning they fully realize the purity of all letters. Son of noble family, a bodhisattva who possesses these four qualities has wisdom equal to space.

"Son of noble family, these eight are the complete purity of the bodhisattvas' wisdom. What are the eight? They are: though they accomplish all virtuous qualities, they do not engage in the view of permanence; though they exert diligence to abandon all nonvirtuous qualities, they do not fall into the view of annihilation; though they enter into dependent origination, they do not contradict acceptance of non-arising; though they appear as knowing the four kinds of analytical knowledge, they are not attached to eloquence in definitive words; though they teach the four seals of the Dharma, they do not perceive things as impermanent, suffering, selfless, or peace; though they teach how to engage in karma and its activities, they do not waver from the fact that there is no doer of karma and no ripening; though they abide in knowledge of the Dharma free of elaboration, they clearly teach the definitive explanation that analyzes the words of all phenomena; and though they have fully found the light of all phenomena, they teach sentient beings both affliction and purification. Son of noble family, these eight are the complete purity of the bodhisattvas' wisdom.

"Moreover, this which is called wisdom is a term for pacification, because conceptual thought does not blaze up at all. It is a term for the unchanging, because it is pure by its own characteristic. It is a term for the nonconceptual, because it has no abode. It is a term for things as they are, because it is genuine suchness. It is a term for truth, because it does not change. It is a term for what is correct, because it does not become improper. It is a term for a sharp mind, because it has fully destroyed bondage. It is a term for satisfaction, because of the qualities of the noble ones. It is a term for penetration, because it has been thoroughly examined. It is a term for meaning, because it is inexpressible. It is a term for sameness, because it has no distinctions. It is a term for the essence, because it is indestructible. It is a term for the unmoved, because it does not abide. It is a term for the vajra, because it pierces through. It is a term for deliverance, because what was to be done has been done. It is a term for purity, because by nature it has no affliction. It is a term for the absence of darkness, because light is not apprehended. It is a term for nonduality, because it has no superimposition. It is a term for exhaustion, because it is utterly exhausted and purified. It is a

term for the inexhaustible, because it is unconditioned. It is a term for the unconditioned, because it has no application. It is a term for space, because it is utterly pure. It is a term for space, because it has no obscuration. It is a term for illumination, because it is the abode of abiding. It is a term for non-apprehension, because it has no essential nature. It is a term for primordial wisdom, because consciousness and primordial wisdom are not two. It is a term for the unassailable, because it has no antidote. It is a term for the bodiless, because it is not manifestly established. It is a term for full understanding, because of the suffering of imagination. It is a term for the abandonment of the origin, because it has fully destroyed the latent tendency of craving. It is a term for cessation, because it has not arisen at all. It is a term for cultivation, because it fully enters the path of nonduality. It is a term for awakening, because it fully opens into perfect buddhahood. It is a term for the Dharma, because it is utterly free of attachment. Because the light of primordial wisdom that enters into such terms does not rely on another, it is called wisdom.

"That which follows all the teachings as taught to be equal to space, and, following them, does not conceive or discriminate even the smallest phenomenon, is the bodhisattva's perfection of wisdom equal to space."

Then, on that occasion, the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"Wisdom cuts through views and the darkness of the afflictions;
It utterly clears away habitual tendencies and afflictions,
It definitively shows cause, condition, and agent,
And it completely cuts off all extremes.
It does not dwell upon a self or a sentient being,
And never does it dwell upon a person or a living soul.
It frees from both existence and nonexistence;
Wisdom is taught as going to the far shore.

"Wisdom is victorious over Māra and free of afflictions;
Wisdom, having crossed the floods, carries others across.
Wisdom brings forth primordial wisdom and moves within it;
Wisdom also reveals liberation, the supreme bliss.
By wisdom one works upon the root of the obscurations;
It is the mark of fully understanding the aggregates and elements.
Freeing from characteristic, the thing characterized, and like characteristics,
One who has attained wisdom shines throughout the three realms of

existence.

"Pure conduct is what is called wisdom;
It acts unstained by the entire world.
It acts in full realization of what has been practiced and what is practiced;
A person pure in wisdom is radiant indeed.
It fully purifies the five eyes,
It fully illuminates the five faculties,
It cuts off the five destinies,
And it teaches the Dharma so that the five aggregates may be exhausted.

"Never dwelling on the far shore or the near shore,
It dwells perfectly in the abode where the realm of phenomena abides.
It is like the sky, equal and alike;
In accord with the wisdom of the buddhas, it is noble.
Freed from both extremes, of gain and of no gain,
It neither conceives nor imagines a middle.
The deathless path that all the noble ones have traveled,
Entry into that path it reveals.

"It understands suffering and likewise abandons craving;
It shows the paths and explains cessation as well.
This wisdom enters into knowing the truths,
And by it the prior limit too is cut off.
All realms are alike as realms, and are not realms;
All phenomena are alike as phenomena, utterly void;
All sentient beings are selfless, alike as sentient beings:
Investigating with the intellect of wisdom, one knows this."

"Noble son, what, then, is the bodhisattvas' merit that is equal to space? Noble son, the qualities of a buddha are equal to space, and the seed of their awakening mind is also equal to space. Noble son, whatever merit the bodhisattva brings about, that too is never separate from the awakening mind. The roots of virtue they gather and accumulate are all dedicated to omniscience, and all of them abide immeasurably, equal to space. Therefore the bodhisattva should give rise to this thought: 'Since space is immeasurable, I shall bring about immeasurable merit.' Why is that? Because by undertaking the immeasurable, the immeasurable aim increases. Therefore the bodhisattva should strive for an immeasurable accumulation of merit.

"Noble son, there are these ten immeasurables that a bodhisattva brings to completion through the accumulation of merit. What are the ten? They are as follows: through perfecting the major marks and the excellent minor marks, to complete the immeasurable adornment of the body; through the pure maṇḍala of a voice that accords with all sentient beings, to complete the immeasurable adornment of speech; through following the minds of all sentient beings, to complete the immeasurable adornment of the mind; through immeasurable conduct, wisdom, and deportment, to complete the immeasurable ripening of sentient beings; through immeasurable aspects, to complete the immeasurable purification of buddhafields; through immeasurable merit and mind, ascertainment and analysis, to complete the immeasurable deportment of a buddha; through every array of adornment and every kind of conduct, to complete the immeasurable adornment of the seat of awakening; through completing the unbarred offering sacrifice, to complete the immeasurable fully developed hair-curl between the brows; through immeasurable service and homage to teachers and the immeasurable destruction of pride, to complete the immeasurable crown protuberance on the head, whose summit cannot be seen; and through coming and going without deceit or guile and holding to harmony, to complete the immeasurable unfailing stride. Noble son, these are the ten immeasurables that a bodhisattva brings to completion through the accumulation of merit.

"Furthermore, noble son, when the bodhisattva's mind has become equal to space, then, because space is immeasurable, all his undertakings too abide immeasurably. Therefore it is called merit equal to space.

"Noble son, how is the bodhisattva's primordial wisdom equal to space? It is that this primordial wisdom pervades the minds of all sentient beings, and among the minds of all sentient beings, he knows a mind with desire, exactly as it is, to be a mind with desire. He knows a mind with aversion, exactly as it is, to be a mind with aversion. He knows a mind with delusion, exactly as it is, to be a mind with delusion. By it he also knows a mind with secondary afflictions, exactly as it is, to be a mind with secondary afflictions. Without himself moving from the intrinsic nature of phenomena that is free of desire, he teaches the Dharma to other sentient beings and other persons in order to tame desire. Without himself moving from the intrinsic nature of phenomena that is free of aversion, he teaches the Dharma to other sentient beings and other persons in order to tame aversion. Without himself moving from the intrinsic nature of phenomena that is free of delusion, he teaches the Dharma

to other sentient beings and other persons in order to tame delusion. Without himself moving from the intrinsic nature of phenomena that is free of secondary afflictions, he teaches the Dharma to other sentient beings and other persons in order to tame all afflictions. He teaches the Dharma in order to purify the afflictions of desire, aversion, and delusion.

"He does not see a mind with desire, aversion, delusion, and secondary afflictions as inferior, nor does he see a mind without desire, aversion, delusion, and secondary afflictions as supreme. Why is that? It is because that bodhisattva fully understands the realm of phenomena by way of the limit of nonduality: whatever is the realm of phenomena is the realm of desire; whatever is the realm of phenomena is the realm of aversion; whatever is the realm of phenomena is the realm of delusion; whatever is the realm of phenomena is the realm of the afflictions. Therefore it is said that all phenomena are gathered into the realm of phenomena. The realm of phenomena does not go anywhere, nor does it not go. All phenomena follow the realm of phenomena, and whoever knows the realm of the self also knows the realm of phenomena. Thus the realm of phenomena and the realm of the self are not two. Why is that? Because the self is completely pure, the realm of phenomena too is completely pure. Likewise, all phenomena too are completely pure. What is completely pure is radiant. What is radiant is without covering. In what is without covering there is no room for any sign. In what is signless there is no abiding at all; nonabiding is space. That which thus follows primordial wisdom, and by that primordial wisdom follows all phenomena, is the bodhisattva's primordial wisdom equal to space.

"Noble son, what, then, is the bodhisattva's recollection of the Buddha that the Buddha has sanctioned? It is to recollect the Buddha through moral discipline while never falling away from undefiled moral discipline. It is to recollect the Buddha through meditative absorption while never wavering from the complete equality of the realm of phenomena. It is to recollect the Buddha through wisdom as well, while not conceptualizing all phenomena even as without movement. It is to recollect the Buddha through liberation while not dwelling even in a second moment of mind. It is to recollect the Buddha through the seeing of the primordial wisdom of liberation while not being attached to any knowledge. It is to recollect the Buddha through the powers while never stirring from the primordial wisdom in which the three times are equal. It is to recollect the Buddha through the fearlessnesses while not dwelling together with any defilement. It is to recollect the Buddha through all

the qualities of a buddha as well, while not conceptualizing even the equality of the realm of phenomena.

"Furthermore, recollection of the Buddha is not to see the Buddha in form, and, by knowing the essential nature of form, to follow the primordial wisdom of mindfulness. Likewise, it is not to see the Buddha in feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness, and, by knowing the essential nature of consciousness, to follow the primordial wisdom of mindfulness. It is not to see the Buddha in the aggregates, elements, or sense sources, and, by knowing the essential nature of the aggregates, elements, and sense sources, to follow the primordial wisdom of mindfulness. The mindfulness of great wisdom that comes from knowing the essential nature of all phenomena is without any mental engagement whatsoever, and no views at all arise in it. Knowing the application of mindfulness through such untroubled mindfulness is called the recollection of the Buddha that the Buddha has sanctioned.

"Furthermore, recollection of the Buddha is not to cling to the Buddha in any posture. Whether standing, walking, sitting, lying down, going, coming, speaking, or not speaking, one does not cling to the Buddha. Because one does not cling, one neither brings mindfulness to mind nor brings nonmindfulness to mind. Because one does not mentally engage with mindfulness, one does not recollect the Buddha as form, as marks, or as the nature of reality. Noble son, this is the recollection of the Buddha that the Buddha has sanctioned, in which there is no engagement with any sign or any object at all.

"Noble son, what, then, is the bodhisattvas' recollection of the Dharma that the Buddha has sanctioned? What is called the Dharma is freedom from desire. For those who are attached to any phenomenon whatsoever, there is no recollection of the Dharma at all. What is called the Dharma is without any basis. For those who apply themselves to any phenomenon, there is no recollection of the Dharma at all. What is called the Dharma is peace. For those whose mind and mentation are ablaze, there is no recollection of the Dharma at all. What is called the Dharma is signless. For those whose consciousness follows after signs, there is no recollection of the Dharma at all. What is called the Dharma is unconditioned. For those who abide in what is established as conditioned, there is no recollection of the Dharma at all.

"Again, recollection of the Dharma is that by which one sees all formations as unarisen; it is entry into flawless reality itself. Having understood that all

phenomena are by their intrinsic nature unborn, the bodhisattva attains acceptance of the unborn nature of phenomena. Such a state is the state of the true Dharma. To realize it in this way is to realize all phenomena; this is what is realized by those in training, those beyond training, the pratyekabuddhas, the bodhisattvas, and the perfectly complete buddhas. Such meditative equipoise is the liberation of all the noble ones, in which no phenomenon whatsoever is engaged. That in which no phenomenon whatsoever is engaged is the recollection of the Dharma that the Buddha has sanctioned.

"Noble son, what, then, is the bodhisattva's recollection of the Saṅgha that the Buddha has sanctioned? What is called the Saṅgha is unconditioned; it cannot be recollected by way of conditioning activity. Where there is no engagement in bodily action, verbal action, or mental action, that is called non-conditioning. Here, what is called conditioned is designation and convention. The unconditioned is the complete overcoming of all designations and the complete transcendence of all conventions. Noble son, this is the recollection of the Saṅgha that the Buddha has sanctioned.

"Noble son, what, then, is the bodhisattva's recollection of giving that the Buddha has sanctioned? What is called giving is to discard and wholly give up all the aggregates. Why is that? Because he has not given away any phenomenon at all. For him no phenomenon that is given appears at all. Here, not grasping at any phenomenon is the supreme giving. What is not grasped is not given up. What is not given up is not prided upon. What is not prided upon is not taken as an object. In what is not taken as an object, the mind does not move. Not moving is the absence of cognition by the mind. That in which there is no cognition by the mind is the nonabiding of consciousness. The nonabiding of consciousness is the recollection of giving that the Buddha has sanctioned.

"Moreover, the bodhisattva's giving is dedicated to omniscience, and omniscience is the equality of all phenomena. One who abides in equality gives completely and also dedicates it to awakening; and though he recollects it, he recollects no phenomenon at all. Why is that? Because omniscience is not endowed with the two, phenomena and non-phenomena; and what is nondual has no mental engagement whatsoever. Noble son, the bodhisattva who thus applies himself to knowing phenomena is one who has the recollection of giving that the Buddha has sanctioned.

"Noble son, what, then, is the bodhisattva's recollection of moral discipline that the Buddha has sanctioned? What is called moral discipline is unconditioned: it is undefiled, free of wishes, spontaneously accomplished, accomplished in its vows, and complete in all vows; it is not characterized by cognition. It abides through meditative absorption, and is not a place where the mind takes an object. It is the root of wisdom, and is not characterized by conceptual elaboration. It is concordant with the cause of liberation, and is not divided by duality. It is highly praised by the wise, and is not the appearance of form. It is the pacification of the afflictions, and is not characterized by discrete cognition. It accords with every happiness, and is not produced by an antidote. Noble son, to recollect such moral discipline, with mindfulness untroubled, is called the recollection of moral discipline that the Buddha has sanctioned.

"Noble son, what, then, is the bodhisattva's recollection of the gods that the Buddha has sanctioned? Two classes of gods should be recollected. What are the two? The gods of the Pure Abodes, and the bodhisattvas bound to one more birth who dwell in the abode of Tuṣita. Here the bodhisattva recollects the gods of the Pure Abodes. And those bodhisattvas bound to one more birth who dwell in the abode of Tuṣita he recollects by ten things that are like a crown. What are the ten? Among all the perfections, the Perfection of Wisdom, which has become the crown; among all the higher knowledges, the higher knowledge that does not decline; among all the grounds, the ground of consecration; among all the factors of awakening, right view and meditative absorption that does not decline; among the discriminating knowledges, the uninterrupted knowledge of meaning and of eloquence; among all knowledges, entry into unattached primordial wisdom; among all faculties, knowing how to engage those of superior, middling, and inferior faculties; following the primordial wisdom that illuminates the powers and fearlessnesses; among all eyes, the all-seeing eye of a buddha; that all the qualities of a buddha are as though they had come into the palms of their hands; and that, seated at the seat of awakening, they will fully and completely awaken through wisdom endowed with a single instant of mind. He recollects them by these ten kinds of crownlike qualities. His mindfulness is not disturbed by views, not disturbed by latent tendencies or manifest afflictions, not disturbed by mental engagement, and not disturbed by conceptual elaboration. Noble son, this recollection of the gods, through such untroubled mindfulness, is called the recollection of the gods that the Buddha

has sanctioned.

"Noble son, how is it, then, that the bodhisattva, though he has attained equality with nirvāṇa, still practices the conduct of a bodhisattva? What is called nirvāṇa is the complete pacification of all afflictions, the cutting off of the stream of all feelings, the stilling of all objects, and the absence of rebirth-linking for the aggregates, elements, and sense sources. That holy being has attained equality with nirvāṇa, yet he delights in the great compassion he resolved upon in the past, and in skillful means, wisdom, and primordial wisdom. He is thoroughly blessed with the blessing of the buddhas. He has thoroughly cultivated wisdom and primordial wisdom. Through manifest blessing his cultivation is fully purified. He abides in the meditative absorption of illusory play. He has completely abandoned the afflictions by which saṃsāra is produced or by which one is bound in saṃsāra, and, having gained mastery over the primordial wisdom by which nirvāṇa is shown, he is born from the unborn and arises from what does not arise. Though he has fully entered into equality with nirvāṇa, he does not cease to bring sentient beings to maturity. Noble son, this is the bodhisattvas' gateway of primordial wisdom called the Paired Measure. Abiding in this gateway of primordial wisdom, the bodhisattva, though he has attained equality with nirvāṇa, practices the conduct of a bodhisattva.

"Noble son, how is it, then, that the bodhisattva knows the characteristics and the patterns of the conduct of all sentient beings? Noble son, the conduct of sentient beings is eighty-four thousand. This is the root statement given before.

"The immeasurable, inconceivable, inexpressible conduct of all sentient beings is known by the primordial wisdom of a buddha; it is not known by the primordial wisdom of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, nor is it known by the primordial wisdom of bodhisattvas. Yet the bodhisattva, through the blessing of the buddhas and through his own knowledge, fully enters into the characteristics of the conduct of all sentient beings, whatever the essential nature or characteristic of that conduct may be: whether the characteristic of cause, the characteristic of condition, the characteristic of efficient cause, the characteristic of combination, the characteristic of distinctness, the characteristic of dissimilarity, the characteristic of desire, the characteristic of aversion, the characteristic of delusion, the characteristic of shared fortune, the characteristic of hell beings, the characteristic of the animal realm, the characteristic of the world of Yama, the characteristic of gods, the

characteristic of humans, the characteristic of those certain to become śrāvakas, the characteristic of those certain to become pratyekabuddhas, the characteristic of those certain to become buddhas, the characteristic of a distant cause, the characteristic of an intermediate cause, or the characteristic of a proximate cause. He knows the characteristics of all that conduct exactly as they are, and is irreproachable in all primordial wisdom. Noble son, it is in this way that the bodhisattva knows the characteristics and the patterns of the conduct of all sentient beings.

"Noble son, how is it, then, that the bodhisattva holds the treasury of the precious Dharma of the buddhas, the blessed ones? Noble son, the treasury of the precious Dharma of the buddhas, the blessed ones, is inexhaustible. However many entries there are into the characteristics of the conduct of all sentient beings, just so many are the entries into the primordial wisdom that leads into the treasury of the precious Dharma of the buddhas, the blessed ones. Just as the conduct of sentient beings is inexhaustible and endless, so too the treasury of the precious Dharma of the buddhas, the blessed ones, is inexhaustible and endless.

"What is called the treasury of the precious Dharma is this: from the night on which the Tathāgata attains awakening until the night on which he passes into complete nirvāṇa, all that the Tathāgata has taught, teaches, and will teach is thus, unerringly thus, and not otherwise. Why is it called 'thus'? Because it has fully entered into the peace of suchness, it is called 'thus.' Why is it called 'unerring suchness'? Because it has fully entered into the ultimate truth, it is called 'unerring suchness.' Why is it called 'suchness that is not otherwise'? Because it is not sought elsewhere than in its own essential nature, it is 'not otherwise.'

"Further, as for the treasury of the precious Dharma of the buddhas, the blessed ones: even if all the sentient beings belonging to a great trichiliocosm world system were as learned as Ānanda, all of them together could not comprehend even its letters in a thousand ten millions of eons. Moreover, what is taught with a single meaning and taught exactly as it is, such is the treasury of the precious Dharma of the buddhas, the blessed ones. The bodhisattvas hold it in such a way that, without forgetting any letter and without losing any meaning, they satisfy all sentient beings, delight all the buddhas, defeat all the māras, subdue all the other non-Buddhist teachers (tīrthikas), and pacify all afflictions; and they hold it in such a way as to proclaim the precious Dharma to them. Noble son, it is in this way that the

bodhisattva holds the treasury of the precious Dharma of the buddhas, the blessed ones.

"Furthermore, noble son, the bodhisattva should hold phenomena in the very essential nature in which I awakened to phenomena. And in what way did the Tathāgata fully and completely awaken to phenomena? As having the essential nature of an illusion, in the manner of being not truly established; as having the essential nature of a dream, in the manner of utterly transcending objects; as having the essential nature of a mirage, in the manner of being utterly unborn; as having the essential nature of an optical illusion, in the manner of not transmigrating; as having the essential nature of a reflection, in the manner of being without intrinsic nature; as having the essential nature of emptiness, in the manner of dependence; as having the essential nature of signlessness, in the manner of nonconceptuality; as having the essential nature of wishlessness, in the manner of the mind's nonattachment; as having the essential nature of freedom from desire, in the manner of being free from all desire; and as having the essential nature of the unconditioned, in the manner of transcending all enumeration. Noble son, in this way, relying conventionally on the understanding of others, I fully and completely awakened to the Dharma as such; but the characteristic of the essential nature of that Dharma cannot be expressed in words. Therefore the bodhisattva who wishes to hold the teachings should fully and completely awaken to phenomena of such an essential nature, and should also teach them to other sentient beings and other persons through letters and definitive words.

"Noble son, how is it, then, that the bodhisattva brings sentient beings to maturity through the primordial purity of sentient beings? Noble son, the realm of sentient beings is primordially pure; there is no root entity of sentient beings in it. Having understood that the root of all phenomena is completely cut off, the bodhisattva, with regard to the sentient beings he brings to maturity, does not come to view them as a self, does not view them as a sentient being, does not view them as a living soul, and does not come to view them as a person. Furthermore, he thinks: 'This so-called sentient being is an inversion. It is from entanglement in views about causes, from ignorance, from existence, from craving, and from false imagination that one speaks of a sentient being.' Therefore, in order to abandon completely the afflictions that arise from nonexistent inversions, the bodhisattva teaches the Dharma to sentient beings, yet he does not destroy any entity at all.

"Because sentient beings do not exist and sentient beings are void, he brings sentient beings to maturity. In this way the bodhisattva brings sentient beings to maturity through their primordial purity.

"Noble son, how is it, then, that the bodhisattva, by applying himself to what is proper, gathers all the qualities of a buddha? What is called 'the proper' is entry into dependent origination. Why is that? Because whatever the causes and conditions are like, the result is produced accordingly. Generosity is the cause of great wealth; and whatever the bodhisattva gives, he dedicates to omniscience and so perfects the perfection of generosity. Moral discipline is the cause of birth among gods and humans; having been born among gods and humans, the bodhisattva establishes sentient beings in moral discipline, and, dedicating to omniscience the moral discipline he has taken up, he perfects the perfection of moral discipline. Patience and gentleness are the cause of the adornment of body, speech, and mind; with body, speech, and mind adorned, the bodhisattva is engaged in benefiting himself and benefiting others, and, dedicating to omniscience that state of patience that wishes to benefit, he perfects the perfection of patience. Diligence is the cause of gathering all the qualities of a buddha; having undertaken diligence, the bodhisattva accomplishes all roots of virtue, and, dedicating to omniscience that diligence by which all roots of virtue are accomplished, he perfects the perfection of diligence. Meditative concentration is the cause of joy and contentment of mind; through joy and contentment the bodhisattva completes the accumulation of calm abiding, and, dedicating that accumulation of calm abiding to omniscience, he perfects the perfection of meditative concentration. Learning is the cause of great wisdom; the bodhisattva of great wisdom does not hold to views that take an object, and, dedicating to omniscience that learning without an object, he perfects the perfection of wisdom. Likewise, of all wholesome qualities, whatever causes of wholesome qualities have been accumulated, the result of each arises spontaneously; and that cause and condition is called proper mental engagement.

"Furthermore, as for what is called 'the proper,' the proper way of all phenomena is the self: just as the self has no self, so all sentient beings have no self. Just as the self is empty, so all phenomena are empty. Just as the self is merely a name imputed, so all phenomena too are merely names imputed. The bodhisattva who applies himself to what is proper in this way engages all phenomena as equal. The equality of all phenomena is the equality of all the qualities of a buddha. Thus the bodhisattva who applies himself to what is

proper accomplishes the qualities of a buddha.

"Noble son, how is it, then, that the bodhisattva does not lose the higher knowledges and has mastery over all phenomena? Here, noble son, those ascetics or brahmins who produce the higher knowledges without having destroyed the view of the perishable collection as a self will also fall away from those higher knowledges. The bodhisattva, however, having destroyed the sixty-two views that spring from the root of the view of the perishable collection, produces the higher knowledges free of all views and all grasping. He is endowed with primordial wisdom, endowed with wisdom, endowed with intelligence, endowed with patience, and endowed with moral discipline. He is absorbed in meditative absorption, secluded in body and secluded in mind. Through such primordial wisdom he turns inward and does not roam outside. His domain is the domainless. He has a contented mind and a joyful mind. He is examined by thorough examination. His intelligence is utterly bright, undisturbed by afflictions, and has attained illumination. His primordial wisdom is free of dimness. He has gathered the accumulation of merit, gathered the accumulation of primordial wisdom, gathered the accumulation of calm abiding, and gathered the accumulation of insight. He is steadfast through generosity, adorned with moral discipline, clad in the armor of patience, wearing the coat of mail of diligence, abiding in meditative concentration, possessed of an intelligence in which wisdom is well cultivated, in harmony with loving-kindness, firmly abiding in compassion, and accomplished through skillful means. Endowed with such qualities, he produces the higher knowledges.

"Up to the seat of awakening he is exceedingly exalted by these higher knowledges, and through these higher knowledges he has mastery over all phenomena. He sees all forms, hears all sounds, enters all minds, and recollects countless eons. He performs magical displays through every miraculous power. He finds the bliss of the exhaustion of defilements. He has mastery over all the conceptions of the mind, however many, over conception and over all analysis. Thus he abides spontaneously in all phenomena. Noble son, it is in this way that the bodhisattva does not lose the higher knowledges and has mastery over all phenomena.

"Noble son, how is it, then, that the bodhisattva fully enters the profound way of the Dharma, so difficult for all the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas to realize? Noble son, what is called profound is dependent origination. The way of dependent origination is as follows: conditioned by ignorance are formations;

conditioned by formations is consciousness; conditioned by consciousness are name and form; conditioned by name and form are the six sense sources; conditioned by the six sense sources is contact; conditioned by contact is feeling; conditioned by feeling is craving; conditioned by craving is grasping; conditioned by grasping is existence; conditioned by existence is birth; conditioned by birth arise aging and death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness, and agitation. Thus this whole great mass of suffering comes into being. The bodhisattva's primordial wisdom fully enters into whatever causes and conditions by which sentient beings become thoroughly afflicted. This is called the way of the arising of dependent origination.

And what is the way of the cessation of dependent origination? It is this: with the cessation of ignorance, formations cease; with the cessation of formations, consciousness ceases; with the cessation of consciousness, name and form cease; with the cessation of name and form, the six sense sources cease; with the cessation of the six sense sources, contact ceases; with the cessation of contact, feeling ceases; with the cessation of feeling, craving ceases; with the cessation of craving, grasping ceases; with the cessation of grasping, existence ceases; with the cessation of existence, birth ceases; with the cessation of birth, aging and death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness, and agitation cease. Thus this whole great mass of suffering comes to cease. Son of noble family, this is called the way of the cessation of dependent origination. The bodhisattva's primordial wisdom fully enters into whatever causes and conditions by which sentient beings become purified. This is called entering the profound mode of the Dharma, which is not the domain of any śrāvakas or pratyekabuddhas.

Why is it not the domain of any śrāvakas or pratyekabuddhas? Knowing the thorough affliction and the purification of all sentient beings is the domain of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. Through their own primordial wisdom and through the blessing of the buddhas, bodhisattvas too know how these are linked together.

Furthermore, what is called profound is the transitory collection, the purity of the self, and the purity of all phenomena. Why? Even when searched for everywhere, the transitory collection is not found, and what is not found is profound. The self has not been found even by all the buddhas. Why? Because the self is pure from the very beginning, and just as the self is pure, so all phenomena are pure. Why is it called pure? Because in it no phenomenon whatsoever has arisen or been produced, has ceased or will cease; therefore it

is called pure. Without darkness, without light, without a basis, without blurred vision, it is the profound ultimate, in which there is no eye and no cessation of the eye, and so on up to no mind and no cessation of the mind. It is not counted as an object. What is not an object and yet functions as an object is the ultimate; therefore it is called profound. In it there is no grasping by mind or mentation. In such a profound mode of the Dharma, difficult to realize, difficult to see, and difficult to comprehend, bodhisattvas do not rest their wisdom on dependence upon others, and they also fully teach it to other sentient beings. Thus the bodhisattva's thorough entry into the profound mode of the Dharma is difficult for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas to fathom.

The Noble Sūtra Requested by Gaganagañja. The third fascicle.

Son of noble family, how is the bodhisattva skilled in the knowledge that enters into dependent origination, and free of all views of the two extremes? Son of noble family, here the bodhisattva thinks: What is dependent is nothing at all. What is dependent is without substance. What is dependent is not established. What arises dependently is impermanent, suffering, without self, and at peace. In what is dependent there is no self, no sentient being, no life principle, no one who is nourished, no man, no person, no one born of Manu, no son of Manu. In what is dependent there is no genuine arising whatsoever. What is dependent is nothing whatever, without effort, empty, signless, secluded, without movement, unelaborated, and free of conceptual elaboration. Therefore, when there is arising, it is only phenomena that arise, and when there is ceasing, it is only phenomena that cease. Hence it is said that here there is no self, sentient being, life principle, nourished one, man, person, one born of Manu, or son of Manu. In those phenomena that arise dependently there is no arising whatsoever and no owner. Therefore all phenomena are said to be like grass, trees, walls, paths, and mirages. Just as, when external things arise, there is no producer, and when they cease, there is no one who makes them cease, so too, when inner phenomena arise, there is no producer, and when they cease, there is no one who makes them cease. Rather, he thinks: when the conditions are present they occur, and when the conditions are incomplete they cease. Applying himself to knowledge in this way, he fully abandons all views of extremes.

What are views of extremes? The extremes are annihilation and permanence. That which neither produces nor perishes is free of annihilation and permanence; therefore, being pure, all views of extremes are purified. Son of noble family, in this way the bodhisattva is skilled in the knowledge that enters

into dependent origination and is free of all views of extremes.

Son of noble family, how is the bodhisattva, sealed with the seal of the Tathāgata, skilled in knowing the indivisibility of suchness? As for being sealed with the seal of the Tathāgata, the indivisibility of suchness is the seal. It is undivided, without entry, without clinging, unshakable, and not to be moved; the world with its gods, humans, and asuras cannot move it. Why? Because the world with its gods, humans, and asuras is itself sealed with that seal. That seal of the Tathāgata is the seal of utter nonarising, the seal of utter emptiness, the seal of utter signlessness, the seal of utter wishlessness, the seal of the utterly unconditioned, the seal of utter freedom from attachment, the seal of utter suchness, the seal of the utter limit of reality, and the seal of utter space. Just as space, as a seal, does not appear, so too that seal of the Tathāgata does not appear to the five eyes; it is sealed with the seal of its own characteristic. However many conventional designations for phenomena the Tathāgata makes, all of them are designated as sealed with the seal of the Tathāgata in just this way. Those whose sphere is consciousness set up distinctions among phenomena. Those who do not abide in consciousness do not set up distinctions among phenomena and do not treat phenomena as separate. Because they are sealed with the seal of the Tathāgata, they do not divide suchness.

What, then, is dividing suchness? It is conceptualizing in terms of inferior, middling, and superior phenomena. Those who do not conceive of or conceptualize any phenomena do not divide suchness. However much one may examine and analyze, suchness cannot be divided. For example, although all sentient beings move about in space, the element of space does not become connected with them. In the same way, although all sentient beings move about in suchness, suchness does not become mixed with them. A bodhisattva here who knows such phenomena is sealed with the seal of the Tathāgata, and suchness, too, does not become mixed.

Son of noble family, how does the bodhisattva enter the way of the realm of phenomena (dharmadhātu) and become fully directed toward the entire realm of phenomena? The realm of phenomena is the realm free of attachment, because it is free of all dust. It is the unborn realm, because it has not been brought about. It is the realm of noncessation, because it has not come into being. It is the realm of not going, because there is no going. It is the realm of no coming, because there is no crossing over. It is the realm of nonabiding, because nothing comes forth. It is the realm of things just as they are, because

the three times are equal. It is the realm of the self, because it is pure from the very beginning. It is the realm without a person, because it is the ultimate. It is the realm without cognizance, because it has no abode. It is the realm without a basis, because it has no admixture. It is the realm without birth, because it is certain. It is the realm of space, because it is completely pure by nature. It is the realm of nirvāṇa, because it has no antidote. This is called entering the way of the realm of phenomena.

Son of noble family, because all phenomena are entered in this way, whatever the bodhisattva who has thus entered the way of the Dharma says, expresses, and teaches, all of it is fully directed toward the realm of phenomena. One who has entered the way of the realm of phenomena fully knows that the element of attachment and the realm of phenomena are not two. Why? Because attachment has the nature of the realm of phenomena. The element of aversion and the realm of phenomena are not two. Why? Because aversion has the nature of the realm of phenomena. The element of delusion and the realm of phenomena are not two. Why? Because delusion has the nature of the realm of phenomena. The element of the afflictions and the realm of phenomena are not two. Why? Because the afflictions have the nature of the realm of phenomena. The desire realm and the realm of phenomena are not two. Why? Because the desire realm has the nature of the realm of phenomena. The form realm and the realm of phenomena are not two. Why? Because the form realm has the nature of the realm of phenomena. The formless realm and the realm of phenomena are not two. Why? Because the formless realm has the nature of the realm of phenomena. The eye element and the realm of phenomena are not two. Why? Because the eye has the nature of the realm of phenomena. The form element and the realm of phenomena are not two. Why? Because form has the nature of the realm of phenomena. The eye consciousness element and the realm of phenomena are not two. Why? Because eye consciousness has the nature of the realm of phenomena. And so on up to the mind element: it and the realm of phenomena are not two. Why? Because the mind element has the nature of the realm of phenomena. The mind consciousness element and the realm of phenomena are not two. Why? Because mind consciousness has the nature of the realm of phenomena. The element of the aggregates and the realm of phenomena are not two. Why? Because the element of the aggregates has the nature of the realm of phenomena. The earth element, the water element, the fire element, the wind element, and the realm of phenomena are not two.

Why? Because earth, water, fire, and wind have the nature of the realm of phenomena. The eighty-four thousand heaps of Dharma, the eighty-four thousand kinds of conduct, and so on up to all phenomena, and the realm of phenomena are not two. Why? Because all phenomena have the nature of the realm of phenomena. The bodhisattva who has entered this equality of phenomena fully knows all phenomena, because he is fully directed toward the entire realm of phenomena. Son of noble family, it is in this way that the bodhisattva has entered the way of the Dharma.

Son of noble family, how is the bodhisattva's intention firm like a vajra and unbreakable, so that he abides well in this Great Vehicle and does not waver? Son of noble family, through twelve things that are firm like a vajra and unbreakable, the bodhisattva cannot be broken by the world with its gods. What are the twelve? They are as follows: an unbreakable awakening mind; unbreakable intention and application with superior intention; unbreakable generosity, moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, and wisdom; unbreakable great loving-kindness and great compassion; unbreakable means of attracting disciples; unbreakable ripening of sentient beings; unbreakable purification of buddha fields; unbreakable freedom from weariness with saṃsāra; unbreakable insatiability for roots of virtue; unbreakable performance of unrestricted offerings for the sake of the major marks and the excellent minor marks; unbreakable giving up of body and life in order to uphold the sublime Dharma; unbreakable dedication of the roots of virtue for the sake of other sentient beings and other persons; and unbreakable accomplishment of all the qualities of a buddha. Son of noble family, when the bodhisattva cannot be parted from such qualities as these, his intention is firm like a vajra and unbreakable. It is just like a vajra jewel: it pierces all precious jewels, yet it itself cannot be pierced. In the same way, the bodhisattva whose intention is firm like a vajra and unbreakable dispels the latent tendencies, the manifest afflictions, and the views of all sentient beings, yet he himself cannot be parted from this Great Vehicle. Son of noble family, in this way the bodhisattva's intention is firm like a vajra and unbreakable, and he abides well in this Great Vehicle and does not waver.

Son of noble family, how does the bodhisattva attain the domain of the buddhas and purify his own domain? What is called the domain of the buddhas is no domain; it is without domain, and completely pure of all domains. Here the bodhisattva purifies his own domain through the purity of the domain of the buddhas. He thinks: The domain of the eye is the domain of the buddhas,

yet the domain of the buddhas is neither near to nor far from anyone. Why? Because the domain of the buddhas is a secluded domain, and in a secluded domain there is no domain of the eye at all. The domain of the ear is the domain of the buddhas, yet the domain of the buddhas is neither near to nor far from anyone. Why? Because the domain of the buddhas is a secluded domain, and in a secluded domain there is no domain of the ear at all. The domain of the nose is the domain of the buddhas, yet the domain of the buddhas is neither near to nor far from anyone. Why? Because the domain of the buddhas is a secluded domain, and in a secluded domain there is no domain of the nose at all. The domain of the tongue is the domain of the buddhas, yet the domain of the buddhas is neither near to nor far from anyone. Why? Because the domain of the buddhas is a secluded domain, and in a secluded domain there is no domain of the tongue at all. The domain of the body is the domain of the buddhas, yet the domain of the buddhas is neither near to nor far from anyone. Why? Because the domain of the buddhas is a secluded domain, and in a secluded domain there is no domain of the body at all. The domain of the mind is the domain of the buddhas, yet the domain of the buddhas is neither near to nor far from anyone. Why? Because the domain of the buddhas is a secluded domain, and in a secluded domain there is no domain of the mind at all. It is the same for the aggregates, the elements, the sense sources, and the twelve links of dependent origination.

Son of noble family, in this way the bodhisattva, through the very seclusion of the domain of the buddhas, enters into all domains as secluded. Having entered the buddha field through the purity of his own field, he enters into the seclusion of the domain of the buddhas with regard to all the phenomena that appear to his six faculties. Just as the domain of the Tathāgata is without attachment and without obstruction, so too he is unattached and unobstructed with regard to all domains. Son of noble family, in this way the bodhisattva follows the domain of the buddhas and purifies his own domain.

Son of noble family, how does the bodhisattva who has attained dhāraṇī always act without forgetting? Son of noble family, here the bodhisattva attains dhāraṇī by carrying out the purification of dhāraṇī. And what is it that purifies dhāraṇī? Son of noble family, these thirty-two things purify dhāraṇī. What are the thirty-two? They are as follows: seeking the Dharma; desiring the Dharma; taking delight in the joy of the Dharma; being inclined toward the Dharma; being bent upon the Dharma; relying on, attending upon, and honoring the learned; being without pride and respectfully humble toward

masters and preceptors; being insatiable in searching for the Dharma; being easy to instruct and harmonious toward those whom one follows; regarding those who speak the Dharma as the Teacher himself and not looking for their faults; being free of laziness in memorizing, reciting, and teaching; giving the Dharma without a teacher's closed fist with regard to the Dharma, and without material motive; applying oneself to learning, which is the root and ground of wisdom, and to the Dharma in the proper way; making one's learning limitless in order to examine the Dharma as one has heard it; making one's abiding in pure conduct limitless; having a mind always inclined toward solitude; recollecting the six recollections; not abandoning the six things that bring about mutual affection; not giving up the six objects of respect; applying oneself to the Dharma with a mind free of anger toward all sentient beings; actions that do not contradict dependent origination; engaging in what is to be done; not being afraid to have the mind examine with certainty the three doors of liberation; never failing, through upholding all the lineages of the noble ones and the qualities of ascetic purification; being undaunted in upholding the sublime Dharma; great compassion through regard for sentient beings; giving up body and life through regard for the Dharma; never being proud through regard for wisdom; and never wearying of bringing sentient beings to maturity. This is called what purifies dhāraṇī.

Son of noble family, what then is dhāraṇī? It is not forgetting the teachings one has memorized; not forgetting the teachings as one has heard them; mindfulness and recollection; realization and comprehension; a longing for understanding; inexhaustible letters; knowing how to enter into etymologies and languages; unobstructed and uninterrupted eloquence in teaching; knowing how to enter into the understanding of the sūtras of definitive meaning; knowing how to enter into the understanding of the sūtras of provisional meaning; knowing how to teach the inexhaustible conventional; knowing how to teach the reality of the indivisible ultimate; knowing with certainty how to enter into the truths; knowing how to follow the applications of mindfulness; knowing the diligence of the right abandonments that never lets up; knowing the display of the bases of miraculous power; knowing the gradations of the faculties; knowing how to abide unshakably in the powers; knowing the realization of the branches of awakening and what accords with them; knowing the ground for entering the path; knowing how calm abiding settles the mind; knowing how insight sets phenomena free; knowing what accords with knowledge and liberation; knowing how to enter into the

analytical knowledges; knowing how to bring forth the wisdom of the superknowledges; knowing how to enter into the six perfections; knowing the four means of attracting disciples, each as appropriate; knowing how to enter into sounds, languages, and modes of speech; knowing how to teach the conventions of the Dharma; knowing meaning as indivisible; knowing words and syllables as inexhaustible; knowing how to satisfy all sentient beings; knowing how to teach the Dharma to each as appropriate; knowing how to retain in memory what all the buddhas have spoken; knowing how to enter into the etymologies that connect all words and letters; knowing how to realize affliction and purification exactly as they are; knowing how to enter into causes and actions; and knowing all phenomena as they appear, without blurring. This is called dhāraṇī.

That which holds all teachings with a body, speech, and mind that are like the earth is inexhaustible. It rains down the rain of the Dharma, completely pacifies the torment of the afflictions, and brings forth all the qualities of a buddha. This is entering the way of dhāraṇī, and one who has attained dhāraṇī should be known to act without forgetting any of the qualities of a buddha. Son of noble family, in this way the bodhisattva who has attained dhāraṇī always acts without forgetting.

Son of noble family, how is the bodhisattva's eloquence unobstructed and uninterrupted, and always blessed with the blessing of the buddhas? Son of noble family, these twenty-four are the eloquence of bodhisattvas. What are the twenty-four? They are as follows: swift eloquence; quick eloquence; unobstructed eloquence; uninterrupted eloquence; eloquence in thoroughly definitive words; eloquence in the profound; eloquence in the varied; well-adorned eloquence; undaunted eloquence; fearless eloquence; eloquence in the etymologies that teach various verses; eloquence in sūtras, narratives, and accounts of the past; unconquerable eloquence; eloquence in the inexhaustible teaching of the analysis of words; eloquence that is exceedingly clear and exceedingly beautiful; eloquence whose words are dignified and acceptable; eloquence that makes the teaching of the Dharma bear fruit; eloquence that adorns assemblies of gods; eloquence that cuts through all doubts; eloquence in worldly and transcendent teachings; unerring eloquence; eloquence of loving-kindness, compassion, joy, and equanimity toward the assembly; eloquence of the superknowledge that recollects births; and eloquence blessed with the blessing of the buddhas. Son of noble family, these twenty-four are the eloquence of bodhisattvas.

These, too, are accomplished through twenty-four purifications. What are the twenty-four? They are as follows: by not cutting short the words of one's teacher, one comes to have swift eloquence. By not hesitating when told "Come here" or "Go," one's eloquence becomes quick.

By being unattached to all afflictions, one's eloquence becomes unobstructed. By abiding without attachment to them, one's eloquence becomes uninterrupted. By being free of slanderous speech, one comes to have eloquence in thoroughly definitive words. By realizing dependent origination, one comes to have eloquence in the profound. By accumulating various kinds of giving, one comes to have eloquence in the varied. By giving away a well-adorned wife, one comes to have well-adorned eloquence. By not falling away from the awakening mind, one comes to have undaunted eloquence. By thoroughly guarding the whole of moral discipline, one comes to have fearless eloquence. By giving parasols, banners, flags, and various bells, one comes to have eloquence in the etymologies that teach various verses. By being foremost in generosity, in service, and in honoring others, one comes to have eloquence in sūtras, narratives, and accounts of the past. By not despising those who are suffering, poor, and without protector, one comes to have unconquerable eloquence. By giving inexhaustible treasures and establishing others in the Dharma, one comes to have eloquence in the inexhaustible teaching of the analysis of words. By possessing verbal conduct that is truthful, free of base speech, and free of harsh words, one's eloquence becomes exceedingly clear and beautiful. By not disregarding the words of one's teacher and not cutting short the words of others, one comes to have eloquence whose words are dignified and acceptable. By accomplishing in oneself the qualities one teaches, one comes to have eloquence that makes the teaching of the Dharma bear fruit. By not praising oneself, not disparaging others, and giving away cherished possessions, one comes to have eloquence that adorns assemblies of gods. By not having a teacher's closed fist with regard to the Dharma and by teaching the Dharma just as one has heard it, one comes to have eloquence that cuts through all doubts. By knowing all the treatises, not harming others, nursing the sick, and generously giving medicine, one comes to have eloquence in all worldly and transcendent teachings. By not looking for occasions when others go astray, not bringing up the transgressions of others, and not dwelling on mistakes, one comes to have unerring eloquence. By having an even mind toward all sentient beings, acting equally toward all sentient beings, establishing them on the path to nirvāṇa,

and not seeking gain, honor, or fame of any kind, one comes to have eloquence of loving-kindness, compassion, joy, and equanimity toward the assembly. By being easy to instruct and gentle, doing just as one has said, having a joyful mind, and not disturbing the mindstreams of others, one comes to have eloquence of the superknowledge that recollects births. By not falling away from the Great Vehicle, not wishing for the Lesser Vehicle, having great compassion for sentient beings, and establishing everyone in earnest practice, one comes to have eloquence blessed with the blessing of the buddhas.

Because it makes other sentient beings understand, it is called eloquence. Because it shows other sentient beings what is to be earnestly practiced, it is called eloquence. Because it satisfies the mindstreams of others, it is called eloquence. Because it teaches in accord with the minds of other sentient beings, it is called eloquence. Son of noble family, a bodhisattva who possesses such qualities, virtues, and wisdom has unobstructed and uninterrupted eloquence, and is always blessed with the blessing of the buddhas.

Son of noble family, how does the bodhisattva gain mastery over birth, death and transmigration, and coming into being? Son of noble family, when the bodhisattva possesses twelve qualities, he gains mastery over birth, death and transmigration, and coming into being. What are the twelve? They are as follows: completely abandoning sinful friends and always relying on spiritual friends; a view that is thoroughly pure; the pure body of moral discipline sanctioned by the buddhas; knowing how to be endowed with meditative absorptions and meditative attainments; wisdom and skillful means joined together; attaining the superknowledges without their declining; discerning what is unborn and has not come into being; taking birth intentionally; fulfilling one's aspirations; applying oneself to the loving-kindness that looks upon sentient beings; being resolved upon great compassion; regarding phenomena as like an illusion; transmigrating and taking birth without dying; entering into phenomena through the characteristic of phenomena, whose nature is that of a dream; examining distorted phenomena exactly as they truly are; and taking birth from the blessing of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, transmigrating and coming into being, yet not conceiving of birth, transmigration, or coming into being.

Son of noble family, the accounts of the past lives in which the bodhisattva, born in this place or that, worked for the benefit of sentient beings, those immeasurable and countless accounts of past lives, all rest on two roots:

resting on the wisdom of the superknowledges, and resting on the root of great compassion. Son of noble family, in this way the bodhisattva gains mastery over birth, death and transmigration, and coming into being.

Son of noble family, how does the bodhisattva pass completely beyond the path of the four māras and completely vanquish all māras and opponents? Son of noble family, here the bodhisattva, knowing and realizing all phenomena to be like an illusion, passes completely beyond the māra of the aggregates. By properly discerning the Dharma as he has heard it, he passes completely beyond the māra of the afflictions. By realizing dependent origination, he passes completely beyond the māra of the Lord of Death. By not falling away from the awakening mind, he passes completely beyond the māra who is a son of the gods.

Moreover, he has vanquished the deeds of Māra. And what are the deeds of Māra that he has vanquished, so that Māra finds no opening against the bodhisattva? Longing for the Lesser Vehicle is a deed of Māra. Not guarding the awakening mind is a deed of Māra. Giving to sentient beings with partiality is a deed of Māra. Moral discipline that rests on the aim of rebirth is a deed of Māra. And so too, applying the same: patience dedicated to physical form, diligence that strives at worldly affairs, meditative concentration that clings to and savors its taste, and, as to wisdom, disparaging those of inferior qualities, are deeds of Māra. Being utterly weary of saṃsāra is a deed of Māra. Not dedicating the roots of virtue is a deed of Māra. Not reproaching the afflictions is a deed of Māra. Concealing transgressions is a deed of Māra. Hostility toward bodhisattvas is a deed of Māra. Rejecting the true Dharma is a deed of Māra. Breaking the continuity of loving-kindness is a deed of Māra. Not seeking the perfections is a deed of Māra. Not wishing to listen to the true Dharma is a deed of Māra. Keeping the closed fist of a teacher with regard to the Dharma is a deed of Māra. Teaching the Dharma for the sake of material gain is a deed of Māra. Trying to bring sentient beings to maturity without skillful means is a deed of Māra. Abandoning the means of attracting disciples is a deed of Māra. Anger toward those whose moral discipline is corrupt is a deed of Māra. Disrespect toward those who possess moral discipline is a deed of Māra. Conforming to the training of the śrāvakas is a deed of Māra. Following those of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle is a deed of Māra. Wishing to reach the goal before its time is a deed of Māra. Abandoning great compassion and judging people by their family is a deed of Māra. Longing for the unconditioned is a deed of Māra. Disparaging the conditioned is a deed of Māra. A mind that

grows slack toward all that must be done for sentient beings is a deed of Māra. Dwelling in pride and not bowing to others, being double-tongued, being full of deceit and guile, delighting in pretense, being crooked, being harsh and coarse, not reproaching wrongdoing, uprooting the Dharma, being content with a mere little learning, pursuing what is not the Dharma, desiring what is not the Dharma, and not suppressing the obscurations, the fetters, and the outbursts of affliction, are deeds of Māra. Not examining the stains of the mind is a deed of Māra. Not dreading the stains that sully a renunciant is a deed of Māra. Son of noble family, whatever there is of entering into unwholesome qualities and abandoning wholesome qualities, all of that is a deed of Māra.

By four qualities one passes completely beyond these deeds of Māra. What are the four? They are these: the six perfections, in which the awakening mind is never forgotten; conscientiousness grounded in faith and diligence; bringing sentient beings to maturity while abiding in skill in means; and upholding the true Dharma while abiding in the profound way of the Dharma. Son of noble family, the bodhisattva who applies himself to the Dharma in this way has passed completely beyond the path of the four māras and has vanquished all māras and opponents.

Son of noble family, how does the bodhisattva gather immeasurable merit and become the sustenance of all sentient beings? Son of noble family, here the bodhisattva dwells in loving-kindness toward sentient beings. He dwells in compassion toward all living creatures. He dwells in the meditative concentrations without attachment to them. He gives away all his possessions to those who ask. Through his merits his wealth is inexhaustible. Through his pure intention he holds a jewel in his hand. Having no thought of high and low, his mind is like the earth. Through perfectly pure moral discipline his aspirations are fulfilled. Through performing every kind of offering and giving, his mind is free and his doors are never closed. Through discerning the Dharma he is rich in dhāraṇīs and eloquence. Through traveling to immeasurable buddha fields he abides in the wisdom of the higher knowledges.

He dedicates his roots of virtue thus: "Just as these four great external elements become the sustenance of all sentient beings, so may these four great inner elements of mine also become the sustenance of all sentient beings. May my roots of virtue, and whatever skill I have in knowing the Dharma, never fail to be the sustenance of all sentient beings." In this way the bodhisattva gathers immeasurable merit and becomes the sustenance of all

sentient beings.

Son of noble family, how is it that, even when no buddhas have appeared, the bodhisattva remains close to sentient beings through the activity of a buddha? Son of noble family, here the bodhisattva, knowing the working of what is possible and what is impossible, has completed the purification of the ten powers. Knowing the work of the exhaustion of the defilements, he has completed the purification of the four fearlessnesses. Knowing the work of the wisdom that is unattached in the three times, he has completed the purification of the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha. Having obtained the light of the buddha eye, he has completed the purification of the five eyes. Having attained the going to the seat of awakening, he has completed the purification of all the higher knowledges. Having completely cut off the habitual tendencies of the afflictions, he has completed the fulfillment of all wholesome qualities. Having gathered the entire accumulation of merit, he has completed the purification of the adornments of body, speech, and mind, and of the major marks and the excellent minor marks. Having obtained empowerment, he has completed the purification of the ten grounds. Having gathered the accumulation of wisdom, he has completed the purification of all the qualities of a buddha. Son of noble family, in this way, even when no buddhas have appeared, the bodhisattva remains close to sentient beings through the activity of a buddha.

Son of noble family, how does the bodhisattva attain the meditative absorption of the ocean seal (sāgaramudrā) and remain unattached to the minds and conduct of all sentient beings? Son of noble family, it is like this. For example, however many forms of sentient beings appear in Jambudvīpa, an imprint resembling every one of them is present in the great ocean. That is why it is called the great ocean.

In the same way, whatever appears in the minds of all sentient beings, whatever appears as form, and whatever appears as sound, all of it appears within the single field of vision of the bodhisattva who abides in the meditative absorption of the ocean seal. That is why it is called the meditative absorption of the ocean seal.

For example, the great ocean has a single taste. Likewise the bodhisattva, knowing the Dharma as having the taste of liberation, has a single taste. For example, the great ocean never misses its time. Likewise the bodhisattva, discerning what is timely and what is untimely, never misses the time for the

seat of awakening. For example, the great ocean does not abide together with corpses. Likewise the bodhisattva does not abide together with any of the afflictions of habitual tendency, nor with any of the attitudes of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. For example, the great ocean neither diminishes nor fills up, even when all waters are spent. Likewise the bodhisattva, even when all phenomena are spent, does not make the realm of phenomena diminish or fill up. For example, the great ocean is immeasurable in its extent. Likewise the bodhisattva is immeasurable in wisdom. For example, the great ocean is deep and its bottom is hard to fathom. Likewise the bodhisattva is deep, and his depths are hard for all the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas to fathom. For example, the great ocean is the home of immeasurable sentient beings. Likewise the bodhisattva is the home of immeasurable sentient beings to be brought to maturity. This is entering the meditative absorption of the ocean seal. Son of noble family, the bodhisattva who has entered it in this way is unattached to the minds and conduct of all sentient beings.

Son of noble family, how does the bodhisattva pass completely beyond all attachment? What is called attachment is the eruption of views about phenomena. Because the bodhisattva is free of every eruption of views, he passes completely beyond all attachment. For example, the wind does not cling anywhere in the midst of the sky. Likewise the bodhisattva, possessing a mind like the wind, does not cling to any sentient being.

Moreover, these holy beings know the ways of conduct and of right procedure. Here, right procedure is mindfulness, and conduct is freedom from distraction. They are also free of darkness and have obtained light. Here, what is called darkness is not knowing phenomena, and what is called light is unobstructed wisdom regarding phenomena. That is why they are said to be free of darkness and to have obtained light. These holy beings do not depend on others for wisdom, but have attained wisdom by themselves. And why is that? Because they abide fully in self-arisen wisdom and inspire other sentient beings to long for wisdom. When the bodhisattva, in this teaching on the wisdom that ascertains phenomena, does not depend on others but attains wisdom by himself, he will swiftly attain the wisdom of omniscience.

Then, at that time, the Blessed One spoke these verses:

One whose mind is secluded from all views,
The wise one who builds up the accumulation of merit,
Having wholly abandoned the arising of signs,

Dedicates it to awakening, and it will never be exhausted.

Having abandoned every pride, even the pride above pride,
He seeks out the accumulations of wisdom.
The one of boundless understanding, whose very nature is space,
Brings the wisdom of omniscience to perfection.

That child of the Victor recollects the Buddha
Not as qualities of form and marks.
Where mind and mentation do not move,
There he recollects the Buddha in harmony with what he is.

The Dharma is free of desire, by nature secluded,
Peaceful, utterly peaceful, forever signless.
That which is free of every object of reference:
That, here, is recollection of the Dharma.

The noble Saṅgha is wholly unconditioned,
Liberated as emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness.
In it there is no mind, no recollection, no engagement:
That is recollection of the Saṅgha.

Letting go of the aggregates entirely, he gives up everything;
He casts away well every thing of affliction;
Without conceit, without conception or discursive thought:
This is right recollection of giving.

Moral discipline is undefiled and unconditioned,
Not engaged in by body, speech, or mind,
Without arising, not abiding in the three realms of existence:
That is recollection of moral discipline.

The gods who are pure, stainless, and free of afflictions,
Who dwell in Tuṣita and have received empowerment:
Recollecting these pure beings,
He thinks, "I too shall soon become like them."

To uphold the true Dharma of the Tathāgata
Is not to grasp any thing of affliction.
Liberated from both Dharma and non-Dharma,
One such as this upholds the Dharma of the Victors.

The defining mark of awakening that the Victors found,
That defining mark of the Dharma, he fully upholds.
One who fully knows this stainless limit
Upholds the Dharma of all the buddhas.

The wise one who realizes that, the self being utterly pure,
Sentient beings are pure and all phenomena are pure,
Has a mind that is pure, by nature luminous,
And always brings beings to maturity in order to set them free.

He does not regard the realms of sentient beings as unworthy,
And sees no diminishing or filling in them.
He teaches the complete abandonment of wrong views.
One such as this purifies many sentient beings.

One who fully teaches all the domains of the world
Thereby fully teaches the domain of the Buddha as well.
The domain of the Buddha is equal to space,
And so he fully knows the domain of the world.

All sounds, speech, tones, and letters
He sees clearly to be like echoes,
And in them even a listener does not truly exist.
Knowing this fully, he obtains dhāraṇī.

Through retaining, holding, and reciting,
And fully explaining the ways of teaching the Dharma,
He has no conceit about self, beings, or phenomena.
That is abiding firmly in dhāraṇī.

Holding what all the Victors have taught,
Satisfying beings with what is well spoken,
Never parted from mindfulness and meditative absorption:
These are the qualities that mark dhāraṇī.

Because the Dharma is in every way without accumulation,
He neither withholds the Dharma nor fails to pour it forth.
Just as a nāga sends down streams of rain,
So he too sends down the rain of the Dharma.

The eloquence of those who are sources of good qualities,
Unobstructed, unbroken, never interrupted,
Expounds thousands of koṭis of sūtras,

Attuned to beings' faculties, yet with no perception of beings.

Through the Buddha's might, for thousands of koṭis of eons,
He teaches the Dharma without interruption
And satisfies beings according to their wishes:
By way of eloquence, he abides in the qualities of a buddha.

Whoever knows the way of all phenomena,
That all these phenomena are like space,
And does not grasp at a being, a life, or a person,
Upholds the true Dharma of the Victors.

All sentient beings are utterly in nirvāṇa;
Thus they are never born at all.
One whose patience is luminous like this
Is conscientious in this teaching.

He sees the aggregates truly as like an illusion,
Knows the elements to be just as the dharmadhātu is,
And sees the six faculties as like an empty village:
He passes completely beyond the māra of the aggregates.

The afflictions, like heaped-up banks of cloud,
He examines closely with conscientiousness and proper attention,
Neither conceptualizing nor discriminating phenomena:
He passes completely beyond the māra of the afflictions.

Whoever knows birth to be forever unborn,
That here no one transmigrates and no one goes,
And knows that phenomena neither come nor go,
Does not fall under the power of the māra, the Lord of Death.

Whoever neither wavers nor harbors conceit,
Who abides in awakening yet has no perception of awakening,
And engages in compassion though there is no self and no being,
Subdues Māra together with his army.

He sees consciousness and wisdom as equal,
Abiding neither in the conditioned nor in the unconditioned,
And sees the minds of beings as like an illusion:
He is a hero who is never overwhelmed.

Clinging neither to the far shore nor to the near,
He fits out well the boat that bears the Dharma.
He ferries beings across, yet has no perception of beings:
That bodhisattva is called the even-minded one.

He knows fully that the three realms of existence are like a wilderness
And will never become empty,
And by the stages of the path he ever ferries beings across:
He is the caravan leader who shows the way to the deathless.

That sage is skilled in what is fitting and what is not;
He knows fully that phenomena are empty from the very beginning,
And by method and reasoning leads beings into nirvāṇa:
That bodhisattva is called a guide.

The stream of mind becomes one thing and then another;
Mind never joins with mind.
Knowing fully these mind-streams of beings,
The bodhisattva is called the perfect guide.

Like the very nature of space and the moon in water,
All phenomena are pure and utterly pure;
Knowing this, he does not mingle with any affliction:
That pure being is beyond reproach.

Whoever, through a single principle, knows all phenomena
To be like an illusion or a mirage, not to be grasped,
Hollow, false, and impermanent,
Swiftly goes to the seat of awakening.

When this teaching on ascertaining the Dharma had been spoken, seventy-two niyutas of living beings, gods, humans, asuras, kinnaras, and mahoragas, gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Thirty-two thousand bodhisattvas attained acceptance of the unborn nature of phenomena. This great trichiliocosm, this world system of a billion worlds, shook in six ways, and a great light pervaded the world system. Hundreds of thousands of gods rained down showers of flowers and played cymbals, and they uttered this inspired utterance: "Those beings who hear this teaching and take faith in it, retain it, and apply themselves to it with diligence have entered the domain of the Buddha. The wise should adorn well with ornaments this whole buddha field in which the buddhas, the blessed ones, appear, and pay homage to it. And why? Because when a buddha has appeared, a Dharma

such as this is taught, and these holy beings endowed with inconceivable qualities will also be seen."

Then, because the Blessed One had answered his question, the bodhisattva, the great being Gaganagañja, was overjoyed. He offered up onto the body of the Blessed One a net of pearls, stainless and pure in its radiance, worth a whole trichiliocosm filled with treasure, and said to the Blessed One: "The wisdom of the buddhas, the blessed ones, is free of attachment and free of obscuration. This teaching is never interrupted. The Tathāgata sees the minds of all sentient beings and is skilled in the wisdom that knows superior and inferior faculties. By the Blessed One's teaching of such a form of Dharma, the minds of the whole assembly have been satisfied. This Great Vehicle has been proclaimed at length. And these bodhisattvas gathered from the world systems of the ten directions have been greatly enriched by a great light of Dharma. Since the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, has shown me too a door through which the Dharma arises, through that door I shall teach immeasurable doors through which the Dharma arises."

The Noble Questions of Gaganagañja, fascicle four.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being called Swift Eloquence, came to that same assembly. Seated there, he said to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, "Son of noble family, as for your being named Gaganagañja, Sky Treasury: is the sky your treasury?"

He replied, "Son of noble family, it is so. The sky is my treasury."

Swift Eloquence said, "Son of noble family, we too would like to see what the sky treasury is like."

Then the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, "Son of noble family, show the special qualities of the sky treasury."

Then the bodhisattva Gaganagañja said to the bodhisattva Swift Eloquence, "Son of noble family, whatever your mind desires, I shall make it rain down from the sky."

Then the bodhisattva Swift Eloquence thought: "In the world system called Padmavyūha, the realm of the Tathāgata Ratnotpalaśrī, there is a lotus called All-Illuminating Light. It is a krośa across, with many thousands of koṭis of soft and tender petals, pleasant to the touch like kācilindika cloth. Its fragrance pervades the buddha field; it has many hundreds of thousands of colors, and it is delightful to behold, so that one never tires of seeing it. I have seen how the

bodhisattvas there attain meditative absorption by seeing that lotus and smelling its fragrance. Let a rain of such lotuses fall on this assembly!"

The very moment the bodhisattva Swift Eloquence had this thought, by the blessing of the bodhisattva Gaganagañja a rain of such lotuses fell from the expanse of the sky. Then, by seeing those lotuses and sensing their fragrance, the whole assembly entered into the meditative absorption called Food of Joy. The whole assembly then arose from that absorption, bowed to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, and exclaimed, "Excellent, excellent are the blessing and the power of wisdom of this holy being! May all sentient beings also obtain such a blessing!"

Then the bodhisattva called Ratnavyūha arrived, and seated there he said to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, "Son of noble family, make a rain of gold dust fall from the sky." The moment the bodhisattva Ratnavyūha had spoken these words, a rain of gold dust fell from the sky at once.

Then the bodhisattva Ratnavyūha again said to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, "Son of noble family, make a rain of every kind of jewel fall from the sky." The moment he had spoken these words, from the ten directions there fell a great rain of countless, immeasurable jewels, each the size of Sumeru, of different names and different colors, namely: gold, silver, crystal, beryl, emerald, red pearl, agate, gems crested with śrīgarbha, stainless gems, precious coral, moonlight gems, fire crystals, illuminating gems, supreme light gems, Jambudvīpa light gems, firelight gems, conch, quartz, coral, sapphire, sources of good qualities, gems of utterly peaceful light, water light gems, water-colored gems, water-clearing gems, earth light gems, indestructible abode gems, gems the eye cannot bear, gems borne by Śakra, victory gems, great victory gems, gems of blazing splendor, kings of śrīgarbha, vajra-crested gems, world-illuminating gems, star-delight gems, light-holding gems, crescent gems, Jambū river light gems, gems with the light of Jambudvīpa, gems possessing a thousand lights, meteor gate gems, fire-radiance gems, gems adorned by the Victors, heat-soothing gems, distress-free gems, illness-dispelling gems, eye-purifying gems, ear-, nose-, tongue-, body-, and mind-purifying gems, limb-illuminating gems, gems of illuminating light, blue light gems, yellow light gems, white gems, crystal-colored gems, nets of jewels, and gems that gather all jewels together. A rain of jewels bearing such names, and of jewels not of these names, fell down. The names of those precious gems could not easily be exhausted even in an eon.

Then the bodhisattva called King of Time said to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, "Son of noble family, in this Sahā world system there are sentient beings who suffer and are poor, who have no food or drink, who are naked without clothing or wear only rags. There are pretas gripped by hunger and thirst, naked and covered only by their own hair, who long to eat spittle, snot, blood, and pus. To protect such beings as these, make a rain of food, drink, and clothing fall."

Immediately, by the blessing of the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, a rain of all kinds of food fell: foods to eat, foods to chew, foods to savor, and foods to lick. Broths of a hundred flavors and every kind of drink poured down in streams as thick as a chariot's axle. A rain of clothing fell, of many colors, of varied colors, of many hundreds of thousands of colors, fine and soft and pleasant to the touch like kācilindika cloth. Then all the destitute, all the poor, and all the pretas in the great trichiliocosm, this world system of a billion worlds, were satisfied.

Then the bodhisattva called King of Physicians said to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, "Son of noble family, for the sake of those sentient beings who are sick, who have no one to tend them and are struck by many illnesses, make a great rain of medicine fall, by which all the sick will be completely freed from illness." Immediately a rain of the medicine of amṛta, the nectar of immortality, poured down from the sky, and by it they were completely freed from every illness.

Then the bodhisattva called Abandoner of the Lower Realms said to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, "Son of noble family, bring peace to the three lower realms." Immediately light streamed forth from the sky, and all the beings in the hells, those born as animals, and the beings in the world of Yama who were touched by that light became filled with happiness. All three lower realms were completely pacified.

In the same way, everything used in practicing giving and generosity poured down as rain from the sky: flowers, garlands, incense, unguents, powders, robes, parasols, banners, pennants, and the like; the five kinds of music and the melodies of song; male servants and female servants, wives, boys and girls, attendants, horses, oxen, chariots, small retinues, and mounts; houses, villages, towns, cities, market towns, districts, provinces, royal palaces with their grounds, pleasure groves, rooftop pavilions, many-storied buildings, mansions, porticoes, windows, half-moon ornaments, thrones, and palanquins; and carriages drawn by four oxen, by sixteen oxen, and on up to chariots

drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses.

Then the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, having blessed things in this way, said to the great gathering of bodhisattvas, "Sons of noble family, take these things and give them away! Give them away completely, and bring the perfection of generosity to completion!"

Then the bodhisattva called Ornament of Moral Discipline said to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, "Son of noble family, now that you have rained down the rain of the perfection of generosity, rain down the rain of the perfection of moral discipline as well." The moment he had spoken these words, there came forth from the sky the sound of praise of the qualities of moral discipline, as many praises as the buddhas and bodhisattvas in the ten directions have spoken of the ornament of the qualities of moral discipline. Likewise, the sounds of the qualities of patience, diligence, meditative concentration, and wisdom came forth from the sky: all the sounds of Dharma with which the buddhas and bodhisattvas in the ten directions teach hundreds of thousands of doors of Dharma through letters, explanations, and conventional terms, all of them, complete and entire, without anything missing, added, or altered. That sound of Dharma was made understood throughout the whole of this great trichiliocosm, this world system of a billion worlds. Then immeasurable, countless sentient beings were brought to maturity in the three vehicles.

Then the bodhisattva called Universal Light thought, "Does this display arranged by the bodhisattva Gaganagañja exist only in this world, or does it exist in other world systems as well?" The bodhisattva Gaganagañja knew with his mind the thought in the mind of the bodhisattva Universal Light, and knowing it, he said to the bodhisattva Universal Light, "Son of noble family, since you have obtained the utterly stainless and utterly pure divine eye, son of noble family, look and see what you behold in the world systems of the ten directions."

Then the bodhisattva Universal Light looked with his divine eye into the world systems of the ten directions. He saw that in countless, immeasurable buddha fields of the ten directions, just as here in this world system a rain of every kind of jewel had poured down and every sound of Dharma had resounded, so too in those buddha fields such deeds were taking place, without anything missing, added, or altered.

Then the bodhisattva Universal Light was filled with wonder and uttered this inspired utterance: "The blessing of the aspiration accomplished by the bodhisattva Gaganagañja is inconceivable! Everywhere, in all the buddha fields at once, this holy being has rained down such a rain!"

Then, through the might of the Buddha and the blessing of the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, that entire assembly saw those buddha fields where the rain of jewels and the rain of Dharma were pouring down. And through the bodhisattva Gaganagañja's display of this miracle of the rain of jewels and the rain of Dharma, sentient beings beyond counting gave rise to the mind set on awakening.

Then five hundred widows came out of Rājagṛha, went to where the bodhisattva Gaganagañja was, and on arriving said to him, "Holy being, since you fulfill the wishes of all sentient beings, grant us husbands too!"

Immediately, by the blessing of the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, five hundred men descended from the sky, with the very complexion, features, and build of those women's former husbands, and they sat down before the bodhisattva Gaganagañja. Then the bodhisattva Gaganagañja said to those women, "Sisters, each of you take your own husband, just as he was." Then each of those women took her own husband, and delighted, joyful, glad, and overjoyed, their hearts filled with happiness, they went to their own homes. Then for seven days those emanated men brought the women to maturity in such a way that they became irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Then those five hundred women came again before the bodhisattva Gaganagañja and spoke these verses:

"The nature of phenomena is empty, like an illusion;
We did not know before this defining character of phenomena.
So you gave us husbands who were emanations,
And through them we have been ripened for the supreme vehicle.

All these phenomena are truly emanations,
Unmoving, without an agent, empty from the beginning.
We have fully realized undefiled wisdom,
And from now on we shall not fall under the power of the afflictions.

We shall give rise to the mind of supreme awakening;
We shall care for all sentient beings as our guests.

Just as you rained down abundance on beings,
We too shall rain down the rain of the supreme Dharma."

The Sage, the supreme guide, prophesied of them:
"In time to come, all of you,
Having practiced the conduct, will become lords among victors,
Sugatas called Sudānta, the Utterly Tamed."

Again, at that time, five hundred men who had been sentenced to death were being led off to be executed. From the sky they heard a voice say, "Beings, there is one called the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, who gives fearlessness to beings who are afraid. Pay homage to him, and you will be freed from this execution." Then all of them, terrified and afraid of death, cried out with one voice, "Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being Gaganagañja!" The moment they had spoken these words, in that very instant five hundred men descended from the sky, came there, and said to the executioners, "What is the use of killing these poor men? Take our clothes and ornaments, cut off our lives, and let these men go!" Because the executioners were overcome by greed, they released those five hundred condemned men and killed the emanated men instead.

Then those men who had been released from execution, having found relief from their fear and terror of being killed, went to where the bodhisattva Gaganagañja was. When they arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One, and they also joined their palms and paid homage to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, and spoke these words: "Holy being, since you have restored our lives and our breath, please give us a teaching of the Dharma by which, if we apply ourselves to it diligently, we will engage in what benefits ourselves and what benefits others."

The bodhisattva Gaganagañja said, "Sons of good family, give rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. In this way you will engage in benefiting yourselves and benefiting others."

When he had said this to them, they gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. The bodhisattva Gaganagañja then gave them a pair of cotton cloths worth a hundred thousand, saying, "Friends, offer this pair of cotton cloths to the Tathāgata." All of them draped that pair of cotton cloths over the body of the Tathāgata, and the Blessed One prophesied of all of them: "When countless eons have passed, having perfectly

accomplished the ways of the factors of awakening, they will each appear in the world as a tathāgata named Bestower of Fearlessness."

Then the venerable Śāriputra said to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, "Son of good family, how long has it been since you placed a treasury in the sky that does not dry up, is not exhausted, and does not diminish?"

Gaganagañja said, "Venerable Śāriputra, what do you think? Does the sky dry up, or is it exhausted, or does it diminish?"

He replied, "No indeed, son of good family."

He said, "Venerable Śāriputra, in the same way, awakening has the characteristic of the essential nature of space, and I have dedicated my roots of virtue to it. Therefore the treasury in the sky does not dry up, is not exhausted, and does not diminish. And as for your asking how long it has been since I placed a treasury in the sky: it has been as long as it has been since I gave rise to the mind set on awakening."

He asked, "Son of good family, how long has it been since you gave rise to the mind set on awakening?"

He replied, "The Blessed One knows it with his knowledge."

Then the elder Śāriputra said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, how long has it been since the bodhisattva Gaganagañja gave rise to the mind set on awakening?"

The Blessed One said, "Śāriputra, if the Tathāgata were to reveal this matter, the world with its gods would be bewildered."

He said, "Blessed One, in this assembly there are beings of great discernment who will come to have faith, so please explain it."

The Blessed One said, "Śāriputra, suppose, for example, that world systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges were completely filled with particles as numerous as the atoms in as many buddhafields as there are grains of sand in the river Ganges. Then, for as many atoms as there are, suppose one set down a single tiny particle every hundred thousand eons, counting them in this way and marking them. All those tiny particles would be used up, yet the hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of incalculable eons since the bodhisattva Gaganagañja gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening would by no means be used up."

Śāriputra asked, "Blessed One, what was the name of that tathāgata in whose presence the bodhisattva Gaganagañja first gave rise to the mind set on awakening?"

The Blessed One said, "Śāriputra, at that time, on that occasion, in the eon called Ratnavyūha, in the world system called Displaying All Buddhafields, there appeared in the world the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, the buddha, the blessed one named King Exalted in Jewel Splendor Who Has Far Surpassed All Aspirations. Moreover, Śāriputra, the arrayed qualities of that tathāgata's buddhafield would not be easy to describe even for one who lived for an eon.

"Śāriputra, the assembly of that tathāgata extended the size of a thousand world systems, and his Saṅgha of bodhisattvas was beyond counting. Śāriputra, at that time there was in that world system a universal monarch who ruled a great trichiliocosm, named Consecrated by All the Gods, and his treasuries of jewels were inconceivable. He had ninety-six thousand sons, born miraculously and brought forth by their own splendor. Why was this? Because in that buddhafield even the word 'woman' did not exist. Śāriputra, the lifespan of that tathāgata lasted a hundred thousand eons.

"Then King Consecrated by All the Gods served and honored that Blessed One for forty intermediate eons, and he served and honored him in such a way that in a single day the heaps of jewels he laid out as offerings would be equal to thousands of koṭis of Mount Sumerus. Then that king, steadfast in merit, together with his host of sons, the people of his towns, and his retinues, gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

"Śāriputra, if you think that the universal monarch called Consecrated by All the Gods at that time, on that occasion, was someone else, do not view it so. Why? Because at that time, on that occasion, the bodhisattva Gaganagañja was the universal monarch of a great trichiliocosm called Consecrated by All the Gods."

Then the venerable Śāriputra said to the Blessed One, "Oh! This bodhisattva Gaganagañja has donned an inconceivable armor. Blessed One, it is wonderful that he has been so long set out upon the vehicle. Blessed One, through conduct such as this one is able to gain such great power of the Dharma."

The Blessed One said, "Śāriputra, this bodhisattva Gaganagañja served and honored buddhas, blessed ones, as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges, and he thoroughly refined the awakening mind. Through awakening minds as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges being completely purified, he thoroughly refined his intention. Through intentions as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges being completely purified, he thoroughly refined his application. Through applications as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges being completely purified, he thoroughly refined his superior intention. Through superior intentions as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges being completely purified, he thoroughly refined the perfection of generosity. Through perfections of generosity as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges being completely purified, he thoroughly refined the perfection of moral discipline. Through perfections of moral discipline as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges being completely purified, he thoroughly refined the perfection of patience. Through perfections of patience as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges being completely purified, he thoroughly refined the perfection of diligence. Through perfections of diligence as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges being completely purified, he thoroughly refined the perfection of meditative concentration. Through perfections of meditative concentration as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges being completely purified, he thoroughly refined the perfection of wisdom. Through perfections of wisdom as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges being completely purified, he thoroughly refined the perfection of skillful means. Through perfections of skillful means as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges being completely purified, he thoroughly refined a mind without anger toward any sentient being, and unobstructed rays of light. Through minds without anger toward any sentient being, and unobstructed rays of light, as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges being completely purified, he thoroughly refined great loving-kindness, and so on, up to great compassion, great joy, great equanimity, and the wisdom of the great superknowledges.

"In the same way there is complete purity of body, complete purity of speech, and complete purity of mind; and through purities of mind as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges being completely purified, he thoroughly refined a single mark of a great being. Applying this in the same way to all thirty-two marks of a great being, and so on, up to the roots of virtue that

come from the complete purity of all the marks of a great being: through roots of virtue beyond the number of grains of sand in the river Ganges being completely purified, this bodhisattva Gaganagañja thoroughly refined this sky treasury so that it is completely pure.

"Śāriputra, this bodhisattva Gaganagañja displays all the conduct of a bodhisattva from the sky. Śāriputra, just as the sky is inexhaustible, so too, because all the aspirations and conduct of this son of good family are completely pure, they are never exhausted in anything at all. Therefore he is called Gaganagañja."

When this teaching was spoken, ten thousand bodhisattvas gained inexhaustible wealth, jewels in their hands, and the acceptance that fulfills the aspiration for the sky treasury.

Then the bodhisattva called Dharmarāja said to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, "Son of good family, we would listen to the treasury of the Dharma proclaimed from the sky."

Gaganagañja said, "Then, son of good family, sit with respect and reverence, and regard this sky as the Teacher, and you will hear the treasury of the Dharma to be heard."

Then the bodhisattva Dharmarāja and that whole assembly joined their palms, paid homage to the sky, and sat down. Then, through the blessing of the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, these verses came forth from the sky:

"Of minds that are like the sky,
And of whatever is the way of all dharmas,
Through a thorough teaching that leads into them,
Listen, all of you, in due order.

In the sky there is nothing high,
And nothing low exists there either;
Where the very nature has no high or low,
How could there be any bowing down?

In the sky there is no arising,
And no cessation is found there either;
Toward phenomena that are unborn
There is no conceptual thought.

In the sky there is no lessening,
And no filling is found there either;

Phenomena are neither filled nor lessened;
They are equal and the same as the sky.

In the sky there is no darkness;
It is not dimmed by that.
Because the nature of mind is luminous,
It is never dimmed at all.

The rays of the sun and moon
Do not make the sky rejoice;
So too, minds that are like the sky
Are not elated by anything.

Even when two-pointed spears rain down,
The sky is not afflicted;
So too, through all the doors of suffering,
The heirs of the Victor are not afflicted.

Through timely rains of nectar
The sky does not become delighted;
Through all gain and honor
The bodhisattva is not delighted.

Toward praise and toward blame
The sky has no thought at all;
So too, in pleasure and in pain,
The bodhisattva is steadfast and unmoved.

Even when the earth is shaken,
The sky is never moved;
Though these worlds shake and are in turmoil,
The bodhisattva is not disturbed.

When the eon of burning comes,
Just as the sky is not burned,
So too, by all the afflictions,
The steadfast bodhisattva is not tormented.

Without arising and without taming,
Just as the sky abides,
Phenomena neither go nor come;
They abide in the realm of phenomena (dharmadhātu).

Whatever appears as form
All comes forth from the sky;
Whatever appears as phenomena
Comes forth from the realm of phenomena.

Signless and formless,
The sky is not something to be seen;
If minds are thoroughly known in this way,
They are equal and the same as the sky.

The sky is a mere name;
It has no color and no shape.
Mind, mentation, and consciousness too
Are fully indicated by names alone."

"Just as the sky has no limit
And cannot be grasped anywhere at all,
So too, wisdom of great power
Is equal to and the same as the sky.

Though beings travel through the sky,
No trace of their going is found there;
Though beings practice for the sake of awakening,
That is no sign of practice.

Just as the body of the past
Is like and similar to the sky,
So too, the essential nature of the aggregates
Is equal to and the same as the sky.

The four elements too are declared
To be like and similar to the sky;
And thus, even in the eon of burning,
This element is the same as the sky.

Just as all sentient beings together
Could never fill the sky completely,
So too, all the objects of the senses
Can never fill the mindstream.

What the Protector of the World proclaimed
With great words, with the lion's roar,
That wisdom which transcends the world,

Is displayed in this teaching.

Just as, because the sky is vast,
Its end can never be found,
So too, of the qualities of the Buddha
No end can ever be found.

All phenomena are the Buddha:
Those who know their reality in this way
Neither destroy entities
Nor abide in entities.

Fully knowing entities and nonentities,
Those who abide in the limit of reality,
The wise, hold to no view
Of entities or of nonentities.

Emptiness is proclaimed in sound,
Yet in sound there is no emptiness;
It is soundless and beyond expression,
And therefore it is called emptiness.

Though all the buddhas speak of it,
Emptiness cannot be expressed;
And even what is called empty,
Its meaning cannot be expressed.

Through explanations such as illusions,
Mirages, dreams, apparitions,
And echoes,
The Guides teach the Dharma.

In order to guide sentient beings,
All the examples are fully shown;
Yet in phenomena utterly at peace
No remedies are to be found.

All phenomena without characteristics
Are taught as having characteristics;
The characterized and the uncharacterized
Are not found in the realm of phenomena.

The characterized has the characteristic of space,
And space, too, has no characteristic.
Those who fully realize this way
Are bodhisattvas.

Without attachment and without bondage,
Utterly without anything at all,
Unelaborated and free of elaboration:
That one is called a bodhisattva.

Not liberated apart from sentient beings,
Yet not abiding in sentient beings either,
Through the wisdom of the nature of beings,
That one is called a bodhisattva.

Hearing that beings have utterly passed beyond sorrow,
They do not become terrified;
For those who have truly set out for awakening,
This is the armor of the heroes.

Though a magician conjures up
Many beings and kills them there,
In that there is no killing at all;
The characteristic of beings is just so.

Illusions and sentient beings,
Nirvāṇa and all the buddhas,
Are in every way of a single nature;
Their nature is realized as without nature.

From the sky, the sky treasury,
The inexhaustible treasury, is accomplished;
It brings satisfaction to all sentient beings,
And that treasury is never exhausted.

By rivers of immeasurable merit
This treasury has been purified;
Without moving away from phenomena,
One should see phenomena as their true nature.

If one fully knows all phenomena
That arise in dependence on causes,
One's treasury is inexhaustible;

The treasury of the Dharma is inconceivable.

The Protector of the World declared
These four things to be inexhaustible:
Sentient beings, space, the awakening mind,
And likewise the qualities of the Buddha.

If these were substances,
They would be completely exhausted;
Because they do not exist they are inexhaustible,
And therefore they are declared inexhaustible.

Phenomena are utterly momentary;
Phenomena that perish are inexhaustible;
In the inexhaustible there is no exhaustion,
And therefore it is called inexhaustible.

Whatever bodhisattva
Fully understands this teaching of the Dharma
Will not find awakening hard to gain;
He has truly set out for awakening."

When this teaching in verse had come forth, a hundred thousand bodhisattvas attained acceptance of the nonarising of phenomena, and twelve thousand gods seated in the midst of the sky gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Then a bodhisattva called Full of Wonder, who had gathered in that very assembly and was seated there, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, I am amazed, wondering where this sound has come from."

The Blessed One said, "Son of good family, ask the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, and he will answer you."

Then the bodhisattva Full of Wonder said to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, "Son of good family, I am filled with wonder, wondering where this sound has come from."

Gaganagañja said, "Son of good family, what do you think? Where does the sound of an echo come from?"

He replied, "Son of good family, the sound of an echo arises from the perception of another sound."

He said, "Son of good family, does an echo have any body, or mind, or form, or color, or shape?"

He replied, "Son of good family, it has none."

He said, "Son of good family, it is just so. Just as an echo, though not established at all, makes sounds and speech understood, so too the sky, not established at all, comes to make sounds and speech understood."

He asked, "Son of good family, who makes this sound understood? From where does this voice come?"

He replied, "Son of good family, the discerning awareness of wisdom is inconceivable. Whatever I think with the intention of my mind comes forth from this space; yet the mind does not go there, and that does not come here, and still the echo of the sound arises. Son of good family, see how profound dependent origination is! Although a result arises from a cause, the cause does not pass over into the accomplished result; nor does a result arise without a cause. That is to say, in this phenomenon of a result produced from causes and conditions, there is no movement in either of them, and there is no agent. Those who have such a perception are free. Why is that? Because the Blessed One has also said that whatever is affliction, the very knowing of it is its purification. Purification does not come about by removing affliction; rather, the characteristic of the essential nature of affliction is itself purification. That is to say, both of these, affliction and purification, are conventional terms. At the ultimate limit, neither affliction nor purification can be found."

"The ultimate limit is not a limit, and what is not a limit is called the limit of reality. What is the limit of reality is the limit of emptiness. What is the limit of emptiness is the limit of self. What is the limit of self is the limit of all phenomena. Why is that? Because all phenomena are that limit: the limit of emptiness, the limit of complete peace. Whoever is not attached to the gateway of these three limits finds the wisdom that is unattached to all phenomena."

Then the elder Śāriputra said to the bodhisattva Full of Wonder, "Son of good family, who gave you the name Full of Wonder?"

He replied, "Venerable Śāriputra, wherever you have interest and diligence in the Dharma, do you not find wonder there?"

He said, "Son of good family, it is so."

He replied, "Venerable Śāriputra, in the same way, wherever I have interest and diligence in all phenomena, there I am full of wonder, thinking, 'When will I bring all the qualities of a buddha to perfection?' That is why I am called Full of Wonder. I find wonder in all the conduct of a bodhisattva. I find wonder in the knowledge that enters into the minds and conduct of all sentient beings, and that is why I am called Full of Wonder. There is no wisdom at all in which I do not find wonder, and there is no entry at all in which I do not, and that is why I am called Full of Wonder. Wherever I find wonder, there is no opening for any affliction or for any deed of Māra, and that is why I am called Full of Wonder."

Then the elder Śāriputra said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, all the qualities of a buddha are expressed through this very name of this holy being. Though he teaches all the qualities of a buddha, he is attached to nothing at all. It is wonderful that, without attachment, he teaches all the qualities of a buddha."

Then the bodhisattva called Ratnaśrī, who had gathered in that very assembly and was seated there, said to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, "Son of good family, taking your teaching on samādhi as your starting point, please speak with eloquence about how samādhi is to be purified."

When he had said this, the bodhisattva Gaganagañja said to the bodhisattva Ratnaśrī, "Son of good family, bodhisattvas have a samādhi called Pure Intention Going Unobstructed to the Seat of Awakening. Son of good family, bodhisattvas have a samādhi called Light Rays Free of Anger Toward All Sentient Beings; because it protects oneself and others, through it one passes completely beyond all harm from others.

"The samādhi called Stainless makes the mind completely pure. The samādhi called Vairocana makes all virtuous qualities increase. The samādhi called Virtuous brings freedom from turbidity. The samādhi called Exalted makes the crown of the head impossible to see. The samādhi called Dispelling tames all afflictions. The samādhi called Coiling brings the path of the right side to completion. The samādhi called Turning Back turns one away from causes and views. The samādhi called Delighting brings delight and devotion in the pleasure grove of the Dharma. The samādhi called Following the Stars makes one a completely pure recipient of offerings. The samādhi called Fierce Might keeps the mind from shrinking back. The samādhi called Entering Sameness and Equality makes the mind equal toward all sentient beings. The samādhi called Entering Activity brings entry into the ripening of karma. The samādhi

called Lion's Crest brings freedom from fear and from hair standing on end. The samādhi called Hero makes all the māras of affliction afraid. The samādhi called White Lotus makes one unstained by all the world. The samādhi called Padmavyūha becomes an ornament of the mind. The samādhi called Array of Light illuminates all the buddhafields. The samādhi called Accomplishing Tasks brings the abandonment of attachment and anger. The samādhi called Armlet on the Crest of the Banner brings illumination in all the qualities of the buddhas. The samādhi called Possessing Shooting Stars destroys all habitual tendencies. The samādhi called Lamp of the Sun brings freedom from darkness and gloom. The samādhi called Coiling Sun lets one look into the minds of all sentient beings. The samādhi called Source of Qualities makes one follow all good qualities. The samādhi called Like Nārāyaṇa defeats all opponents. The samādhi called Following the Essence makes the vajra body indestructible. The samādhi called Possessing the Essence brings all theses under one's command. The samādhi called Vajra Maṇḍala keeps one from losing the superknowledges. The samādhi called Vajra Essence brings one to the seat of awakening. The samādhi called Vajra-like brings full realization of all phenomena. The samādhi called Possessing Conduct becomes the wisdom that enters into the minds and conduct of all sentient beings. The samādhi called Earth-Holder brings freedom from desire and aversion. The samādhi called Crushing the Maṇḍala of Māra brings one completely beyond the four māras. The samādhi called Dissolving the Body dissolves all forms. The samādhi called Unflinching makes the mind one-pointed."

"The samādhi called Entering Aspects makes all objects of focus completely pure. The samādhi called Free of Affliction brings one completely beyond all objects of focus. The samādhi called Stainless Wheel makes the wheel of Dharma completely pure. The samādhi called Lightning Light lets one observe the momentary perishing of the mind. The samādhi called Victorious Through Good Deeds brings all virtuous qualities to completion. The samādhi called Purifying brings the abandonment of all nonvirtuous qualities. The samādhi called Ornament of the Body brings the major marks and the excellent minor marks to completion. The samādhi called Ornament of Speech delights the minds of all sentient beings by proclaiming with the voice of Brahmā. The samādhi called Ornament of the Mind keeps one from falling away from samādhi. The samādhi called Steadfast makes one irreversible. The samādhi called Giving Equally makes one draw no distinctions among sentient beings. The samādhi called Accumulation of Moral Discipline brings all aspirations to

fulfillment. The samādhi called Donning the Armor of Patience makes one disregard body and life. The samādhi called Steadfast Diligence makes the superknowledges swift. The samādhi called Immeasurable Aspects brings mastery over the Brahmā states. The samādhi called Nothingness thoroughly purifies the formless realm. The samādhi called Banner of Mount Meru outshines all sentient beings. The samādhi called Lamp of Mount Meru lets one survey the ten directions. The samādhi called Meteor of Wisdom dispels all obscurations, hindrances, and outbursts of affliction. The samādhi called Seal of the Ocean brings entry into various works and activities. The samādhi called Infinite Coiling cuts through all views. The samādhi called Emptiness brings the abandonment of all objectification and all views. The samādhi called Signlessness brings the abandonment of all thinking, conceptualizing, and imagining. The samādhi called Wishlessness brings all aspirations to fulfillment. The samādhi called Unmoving destroys all movement and volition. The samādhi called Possessing Sound brings unobstructed eloquence. The samādhi called All-Retaining makes one retain everything one has heard. The samādhi called Pure Mindfulness makes one seek all the qualities of a buddha with an immeasurable vessel. The samādhi called Inexhaustible brings satisfaction to all sentient beings. The samādhi called Ratnavyūha makes one obtain jewels in one's hands. The samādhi called Following makes one know the minds of all sentient beings. The samādhi called Entering the Destinies brings understanding of all destinies. The samādhi called Entering Intelligence makes mind and mentation completely pure. The samādhi called Possessing Clouds makes the rain of the Dharma pour down according to each one's inclination. The samādhi called Recollection of the Buddha brings attainment of the deathless Dharma. The samādhi called Recollection of the Dharma brings direct realization of the Dharma free from desire. The samādhi called Recollection of the Saṅgha keeps one from turning back from the qualities of a buddha. The samādhi called Recollection of Giving brings the complete relinquishing of all the aggregates. The samādhi called Recollection of Moral Discipline establishes one firmly in the root of the qualities of all the buddhas. The samādhi called Recollection of the Gods makes one blameless in pure qualities. The samādhi called Entering the Realm of Phenomena makes one fully inclined toward all phenomena. The samādhi called Nature of Space brings nonattachment to all phenomena. The samādhi called Unborn by Nature brings attainment of acceptance of the nonarising of phenomena. The samādhi called Understanding the Sequential and the Nonsequential brings mastery of skill in knowing the distinctions of all letters and words. And there

is the samādhi called Seal of Thorough Refinement and Stainlessness: a bodhisattva endowed with this samādhi fully awakens to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening through wisdom joined with a single instant of mind.

"Son of good family, these are the eighty gateways of samādhi, and each of these samādhis also has a retinue of five hundred gateways of samādhi. All of these together make forty thousand samādhis, and through affliction and purification these become eighty thousand samādhis. Through the past, the future, and the present, these become eighty-four thousand samādhis of inexhaustible wisdom. As many samādhis as there are, so many are the gateways of the Dharma, and so many are the heaps of the Dharma. Therefore it is said that the Tathāgata taught eighty-four thousand heaps of the Dharma in order to engage with the eighty-four thousand kinds of conduct of sentient beings.

"Son of good family, this is a sūtra of the Dharma for making sentient beings know the entry into the wisdom and conduct of the buddhas. The entry into the entire wisdom of the buddhas and the entire conduct of sentient beings is immeasurable and inconceivable; even if one remained for eight thousand eons, it would not be easy to explain."

When this wisdom of the buddhas had been fully taught and these gateways of meditative absorption had been explained, sixteen thousand bodhisattvas attained acceptance that phenomena are unborn, brought about through meditative absorption and wisdom. Eighty-four thousand sons of the gods set their minds on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Then the Blessed One gave his approval to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, saying "Excellent!": "Holy being, your teaching of this gateway of meditative absorption is well spoken. Excellent, excellent is this thorough teaching, this full proclamation of the wisdom of the Tathāgata, just as it is, concerning the dharmas that one witnesses directly with one's own body and does not leave to the authority of others."

The Questions of the Noble Gaganagañja, the fifth section.

Then the bodhisattva Ratnaśrī said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, in the presence of which tathāgata did the bodhisattva Gaganagañja first bring down from the sky a rain of every kind of jewel?"

When he had asked this, the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Ratnaśrī: "Son of good family, long ago in the past, beyond countless eons, and further

still beyond that, at that time, on that occasion, there appeared in the world, in the world system called Girdle, during the eon called Guṇaprabha, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, charioteer who tames beings, unsurpassed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called King of the Rays of Stainless Infinite Light.

"Moreover, son of good family, that world system called Girdle was prosperous, happy, rich in harvests and flourishing, filled with many people and humans, adorned with the seven precious substances, soft and supple, pleasant to the touch like kācilindika cloth, strewn with lotuses of Jambūnada gold, decorated with various brilliant jewels, laid out in a checkerboard pattern, and level like the palm of the hand. That world system was, for example, like the enjoyments and the way of life of the gods who control others' emanations (Paranirmitavaśavartin). All its people lived in celestial palaces and multistoried houses, and food and drink came to them in abundance at a mere thought.

"Moreover, son of good family, the Tathāgata King of the Rays of Stainless Infinite Light had a great saṅgha of bodhisattvas numbering sixty trillion bodhisattvas.

"Moreover, son of good family, at that time, on that occasion, there appeared a wheel-turning king called Puṇyālaṃkāra, possessed of the seven precious things. Moreover, son of good family, the palace of King Puṇyālaṃkāra was built in the center of Jambudvīpa. It extended four leagues to the east, and four leagues each to the west, the south and the north. It was splendid and beautiful to behold, made of the seven precious substances, and adorned with five hundred pleasure groves.

"Moreover, son of good family, King Puṇyālaṃkāra had eighty-four thousand queens, every one of them the finest woman of her land. He had eighty-four thousand sons, every one of them possessing the strength and might of a great champion.

"Moreover, son of good family, King Puṇyālaṃkāra had two precious queens. One was named Śrītejas, and the other was named Śrīprabhā. When King Puṇyālaṃkāra had entered the pleasure grove called Array of Joy and was staying among his queens, two boys appeared from the laps of those two queens. They were born miraculously, perfect in their former training, with their aspirations fulfilled, and fully set out toward unsurpassed, perfect and

complete awakening. One was named Siṃha, and the other was named Siṃhavikrāntagāmin. As soon as the two had appeared, they spoke these verses to their father Puṇyālaṃkāra, with one voice and one melody:

"Virtue and nonvirtue done in the past are not wasted;
Offerings made to the Tathāgata are not wasted;
The resolve, the mind of awakening, is not wasted either;
Learning that puts practice first is not wasted.
Giving, taming and restraint are not wasted;
Patience and gentleness are not wasted either.
Because one is grateful and does virtuous deeds,
The diligence one has undertaken is not wasted either.
One-pointed meditative concentration, a mind set on liberation,
Certain realization and a mind of wisdom do not decline.
Acts done through primordial wisdom are never disturbed,
And through undisturbed qualities awakening is not hard to find.
Such a one is not stained by the afflictions;
Such a one will not dwell again in a womb,
But is born miraculously in the heart of a lotus,
Unstained, like a lotus by the water.
From the Victor in the eastern quarter, the king of healers,
The Sugata Stainless Light, of supreme primordial wisdom unattached to the three times,
From his presence we have come here,
Because we long for the Dharma.
Just as with the udumbara flower,
The appearance of a tathāgata is hard to find.
In order to serve and honor him and to behold him,
Father, please go as well into the Sugata's presence."

When the king had heard this counsel,
Together with his sons, his queens and his retinue,
Surrounded by a thousand koṭis of living beings,
He went into the presence of that Victor.
With flowers and fragrances, along with ointments,
He made offerings to him in fitting manner,
Bowed at his feet and circumambulated him,
And with palms joined, bowing, sat before him.
Siṃha and Siṃhavikrāntagāmin as well

Took hold of the Tathāgata's feet,
Touched them with their heads, and the noble one,
Wise in the Dharma and its meaning, spoke these verses:

"You are refuge, protector and ally;
You have become a lamp for those in the world who are blind.
You are skilled in the thoughts and conduct of sentient beings,
And you establish them according to their inclinations.
This king delights in wealth and comfort,
Bound by form, by sound and by smell.
He never comes near even to make offerings to the Teacher;
How then would he listen to the Dharma?
Protector, please give rise to compassion,
So that all of them, having heard it together,
Will never turn back from the supreme vehicle:
Teach well that supreme path of awakening."

The Blessed One, the Protector, rose into the sky
To the height of eighty palm trees, and remaining there he spoke to that lord of men:
"King, listen to my supreme Dharma,
And having heard it, apply it properly and earnestly.
Desires are impermanent, and so are kingship and life;
Life is like a drop of dew on the grass.
Affection likewise, and the pleasures of desire, are like a dream;
What wise person would take delight in them?
No sentient being is ever sated by desires;
Again and again they thirst for desires and wander on.
The childish never know satiety and dwell among objects;
Those who are sated with wisdom are fully satisfied.
Just as an illusion deceives and has no essence,
So too the five aggregates are like an illusion.
These elements are taught to be like poisonous snakes;
The six senses are like an empty village.
Sons and wife, kingdom and country
Are no companions for one about to die.
Giving, taming, complete restraint and the whole of moral discipline:
These are the companions for going to the world beyond.

Look well at my form, my qualities and my perfect eloquence,
And at what my miraculous powers are like.
If you wish to become like this as well,
Set your mind on this sublime awakening!"

When that elephant among kings had heard the Dharma,
He, with seventy thousand koṭis of living beings,
With his sons and queens, his troops and his townspeople,
Set their minds on this sublime awakening:
"We shall give rise to the supreme mind;
We shall take all sentient beings as our guests;
We shall practice the supreme and delightful conduct of awakening;
We shall become buddhas, unsurpassed among beings."

"Son of good family, in this way King Puṇyālaṃkāra served that Blessed One and his retinue for eighty-four thousand years with every comfort and requisite that was suitable, pleasing and blameless. The two boys Siṃha and Siṃhavikrāntagāmin went forth from home into homelessness in the teaching of that Blessed One. Because they had gone forth, twenty thousand younger princes also went forth from home into homelessness. Then the monks Siṃha and Siṃhavikrāntagāmin, applying themselves diligently to the factors of awakening, to having few possessions and to living in solitude, before long developed the five superknowledges. Having gained the superknowledges, they taught the Dharma in all world systems through the power of their own miraculous abilities and the power of their aspirations, and the two of them brought immeasurable, countless sentient beings to maturity and established them in unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

"Son of good family, then, when eighty-four thousand years had passed, King Puṇyālaṃkāra went to where the Blessed One, the Tathāgata King of the Rays of Stainless Infinite Light, was staying, and he saw that the two boys had gone forth. When he saw this, a contemptuous thought arose in him: 'I have served the Tathāgata with every comfort and requisite for eighty-four thousand years. What have these two done by going forth that I have not done?'

"Then, son of good family, the Tathāgata King of the Rays of Stainless Infinite Light, knowing that King Puṇyālaṃkāra was thinking in this way, said this to the bodhisattva Siṃhavikrāntagāmin: 'Son of good family, display the power of your wisdom, your superknowledges, your merit and your primordial wisdom,

and delight the whole assembly! Shatter all the abodes of Māra! Make the path of awakening blaze! Satisfy all sentient beings! Defeat your opponents! Make the lamp of the Dharma blaze! Pacify all the afflictions! And display the play of a bodhisattva!'

"Then at that time, on that occasion, the bodhisattva Siṃhavikrāntagāmin stroked the sky with his hand, and when he had stroked the sky with his hand, the great trichiliocosm world system shook in six ways."

"Again he stroked the sky with his hand, and then a hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of cymbals resounded in the air without being played. Again he stroked the sky with his hand, and then from the air there fell a rain of flowers never heard of or seen before, fragrant, soft, and pleasant to the touch like kācilindika cloth. Again he stroked the sky with his hand, and immediately a rain of every kind of jewel poured down from the air. A rain of every kind of enjoyment and amenity poured down. Just as a rain of every kind of requisite poured down in that great trichiliocosm world system, so too a rain of food, drink and delicacies of the same kind poured down.

"Then the Tathāgata King of the Rays of Stainless Infinite Light said this to King Puṇyālaṃkāra: 'Great king, which is greater: the giving that you have practiced, or this rain of jewels that has fallen?'

"The king replied, 'Blessed One, this rain of jewels is not easy even to describe by comparison; it is beyond measure to that extent.'

"He said, 'Great king, if this bodhisattva Siṃhavikrāntagāmin wishes, he can, by the power of the primordial wisdom of the superknowledges, bring down such a rain of jewels in as many world systems as there are grains of sand in the River Ganges, and he can satisfy and gratify the sentient beings of those world systems according to whatever each of them desires.'

"Son of good family, at that time, on that occasion, the gods dwelling on the earth called out: 'As soon as this one set his mind on awakening, a rain of every kind of jewel poured down from the sky; surely, then, this bodhisattva will become a sky treasury!' Just as the earth-dwelling gods called out, so too the gods of the atmosphere, the gods of the realm of the Four Great Kings, of the Thirty-Three, of Yāma, of Tuṣita, and from Nirmāṇarati up to Akaniṣṭha called out: 'As soon as this one set his mind on awakening, such a rain of jewels poured down; oh, surely this bodhisattva will become a sky treasury!' Because they called this out, the Blessed One, the Tathāgata King of the Rays of Stainless Infinite Light, approved that name. And because he approved it,

the buddhas, the blessed ones, as many as the grains of sand in the River Ganges, also approved it.

"Son of good family, in this way King Puṇyālaṃkāra, having seen that power of superknowledge, merit and primordial wisdom of the bodhisattva Siṃhavikrāntagāmin, installed as king the boy called Jinamati, and out of faith went forth from home into homelessness. He applied himself properly in this way, thinking: 'This giving is attachment of the mind; going forth is purity of the mind. This giving is an obstacle for body and speech; going forth purifies body and speech. This giving is a great obstacle; going forth is the complete pacification of all obstacles. This giving is grass and leaves; going forth comes to fulfillment as the core and the fruit. This giving is bound up with "mine" and with possessiveness; going forth is the abandoning of all possessiveness. This giving does not move away from the view of the perishable collection; going forth purifies all views. This giving is the pastime of children; this going forth is the ground of the tamed, the peaceful and the wise.' With such a mind and such an intention he went forth in this way, and living alone, unmingled with others, conscientious and diligent, in complete solitude, before long he developed the five superknowledges.

"Son of good family, if you think that the one who was King Puṇyālaṃkāra at that time, on that occasion, was someone else, do not see it that way. Why is that? The Tathāgata Krakucchanda was at that time, on that occasion, the wheel-turning king called Puṇyālaṃkāra. This bodhisattva Gaganagañja was at that time, on that occasion, the bodhisattva called Siṃhavikrāntagāmin, and he first brought down a rain of jewels from the sky treasury. Since then, for immeasurable, countless hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of eons, he has never lost the superknowledge of bringing down a rain of jewels from the sky treasury. Son of good family, I myself was at that time, on that occasion, the bodhisattva called Siṃha. The bodhisattva Maitreya was at that time, on that occasion, the prince called Jinamati, whom King Puṇyālaṃkāra installed as king.

"Son of good family, that buddha's teaching too became joyful and pure in this way, and became the abode of sentient beings who had developed roots of virtue. All the sentient beings, however many, who set their minds on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening became irreversible from awakening."

When this account connected with the past had been told, twelve thousand living beings set their minds on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Then the bodhisattva Gaganagañja said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, what is the transcendent path of the bodhisattva great beings?"

When he had asked this, the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja: "Son of good family, what is called the path of the bodhisattvas is the six perfections, the thirty-seven factors of awakening, calm abiding, insight, the four means of attracting others, the four meditative concentrations, the four immeasurables, the four formless absorptions, and the five superknowledges. Son of good family, this is called the transcendent path of the bodhisattvas.

"What is called the world is the five aggregates. Here a bodhisattva gives gifts knowing form to be impermanent. He gives gifts knowing form to be suffering.

He knows form to be selfless. He knows form to be peaceful. He knows form to be empty. He knows form to be signless. He knows form to be wishless. He knows form to be unconditioned. He knows form to be unborn. He knows form to be unarisen. He knows form to be dependently originated. He knows form to be isolated. He knows form to be ungraspable. He knows form to be without a basis. He knows form to be without arising. He knows form to be like an illusion. He knows form to be like a dream. He knows form to be like a mirage. He knows form to be like the moon in water. He knows form to be like an echo. He knows form to be like an optical illusion. He knows form to be like a reflection. Knowing form to be like grass, wood, a wall or a road, and like an optical illusion, he gives gifts, and through the suchness of form he enters the suchness of giving. Through the suchness of giving he comes to know the suchness of dedication. Through the suchness of dedication he comes to know the suchness of awakening; through the suchness of awakening, the suchness of sentient beings; through the suchness of sentient beings, the suchness of the self; and through the suchness of the self, the suchness of all phenomena. That which is the suchness of all phenomena is not a suchness; it is unerring suchness, and suchness that is not other. Giving through coming to know suchness: son of good family, this giving is the transcendent path of the bodhisattvas.

Likewise, he gives gifts knowing feeling, perception, formations and consciousness to be impermanent. He knows consciousness to be suffering

and selfless. He knows consciousness to be peaceful. He knows consciousness to be empty. He knows consciousness to be signless. He knows consciousness to be wishless. He knows consciousness to be unconditioned. He knows consciousness to be unborn. He knows consciousness to be unarisen. Knowing consciousness to be dependently originated, he gives gifts. He knows consciousness to be isolated. He knows consciousness to be ungraspable. He knows consciousness to be without a basis. He knows consciousness to be not arising. He knows consciousness to be like an illusion. He knows consciousness to be like a dream. He knows consciousness to be like a mirage. He knows consciousness to be like the moon in water. He knows consciousness to be like an optical illusion. He knows consciousness to be like a reflection. Knowing consciousness to have the characteristic of non-cognition, he gives gifts, and through the suchness of consciousness he comes to know the suchness of giving. Through the suchness of giving he comes to know the suchness of dedication; through the suchness of dedication, the suchness of awakening; through the suchness of awakening, the suchness of sentient beings; through the suchness of sentient beings, the suchness of the self; and through the suchness of the self, the suchness of all phenomena. That which is the suchness of all phenomena is suchness. It is unerring suchness, and suchness that is not other. Son of good family, this giving of gifts through coming to know suchness is the transcendent path of the bodhisattvas.

Moreover, son of good family, the bodhisattva guards moral discipline knowing form to be impermanent, and so on up to: he guards moral discipline knowing form to be like grass, wood, a wall or a road, and like a reflection. Through the suchness of form he comes to know the suchness of moral discipline. Through the suchness of moral discipline he comes to know the suchness of dedication; through the suchness of dedication, the suchness of awakening; through the suchness of awakening, the suchness of sentient beings; through the suchness of sentient beings, the suchness of the self; and through the suchness of the self, the suchness of all phenomena. That which is the suchness of all phenomena is not a suchness; it is unerring suchness, and suchness that is not other. Son of good family, this guarding of moral discipline through coming to know suchness is the transcendent path of the bodhisattvas.

Likewise, he guards moral discipline knowing feeling, perception, formations and consciousness to be impermanent, and so on up to: he guards moral discipline knowing consciousness to have the characteristic of non-cognition. Through the suchness of consciousness he comes to know the suchness of

moral discipline. Through the suchness of moral discipline he comes to know the suchness of dedication; through the suchness of dedication, the suchness of awakening; through the suchness of awakening, the suchness of sentient beings; through the suchness of sentient beings, the suchness of the self; and through the suchness of the self, the suchness of all phenomena. That which is the suchness of all phenomena is not a suchness; it is unerring suchness, and suchness that is not other. This guarding of moral discipline through coming to know suchness is the transcendent path of the bodhisattvas.

Moreover, son of good family, the bodhisattva cultivates patience knowing form to be impermanent, and so on; applying the same pattern, with such understanding he undertakes diligence. He settles evenly in meditative concentration. He discerns with wisdom. Knowing form to be impermanent, he discerns with wisdom, and so on up to: knowing form to be like grass, wood, a wall or a road, and like an optical illusion, he discerns with wisdom. Through the suchness of form he comes to know the suchness of wisdom. Through the suchness of wisdom he comes to know the suchness of dedication; through the suchness of dedication, the suchness of awakening; through the suchness of awakening, the suchness of sentient beings; through the suchness of sentient beings, the suchness of the self; and through the suchness of the self, the suchness of all phenomena. That which is the suchness of all phenomena is not a suchness; it is unerring suchness, and suchness that is not other. This discerning with wisdom through coming to know suchness is called the transcendent path of the bodhisattvas.

Likewise, he discerns with wisdom knowing feeling, perception, formations and consciousness to be impermanent, and so on up to: he discerns with wisdom knowing consciousness to have the characteristic of non-cognition. Through the suchness of consciousness he comes to know the suchness of wisdom. Through the suchness of wisdom he comes to know the suchness of dedication; through the suchness of dedication, the suchness of awakening; through the suchness of awakening, the suchness of sentient beings; through the suchness of sentient beings, the suchness of the self; and through the suchness of the self, the suchness of all phenomena. That which is the suchness of all phenomena is not a suchness; it is unerring suchness, and suchness that is not other. Son of good family, this discerning with wisdom through coming to know suchness is also the transcendent path of the bodhisattvas.

Moreover, son of good family, the bodhisattva, knowing form to be impermanent, cultivates the application of mindfulness that observes the body as body, and so on up to: knowing form to be like grass, wood, a wall or a road, and like an optical illusion, he cultivates the application of mindfulness that observes the body as body. Through the suchness of form he comes to know the suchness of the body. From coming to know the suchness of the body up to the suchness of all phenomena, he comes to know them. That which is the suchness of all phenomena is not a suchness; it is unerring suchness, and suchness that is not other. Through coming to know suchness he cultivates the application of mindfulness that observes the body as body, and yet does not conceptualize through any conceptual thought connected with the body. Son of good family, this is the transcendent path of the bodhisattvas.

Likewise, from knowing feeling, perception, formations and consciousness to be impermanent, extend it at length in the same way, up to the giving of gifts. Likewise, feeling, mind and phenomena should also be set out in full: from knowing form to be impermanent, he cultivates the application of mindfulness that observes phenomena as phenomena, and so on up to: knowing it to be like grass, wood, a wall or a road, and like an optical illusion, he cultivates the application of mindfulness that observes phenomena as phenomena. Likewise, knowing feeling, perception, formations and consciousness to be impermanent, he cultivates the application of mindfulness that observes phenomena as phenomena, and so on up to: knowing consciousness to have the characteristic of non-cognition, he cultivates the application of mindfulness that observes phenomena as phenomena.

Thus, whatever is the suchness of the aggregates is the suchness of the applications of mindfulness. Whatever is the suchness of the applications of mindfulness is the suchness of dedication. Whatever is the suchness of dedication is the suchness of awakening. Whatever is the suchness of awakening is the suchness of sentient beings. Whatever is the suchness of sentient beings is the suchness of the self. Whatever is the suchness of the self is the suchness of all phenomena, and whatever is the suchness of all phenomena is not a suchness; it is unerring suchness, and suchness that is not other. Though through coming to know suchness he cultivates the application of mindfulness that observes phenomena as phenomena, he does not conceptualize through any conceptual thought connected with phenomena. Such coming to know is called the transcendent path of the bodhisattvas.

Applying the same pattern, just as with the applications of mindfulness, so too the right abandonments, the bases of miraculous power, the faculties, the powers, the branches of awakening, the path, calm abiding, insight, the four means of attracting others, the four meditative concentrations, the four immeasurables, the four formless absorptions and the five superknowledges should likewise be set out in full.

Knowing form to be impermanent, he accomplishes the primordial wisdom of the superknowledges. Knowing form to be suffering, form to be selfless, form to be peaceful, form to be empty, form to be signless and form to be wishless; knowing form to be unconditioned; knowing it to be unborn, unarisen, dependently originated, isolated, ungraspable, without a basis, not arising, like an illusion, like a dream, like a mirage, like the moon in water, like an echo, like an optical illusion, like a reflection; and knowing form to be like grass, wood, a wall or a road, and like an optical illusion, he fully accomplishes the primordial wisdom of the superknowledges.

Likewise, knowing feeling, perception, formations and consciousness to be impermanent, he fully accomplishes the primordial wisdom of the superknowledges. Knowing consciousness to be suffering; knowing consciousness to be selfless, consciousness to be peaceful, consciousness to be empty, signless, wishless, unconditioned, unborn, unarisen, dependently originated, isolated, ungraspable, without a basis, not arising, like an illusion, like a dream, like a mirage, like the moon in water, like an echo, like an optical illusion, like a reflection; and knowing consciousness to have the characteristic of non-cognition, he fully accomplishes the primordial wisdom of the superknowledges.

That is to say, whatever is the suchness of the aggregates is the suchness of the superknowledges. Whatever is the suchness of the superknowledges is the suchness of dedication. Whatever is the suchness of dedication is the suchness of awakening. Whatever is the suchness of awakening is the suchness of sentient beings. Whatever is the suchness of sentient beings is the suchness of the self. Whatever is the suchness of the self is the suchness of all phenomena. Whatever is the suchness of all phenomena is not a suchness; it is unerring suchness, and suchness that is not other. Through coming to know suchness he fully accomplishes the primordial wisdom of the superknowledges, and such coming to know is called the transcendent path of the bodhisattvas.

Why is that? Because the transcendent path is the coming to know of suchness through form: form does not disintegrate, is not annihilated, and is not permanent; it is dependent origination, by its intrinsic nature unborn. In the same way, it is the coming to know of the suchness of feeling, perception, formations and consciousness: consciousness does not disintegrate, is not annihilated, and is not permanent; it is dependent origination, by its intrinsic nature unborn. Whoever has crossed beyond the world of the aggregates is not attached even to the world of desire, the world of form, or the formless world. Being unattached, he teaches the Dharma to sentient beings born in the five destinies so that they may pass beyond the world, and he teaches the Dharma in such a way that he does not destroy the world. Why is that? He does not destroy the world's characteristic of impermanence. The world has the characteristic of suffering, the characteristic of selflessness, the characteristic of peace, the characteristic of emptiness, the characteristic of signlessness, the characteristic of wishlessness, the characteristic of nonformation, up to the characteristic of suchness. This not destroying the world, noble son, is the pure transcendent path of the bodhisattvas.

The bodhisattva who is firmly established on the pure path makes a great light of the Dharma for sentient beings who abide on a wrong path. Having found that light, they become firmly established on that very transcendent path.

Because it brings one to the seat of awakening, this path is the very highest. Because there is no unwholesome thought whatsoever, this path is supreme. Because it finds the summit of the wisdom of the buddhas, this path is sublime. Because it ferries one across all the floods, this path is unsurpassed. Because it goes beyond all limited paths, this path has none above it. Because no antidote is apprehended, this path is without equal. Because it truly travels the path of the buddhas of the past, this path is equal to the unequaled. Because it has vanquished Māra and all opponents, this path goes in ease. Because it plays with the wisdom of the superknowledges and the bases of miraculous power, this path goes without obstruction. Because the light shining by wisdom is completely pure, this path is free of darkness and gloom. Because it is without deceit and guile, this path is straight. Because the mind is without crookedness, this path is clear. Because the mind is equal toward all sentient beings, this path is even. Because it makes room for all sentient beings, this path is vast. Because beings do not harm one another on it, this path is spacious. Because one travels it without weariness, this path is restful.

Through the perfection of generosity, this path is made firm by merit. Through the perfection of moral discipline, this path is free of torment. Through the perfection of patience, this path is free of fear. Through the perfection of diligence, this path cannot be turned back. Through the perfection of meditative concentration, this path is free of all dust. Through the perfection of wisdom, this path goes on a par with space. Being without pride, this path follows wisdom. Through accomplishing all wholesome qualities, this path follows the full cultivation of all the qualities of a buddha. Because what was heard before does not deceive, this path follows the turning of the wheel of Dharma.

Noble son, these are the pure transcendent paths of the bodhisattvas. Abiding on these pure paths, the bodhisattva puts on the great armor, enters the Great Vehicle, and goes to wherever the seat of awakening is.

Here, this is the armor of the bodhisattvas. By fitting out a great ship, it is the armor of ferrying across those who have not crossed. By freeing them from all the bonds of the afflictions and of views, it is the armor of liberating those who are not liberated. By casting off every fear that comes from grasping, it is the armor of giving relief to those who have found no relief. By showing that the inverted views regarding what does not exist are sameness, it is the armor of bringing to nirvāṇa those who have not attained nirvāṇa. By not apprehending a self, a sentient being, a life or a person, it is the armor of liberating all sentient beings. By having no regard for body or life, it is the armor of upholding the sublime Dharma. By never being satiated in gathering the stores of roots of virtue, it is the armor of purifying a buddha field. By amassing many kinds of stores of giving, it is the armor of the major marks and excellent minor marks that adorn the body. By attaining the superknowledges, it is the armor of subduing Māra and all adversaries. Through the wisdom of the specific knowledges, it is the armor of fully satisfying all sentient beings. Through the wisdom of the dhāraṇīs, it is the armor of hearing and seeking out all the qualities of a buddha. Through the wisdom of the superknowledges, it is the armor of looking into the minds of all sentient beings. Through the wisdom of discernment, it is the armor of knowing the superior and inferior faculties of all sentient beings. By accomplishing the powers of wisdom and primordial wisdom, it is the armor of perfecting the ten powers. Because the mind is never daunted by anything, it is the armor of attaining the fearlessnesses. Because the mind is never daunted by anything, it is the armor of attaining the fearlessnesses. By

abandoning all unwholesome qualities and perfecting all wholesome qualities, it is the armor of fulfilling the eighteen distinctive qualities of a buddha.

Even on hearing that all phenomena are like an illusion, a dream, a mirage, an echo, or the moon in water, not to be frightened, not to be terrified, and not to become terrified: that is the armor of fearlessness of the bodhisattvas. Even while knowing that all sentient beings are by their intrinsic nature in complete nirvāṇa, to remain without ever abandoning any sentient being: that is the armor of great compassion of the bodhisattvas. Even on hearing that all phenomena are emptiness, signless, wishless, unformed, unborn and unarisen, to display everywhere life, death and transmigration, and birth: that is the armor of skillful means of the bodhisattvas.

To know all phenomena as having the characteristic of having entered certainty, and to realize all formations as unborn, and yet not to fall into cessation nor to actualize the fruit: that is the armor of the bodhisattvas' undisturbed former blessing. Having put on these twenty great armors, one has fully entered the Great Vehicle.

That Great Vehicle is well furnished with four wheels, the means of attraction. Its spokes are firmly fitted through the dedication of roots of virtue with pure intention. Its hub is deep and well made through the surpassing greatness of the wisdom of dependent origination. It has an axle and is firmly held together, in order to carry the burden of all sentient beings. Its chariot pole is firmly joined, since it is wholly held by great love and great compassion. It is encircled by a railing of every jewel, since it is beautifully adorned with all the jewels of the Dharma. It is bound with the straps of firm superior intention, since it does not let former vows sink out of sight. It bears the load of the yoke through the union of skillful means and wisdom. It is well fitted with the yoke holes of calm abiding and insight. Its gait is the strength of fully knowing the Four Truths. It has thousands of thoroughbred steeds, full of exertion. By the four bases of miraculous power it goes to all buddha fields. Its reins of mindfulness are bound with threads of jewel garlands. Because it holds all sentient beings, it travels broad and spacious. It subdues enemies and the enemy Māra. It is well crafted. It is joined with knowledge and primordial wisdom. It is blessed with blessings. It is held in mind by all the buddhas of the ten directions. Its lion throne is beautifully adorned. It is extolled by the gods, by Śakra, and by all the Brahmās. It is fair of form, and one never tires of looking at it; it is lovely to behold. Like a vajra it is hard and invincible. Because its superior intention is steadfast, it never departs from its vow. It is

well gathered in and held by the driver. It is always led by the awakening mind. Following the complete fulfillment of the qualities of aspiration, it goes wherever it pleases. It has gained the light of the divine eye that surveys the ten directions. In order to illuminate the ten directions, its light is vast and pure and its rays are infinite. Since a rain of the flowers of the branches of awakening falls on it continually, it is always full of flowers. It always has the music of cymbals and instruments that proclaim the Dharma. Its assembly of people are of like fortune. It seeks out all the conduct of bodhisattvas. It is exceedingly exalted through the infinite wisdom of immeasurable kinds of qualities. It is fully endowed with the wisdom of omniscience, the emptiness endowed with the supreme of all aspects. Noble son, such is that Great Vehicle.

Therefore those holy beings put on the armor and fully enter it. Having entered that transcendent path, even though they have not yet attained omniscience, they stand close to sentient beings with the deeds of a buddha.

When this array of the path, the armor and the vehicle was taught, seventy-two thousand living beings, gods and humans, gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, and thirty-two thousand bodhisattvas, through the purity of the transcendent path, attained forbearance toward unborn phenomena.

The Questions of the Noble Gaganagañja, the sixth section.

Then the bodhisattva Ratnaśrī said to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, "Noble son, you have purified the transcendent path."

He replied, "Noble son, I have purified it because I myself am pure."

"Noble son, how are you pure?"

"Noble son, I am pure because the world is pure."

"Noble son, what is this purity of the world?"

He replied, "Because the prior limit of form is pure, there is no passing away; because the later limit of form is pure, there is no coming; and because present form too is pure, it remains as the nature of reality. In the same way, because the prior limit of feeling, perception, formations and consciousness is pure, there is no passing away; because the later limit of consciousness is pure, there is no coming; and because present consciousness too is pure, it remains as the nature of reality. That, noble son, is called the purity of the world."

"To what does a world thus purified look?"

"Noble son, a world thus purified looks to all phenomena."

"How does it look to all phenomena?"

"Through wisdom and primordial wisdom it fully knows all phenomena as completely cut off at the prior limit and at the later limit."

"What is this complete cutting off of all phenomena at the prior limit and at the later limit?"

"That in which there is neither annihilation nor permanence."

"What is that called, in which there is neither annihilation nor permanence?"

"That in which there is neither annihilation nor permanence is called nonarising and noncessation."

"What is that called, in which there is neither arising nor cessation?"

"What is without arising and without cessation cannot be called anything at all. Why is that? Because that phenomenon cannot be counted and cannot be expressed."

"Noble son, how could a phenomenon that cannot be counted come to be counted?"

He replied, "It is like this. For example, upon the earth one may count with reference to space, but space itself cannot be counted. In the same way, one may count by way of the door of counting, yet one cannot count by way of the door of counting. The very door of counting is the door of the uncountable. What, then, is the door of counting, and what is the door of the uncountable? What is called the door of counting is the conditioned. What is called the door of the uncountable is the unconditioned. The unconditioned, in which there is no counting, is the uncountable; and whatever is uncountable is the unconditioned. The Blessed One too, counting and measuring it in this way, said, 'By wisdom abandon what is to be abandoned.' When a bodhisattva counts the conditioned, measures it against consciousness, and examines it properly, he does not see any phenomenon whatsoever that is to be fully known, to be abandoned, to be actualized, or to be cultivated. Since he does not see any phenomena at all, he does not make phenomena a basis. When he does not make phenomena a basis, he has attained the baseless."

When he has attained the baseless, he no longer desires anything at all. When he desires nothing at all, he does not apprehend anything. Being free of apprehending, he has nothing he takes as his own and grasps at nothing.

If one asks what he does not grasp: he does not grasp form as permanent or impermanent; he does not grasp feeling, perception, formations or consciousness as permanent or impermanent. He does not grasp form as suffering or as pleasure; he does not grasp feeling, perception, formations or consciousness as suffering or as pleasure. He does not grasp form as self or as no-self, and so on up to: he does not grasp consciousness as self or as no-self. He does not grasp form as attractive or unattractive, and so on up to: he does not grasp consciousness as attractive or unattractive. He does not grasp form as empty or not empty, and so on up to: he does not grasp consciousness as empty or not empty. Although he grasps at nothing, because he has attained samādhi he moves about in saṃsāra, yet he does not grasp the afflictions of saṃsāra. He causes sentient beings to aspire to nirvāṇa, and he himself has first attained complete nirvāṇa.

What, then, is the complete nirvāṇa of a bodhisattva? What is called complete nirvāṇa is nonformation. Here the bodhisattva does not form even the slightest unwholesome action. He takes up wholesome qualities rightly and engages in them. He forms every formation of solitude of body, speech and mind, and having examined them individually, he dedicates them to omniscience. He does not conceive of that omniscience as form, nor as feeling, nor as perception, nor as formations, nor does he conceive of it as consciousness. Because his mind is without conceit and his moral discipline is without conceit, even while he fulfills all his aspirations he does not see any phenomenon diminish or become full. Since there is neither diminishing nor filling, he finds the sameness of all phenomena, abides in the realm of phenomena, and practices the conduct of a bodhisattva; yet there is no phenomenon whatsoever that he practices, nor any that he fully practices. Noble son, it is in this way that a bodhisattva who has attained complete nirvāṇa practices the conduct of a bodhisattva.

Why is that? To be firmly established in not forming anything that could be formed is nirvāṇa. Therefore the bodhisattva does not form what could be formed; and not forming, since nothing is formed, is called complete nirvāṇa. What is called "the beyond" is that into which consciousness does not enter; the bodhisattva, characterized by the absence of cognition, is said to be in complete nirvāṇa. What is called "the beyond" is signlessness; there his mind

does not turn toward signs, and this is called complete nirvāṇa. What is called "the beyond" is the absence of conceptualization; his mind does not enter into conceptualization, and therefore it is called complete nirvāṇa. What is called "the beyond" is the baseless; his mind does not turn toward that baseless, and therefore it is called complete nirvāṇa. Noble son, in this way the bodhisattva who has attained complete nirvāṇa practices the conduct of a bodhisattva.

Then the Blessed One gave his approval to the bodhisattva, the great being Gaganagañja, saying, "Excellent, excellent! Holy being, if it is to be explained, it should be explained just so." When this teaching was explained, five hundred bodhisattvas gained forbearance.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Gaganagañja, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, we are made eloquent by this light of the Tathāgata's Dharma. Blessed One, it is like this: just as forms appear in dependence on light, in the same way we are made eloquent by this might of the Tathāgata's person."

Then the bodhisattva Ratnaśrī said to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, "Noble son, why do you conceal your own wisdom and declare, 'I am eloquent through the Buddha's blessing'?"

He replied, "Noble son, whatever eloquence bodhisattvas have, however slight, should all be regarded as the Buddha's blessing. Why is that? If the buddhas, the blessed ones, did not illuminate those teachings, how could bodhisattvas become eloquent?"

He asked, "Noble son, does that eloquence, then, pass over from one to another?"

He replied, "Noble son, it does not pass over; nevertheless, one is eloquent because of the Buddha's eloquence as its cause. It is like this: ignorance, for example, does not pass over into formations, yet with ignorance as their cause formations arise. In the same way, the Buddha's eloquence does not pass over anywhere at all, yet with it as cause one becomes eloquent. It is like this: the sounds of horses, elephants and people, for example, do not pass over into the echo, yet with them as cause the sound of the echo arises. In the same way, the Buddha's eloquence does not pass over anywhere at all, yet with it as cause one becomes eloquent."

Ratnaśrī said, "Noble son, dependent origination is profound."

He replied, "So it is: in it no phenomenon whatsoever arises."

He asked, "Noble son, are not all phenomena dependently originated?"

He replied, "If there were some agent in the conditions, phenomena would indeed arise. But since no agent at all is apprehended in the conditions, therefore no agent can be apprehended in any phenomenon."

He asked, "Noble son, has the Tathāgata not appeared?"

He replied, "If suchness appeared, the Tathāgata too would appear; but suchness is not held to appear. Why is that? Suchness is characterized by nonarising. As suchness is, so too are all phenomena; and because he has realized this, he is called the Tathāgata."

He asked, "Noble son, has the Tathāgata appeared, then?"

He replied, "A question such as this is one to be set aside."

He asked, "What is it that is to be set aside?"

He replied, "It is just as the realm of phenomena abides."

He asked, "How does the realm of phenomena abide?"

He replied, "Not abiding as arising, not abiding as perishing: an abiding such as this, which is neither abiding nor nonabiding, is the abiding of the realm of phenomena. As the realm of phenomena abides, so too do all phenomena abide. The abiding of all phenomena is a nonabiding. In what is a nonabiding there is no abiding as arising whatsoever, nor any abiding as perishing; therefore it is neither abiding nor nonabiding. An abiding such as this is the abiding of the Tathāgata. The abiding of the Tathāgata is not held to be an abiding as arising, nor is it an abiding as cessation. So, noble son, to say 'The Tathāgata has appeared' is one extreme, and to say 'The Tathāgata has not appeared' is the second extreme. The Tathāgata is to be sought on the middle path between these two, arising and nonarising."

Ratnaśrī said, "Noble son, since the birth of a buddha, in which there is no arising and no abiding as perishing, is so profound, who, noble son, will have faith in this appearance of a buddha?"

He replied, "One who does not add anything."

He asked, "Noble son, what is meant by 'adding'?"

He replied, "Noble son, 'adding' is a word for superimposition. Whoever superimposes nothing on any phenomenon adds nothing to any phenomenon. The word of not adding is the word of sameness. The word of sameness is the word without likeness. The word without likeness is the word that is no word.

The word that is no word is the word without letters. The word without letters is the word without cognition. The word without cognition, in which there is no movement as far as mind and mentation, is the word without any movement at all. It is like this: for example, although in space there is no place for a bird's track, by convention one speaks of it as a place. In the same way, the birth of a buddha is nonarising, yet it is spoken of with the word 'birth'. Here the bodhisattva, being skilled, teaches nonarising and makes it fully clear.

"Why is that? The essential nature of all phenomena is this: it is the essential nature of nonarising. What is the essential nature of nonarising is without essential nature. What is without essential nature has no entity. What has no entity has no abiding whatsoever: all phenomena are the limit of nonabiding. The limit of nonabiding is the limit of all phenomena; therefore all phenomena are said to abide at the limit of reality. What is called the limit of reality is the limit that is never cut off, the limit that follows all limits; all phenomena appear as having reached that limit. Why is that? This limit is the limit of the reaches of space. Just as space is nowhere a limit that is cut off, so too at the limit of reality there is no limit to any phenomenon. The limit of reality is the limit of the self. By coming to know the limit of the self one should realize the knowledge of the limit of all sentient beings. In that limit of all sentient beings the limit of all phenomena is included as well. Therefore all phenomena are called the limit of exhaustion, the end of exhaustion, the culmination of exhaustion. What is called exhaustion is a synonym for nirvāṇa. Therefore all phenomena are said to be equal to nirvāṇa.

"Why is that? There is no antidote for them. It is like this: just as there is no antidote for space, so there is no antidote for any phenomenon either. Those who seek nirvāṇa by means of an antidote are seeing arising and perishing. Thinking, 'These phenomena are to be produced; these phenomena are to be stopped,' they engage in arising and perishing, and so they do not know the sameness of nirvāṇa. Therefore the Blessed One too said, 'Understand! Understand! Do not dispute! Perfect the supreme qualities of the renunciant, which is freedom from dispute.'"

Then the venerable Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, it is marvelous how the bodhisattva Gaganagañja teaches just as one who has become a bodily witness."

The bodhisattva Gaganagañja said, "Venerable Ānanda, my body is a direct witness, but the body's direct witnessing is not a self. Why is that? Space is my

body; therefore my body is a direct witness. How is the body a direct witness? Because, although with this body I perform the deeds of a buddha, the Dharma body does not decline; it is not characterized by the aggregates, the elements or the sense sources; nor has the body arisen from error; rather, I have obtained a mind-made body. In this way a bodhisattva is a bodily witness."

Ānanda said, "Noble son, are you, then, a direct witness of all phenomena?"

He replied, "Venerable Ānanda, I do not hold my body to be apart from phenomena: my body itself is phenomena, and the nature of phenomena is my body. Therefore my body is a direct witness."

Ānanda said, "Noble son, if you are a bodily witness, are you then an arhat?"

He replied, "Because I have realized the Dharma door free of affliction, and am without attachment, without aversion and without delusion, I am an arhat."

He asked, "Noble son, if you are an arhat, when will you pass into complete nirvāṇa?"

He replied, "Venerable Ānanda, an arhat does not pass into complete nirvāṇa; it is ordinary beings who pass into complete nirvāṇa, not arhats. Why is that? An arhat has abandoned the very notion of nirvāṇa. Ordinary beings conceive, 'I shall pass into complete nirvāṇa'; and to the extent that they think and conceive, to that extent they pass into complete nirvāṇa."

He said, "Noble son, as we understand the meaning of what you have said, you are not an arhat, not an ordinary being, not one still in training, not one beyond training, not a pratyekabuddha, not a bodhisattva, and not a tathāgata."

He replied, "Excellent, venerable Ānanda, excellent! One who is not an arhat, not an ordinary being, not one in training, not one beyond training, not a pratyekabuddha, not a bodhisattva, and not a tathāgata displays all the grounds, yet is not established in any of them."

When this teaching was explained, about five hundred śrāvakas threw their upper robes over the bodhisattva Gaganagañja as a covering in honor of the Dharma, and spoke these words: "May all sentient beings too find eloquence such as this!" Then, through the blessing of the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, those Dharma robes went off into space. Then those monks, the arhats, said, "Noble son, where have those Dharma robes gone?"

He replied, "They have gone into the treasury of space."

At that moment the Blessed One smiled, and the venerable Ānanda asked the Blessed One the meaning of his smile: "Blessed One, the Tathāgata does not smile without reason. What is the cause, what is the condition, of your smile?"

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, the five hundred upper robes that those five hundred monks threw over the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, and that the bodhisattva Gaganagañja placed in the treasury of space, have gone to the world system called Kāṣāyadhvaja, and there, in the buddha field of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Śailendrarāja, they are performing the work of a buddha. The Dharma discourse that the bodhisattva Gaganagañja gave issued forth from those Dharma robes in that buddha field, and through that teaching of the Dharma many thousands of bodhisattvas attained forbearance. Ānanda, behold the domain of the miraculous powers and wisdom of the bodhisattvas, who bring sentient beings to maturity in so many ways."

When this teaching was explained, a great rain of flowers poured down, flowers colored like fire, blazing like the moon and the sun, of colors never seen or heard of before. And from those flowers came forth a voice saying, "Those sentient beings who hear this teaching from the bodhisattva Gaganagañja and come to have faith in it are sealed with the seal of irreversibility and are bound for the seat of awakening."

Ānanda asked, "Blessed One, where do these flowers come from?"

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, there is a Brahmā called Prabhāvyūha who holds sway over a hundred thousand Brahmā world systems. That Brahmā has scattered these flowers as an offering to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja."

Ānanda said, "Blessed One, we would like to see that Brahmā."

He said, "You will see that Brahmā shortly; wait a little."

Then the Brahmā Prabhāvyūha, surrounded and preceded by sixty-eight thousand Brahmās, vanished from the Brahmā world and came into the presence of the Blessed One. He bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet, circumambulated him three times, and sat down to one side.

Then the Brahmā Prabhāvyūha said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, marvelous is the greatness of the moral discipline of the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, the greatness of his samādhi, the greatness of his superknowledges, the greatness of his primordial wisdom, the greatness of his wisdom, the greatness of his fulfilled aspirations, the greatness of his skill in means, the greatness of his superior intention, the greatness of his mastery of

the Dharma, the greatness of the adornment of his body, the greatness of the adornment of his speech and mind, and the greatness of his mastery over all phenomena. Because the one called the bodhisattva Gaganagañja trained himself thoroughly in the past, he displays every activity of body, speech and mind without effort. Blessed One, who would not acknowledge what has been done for former roots of virtue? Blessed One, this lion's roar that the bodhisattva Gaganagañja now sounds is the result in keeping with the cause of his profound conduct in the past."

The Blessed One said, "So it is. It is just as you say, Brahmā. The unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening of the bodhisattvas arises from former roots of virtue, from merit and from primordial wisdom."

Then the Brahmā Prabhāvyūha said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, what are the roots of virtue of the bodhisattvas? What is their merit? What is their primordial wisdom?"

The Blessed One said, "Brahmā, what is called the root of virtue is the first arousing of the mind; it is the root of all the qualities of a buddha. Merit is that which, from the very moment of arousing the awakening mind, outshines all the bases of meritorious action arising from giving, arising from moral discipline, and arising from meditation, of all sentient beings and of all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. Primordial wisdom is the dedication of the roots of virtue gathered and accumulated to omniscience, the knowledge of all aspects.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is intention, because it is free of deceit and guile. Merit is application, because it gathers all merit. Primordial wisdom is superior intention, because it advances to distinction.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is a firm commitment to wholesome qualities. Merit is never being satisfied with the stores of roots of virtue. Primordial wisdom is examining the roots of virtue as an illusion.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is finding a spiritual friend. Merit is not abandoning the spiritual friend. Primordial wisdom is questioning the spiritual friend about everything.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is striving for the Dharma. Merit is desiring the Dharma. Primordial wisdom is delighting in and being devoted to the joy of the Dharma.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is seeking the Dharma. Merit is teaching the Dharma without material gain.

Primordial wisdom is keeping no teacher's closed fist with regard to the Dharma.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is listening to the Dharma. Merit is examining it properly. Primordial wisdom is putting the Dharma into practice.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is seeing the buddhas. Merit is serving the buddhas. Primordial wisdom is relying completely on the buddhas.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is obtaining the going forth. Merit is delighting greatly in the lineage of the noble ones. Primordial wisdom is delighting in dwelling in the wilderness.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is being easy to satisfy and easy to support. Merit is obtaining Dharma robes and alms without effort. Primordial wisdom is making use of them without attachment or greed.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is cultivating the applications of mindfulness. Merit is bringing the correct exertions to completion. Primordial wisdom is attaining the bases of miraculous power.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is entering into the faculty of faith. Merit is diligence, mindfulness, and vigilance. Primordial wisdom is cultivating meditative absorption and wisdom.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is abiding in the five powers. Merit is understanding the branches of awakening. Primordial wisdom is knowing how to enter the path.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is joy of mind. Merit is seeking out the prerequisites for calm abiding. Primordial wisdom is being skilled in insight.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is the meritorious act that arises from generosity. Merit is the meritorious act that arises from moral discipline. Primordial wisdom is the meritorious act that arises from meditation.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is training in higher moral discipline. Merit is training in higher mind. Primordial wisdom is training in higher wisdom.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is confessing every wrongdoing, one by one. Merit is rejoicing in all merit. Primordial wisdom is supplicating all the buddhas.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is giving away all one's possessions. Merit is not hoping for their ripening. Primordial wisdom is being without conceit about the gift and dedicating it to awakening.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is correctly taking up the trainings. Merit is moral discipline that is unimpaired. Primordial wisdom is dedicating to awakening a moral discipline that is free of contrivance.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is having no anger toward any sentient being. Merit is bearing harsh words with patience. Primordial wisdom is giving up body and life in order to bring all sentient beings to maturity, and dedicating this to awakening.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is undertaking virtuous qualities. Merit is aspiring to all roots of virtue. Primordial wisdom is entering evenly into signlessness and dedicating the roots of virtue to awakening.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is seeking out the branches of meditative concentration. Merit is not letting one's former roots of virtue be exhausted through attaining meditative concentration. Primordial wisdom is turning back from meditative concentration and taking birth in the desire realm.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is learning, the root of wisdom. Merit is examining what one has learned. Primordial wisdom is bringing wisdom to fulfillment.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is an even mind toward all sentient beings. Merit is entering into absorption in a mind of loving-kindness. Primordial wisdom is loving-kindness toward all sentient beings that is like space.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is the accumulation of the first three grounds. Merit is the fourth ground and those that follow. Primordial wisdom is bringing the tenth ground to fulfillment.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue belongs to bodhisattvas who have first given rise to the mind of awakening. Merit belongs to bodhisattvas who have embarked on the conduct. Primordial wisdom belongs to irreversible bodhisattvas.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is the soles of the feet that touch the ground evenly. Merit is the adornment of the major marks and the excellent minor marks. Primordial wisdom is the crown of the head whose summit cannot be seen.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is the adornment of a buddha field. Merit is enjoying food and drink by mere thought. Primordial wisdom is being born as a sentient being of sharp faculties.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is hearing about the deeds of Māra. Merit is recognizing the deeds of Māra. Primordial wisdom is passing entirely beyond the deeds of Māra.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is great compassion. Merit is skill in means. Primordial wisdom is the Perfection of Wisdom.

"Furthermore, the root of virtue is the adornment of the seat of awakening. Merit is subduing all māras. Primordial wisdom is fully and perfectly awakening to complete awakening through wisdom endowed with a single instant of mind.

"Brahmā, in this way the bodhisattva arises from roots of virtue, from merit, and from primordial wisdom."

Then Brahmā Prabhāvyūha said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, it is wonderful how the Tathāgata has taught all the qualities of a buddha in so many ways on the basis of these three fundamental points."

When he had said this, the bodhisattva, the great being Gaganagañja, said to Brahmā Prabhāvyūha, "Brahmā, all phenomena are gathered together in a single point. Why is that? The point of emptiness is the point, for all phenomena are gathered together in emptiness. The point of signlessness is the point, for all phenomena are gathered together in signlessness. The point of wishlessness is the point, for all phenomena are gathered together in wishlessness. Applying this in the same way, up to: the point of the unconditioned is the point. The point of freedom from attachment is the point. The point of peace is the point. The point of groundlessness is the point. The point of the realm of phenomena is the point. The point of suchness is the point. The point of the limit of reality is the point. The point of non-occurrence is the point. The point of non-arising is the point. The point of nirvāṇa is the point, for all phenomena are gathered together in nirvāṇa.

"Furthermore, Brahmā, attachment is the point of freedom from attachment.

Why is that? Attachment has the nature of freedom from attachment, and all phenomena have the nature of attachment. Aversion is the point of freedom from aversion. Why is that? Aversion has the nature of freedom from aversion, and all phenomena have the nature of aversion. Delusion is the point of

freedom from delusion. Why is that? Delusion has the nature of freedom from delusion, and all phenomena have the nature of delusion. The view of the perishable collection is the point of the absence of the view of the perishable collection. Why is that? The view of the perishable collection has the nature of the absence of the view of the perishable collection, and all phenomena have the nature of the view of the perishable collection. Form is the point of the absence of form. Why is that? Form has the nature of the absence of form, and all phenomena have the nature of form. In the same way, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness too: consciousness is the point of the absence of consciousness. Why is that? Consciousness has the nature of the absence of consciousness, and all phenomena have the nature of the absence of consciousness. The elements, the sense sources, and the twelve links of dependent origination are to be applied in the same way. Ignorance is the point of the absence of ignorance. Why is that? Ignorance has the nature of the absence of ignorance, and all the qualities of a buddha have the nature of ignorance. And so on, up to birth: birth too is the point of the absence of birth. Why is that? Birth has the nature of the absence of birth, and all the qualities of a buddha have the nature of birth. All the qualities of a buddha are the point of what is not a quality. Why is that? All phenomena have the nature of non-conceptuality, and all the qualities of a buddha have the nature of all phenomena.

"Brahmā, these are a door of entry into the points of the Dharma called Entering the Point That Is No Point, in which, in each single point, all the qualities of a buddha are gathered together.

"Brahmā, just as, for example, all rivers flow into the great ocean, so in the single point of a Dharma door all the qualities of a buddha are gathered together. Brahmā, just as, for example, all that appears as form is gathered together in space, so in the single point of a Dharma door all the qualities of a buddha are gathered together. Therefore this point is an inexhaustible point, a treasury where hundreds of thousands are deposited.

"Brahmā, just as, for example, all hundreds of thousands are gathered together in a single treasury where hundreds of thousands are deposited, and though they are kept there for a thousand years and then taken out, however many hundreds of thousands there are, they do not cling to that place, nor does the place cling to the hundreds of thousands, in the same way, Brahmā, even if one were to count the qualities of a buddha, set them aside, and measure them for a hundred thousand eons, the qualities of a buddha would

not pass into the body or into the mind. Whether they are explained or not explained, they are just so many. Yet that 'so many' is not so many either. Why is that? If something were found to be so many or not so many, then it would be something found. But since they are not so many, and also not not so many, therefore they are not spoken of as being so many or not so many.

"Brahmā, whoever counts the qualities of a buddha counts all phenomena. Why is that? All phenomena are qualities of a buddha, and whatever are qualities of a buddha are neither phenomena nor non-phenomena. Why is that? The qualities of a buddha are not imputed by perception. The qualities of a buddha are taught in order that perception may be fully understood, and the conceptualization in which there is no perception, and which is also not the absence of perception, is neither a phenomenon nor a non-phenomenon.

"Brahmā, these qualities of a buddha have such a characteristic: they are pure by their own characteristic and isolated by their own characteristic. Their own characteristic is characteristiclessness, and characteristiclessness is space. The characteristic of space is all phenomena."

When the bodhisattva Gaganagañja had taught this excellent discourse, twelve thousand Brahmās from Brahmā's assembly gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, and five thousand Brahmās who had developed roots of virtue through thorough purification attained acceptance of the nonarising of phenomena.

The Noble Request of Gaganagañja, section seven.

Then the bodhisattva Ratnapāṇi said to the bodhisattva, the great being Gaganagañja, "Son of noble family, by what qualities must the awakening mind, the mind that is called 'the awakening mind,' be held together for it to remain irreversible?"

Gaganagañja said, "Son of noble family, the awakening mind remains irreversible when it is held together by two qualities. What are the two? Intention and superior intention."

He said, "Son of noble family, by what are intention and superior intention held together?"

He said, "Son of noble family, intention is held together by freedom from guile and freedom from deceit. Superior intention is held together by not being attached to it and by advancing to distinction."

He said, "Son of noble family, by what are these four qualities held together?"

He said, "Son of noble family, these four qualities are held together by eight qualities. What are the eight? They are as follows. Freedom from guile is held together by straightforwardness and clarity. Freedom from deceit is held together by being uncontrived and by pure intention. Not being attached to it is held together by an unflagging mind and unflagging diligence. Advancing to distinction is held together by the accumulation of merit and the accumulation of primordial wisdom."

He said, "Son of noble family, by what are these eight qualities held together?"

He said, "Son of noble family, these eight qualities are held together by sixteen qualities. What are the sixteen? They are as follows. Straightforwardness is held together by peace and gentleness. Clarity is held together by the absence of pride and the absence of murkiness. Being uncontrived is held together by great loving-kindness and great compassion. Pure intention is held together by the complete purity of body and mind. An unflagging mind is held together by steadfastness and strength. Unflagging diligence is held together by doing just what is to be done and by genuine earnestness. The accumulation of merit is held together by application and by bringing application to its conclusion. The accumulation of primordial wisdom is held together by learning and by accomplishing what has been learned.

"Son of noble family, those eight qualities are held together by these sixteen qualities."

He said, "Son of noble family, by what are these sixteen qualities held together?"

He said, "Son of noble family, these sixteen qualities are held together by thirty-two qualities. What are the thirty-two? They are as follows. Peace is held together by a sense of shame and by consideration for others. Gentleness is held together by being easy to admonish and by being pleasant company. The absence of pride is held together by not disparaging others and by deference. The absence of murkiness is held together by stainlessness and by not being rough. Great loving-kindness is held together by a mind free of anger and by an even mind toward all sentient beings. Great compassion is held together by never growing weary and by asking, 'What is there to be done for all sentient beings?' The complete purity of the body is held together by not harming and by being satisfied with one's own possessions. The complete purity of the mind is held together by being tamed and by being peaceful. Steadfastness is held together by not breaking one's commitment and by fulfilling one's promises.

Strength is held together by a firmly established mind and by an unmoving mind. Doing just what is to be done is held together by what one has said and by acting accordingly. Genuine earnestness is held together by correct application and correct effort. Application is held together by liberating and by not turning back. Bringing application to its conclusion is held together by the voice of another and by proper attention. Learning is held together by the spiritual friend and by compliance. Accomplishing what has been learned is held together by thorough reflection and by reflection with certainty. Son of noble family, those sixteen qualities are held together by those thirty-two qualities."

He said, "Son of noble family, by how many qualities are these thirty-two qualities held together?"

He said, "Son of noble family, these thirty-two qualities are held together by sixty-four qualities. What are the sixty-four? They are as follows. A sense of shame is held together by inward examination and by restraint of the sense faculties. Consideration for others is held together by guarding against external objects and by being wary of those who are learned and realized. Being easy to admonish is held together by seeking the Dharma and by desiring the Dharma. Being pleasant company is held together by a pleasing body and a pleasing mind. Not disparaging others is held together by not being conceited and by practicing the Dharma. Deference is held together by a body without crookedness and a mind without crookedness. Stainlessness is held together by removing the three stains and by cultivating the three liberations. Not being rough is held together by not being harsh and by not slandering. A mind free of anger is held together by protecting oneself and by protecting others. An even mind toward all sentient beings is held together by making no distinctions and by a single taste. Never growing weary is held together by the dreamlike nature and the illusory nature. Asking, 'What is there to be done for all sentient beings?' is held together by the superknowledges and by skillful means. Not harming is held together by aspiration and by trust in the ripening of karma. Being satisfied with one's own possessions is held together by having few desires and by contentment. Being tamed is held together by not being agitated and by not quarreling. Being peaceful is held together by casting off the clinging to 'I' and by abandoning the clinging to 'mine.' Not breaking one's commitment is held together by looking to the awakening mind and by relying on the seat of awakening. Fulfilling one's promises is held together by recognizing the deeds of Māra and

by the blessing of the buddhas. A firmly established mind is held together by a mind that does not change and by freedom from restlessness. An unmoving mind is held together by being like a mountain and by being unshakable. What one says is held together by doing what ought to be done well and by not causing torment. Acting accordingly is held together by truthfulness and by speaking correctly. Correct application is held together by according with dependent origination and by fully abandoning permanence and annihilation. Correct effort is held together by reasoning and by method. Liberating is held together by the correct exertions and by never abandoning diligence. Not turning back is held together by valor and by effort. The voice of another is held together by the spiritual friend and by seeking the Dharma. Proper attention is held together by the prerequisites for calm abiding and the prerequisites for insight. The spiritual friend is held together by the wish to listen and by showing respect. Compliance is held together by lightness of body and lightness of mind. Thorough reflection is held together by disenchantment and by freedom from attachment. Reflection with certainty is held together by what has become a cause and by the result not going to waste. Son of noble family, those thirty-two qualities are held together by these sixty-four qualities."

He said, "Son of noble family, by how many qualities are these sixty-four qualities held together?"

He said, "Son of noble family, those sixty-four qualities are held together by one hundred twenty-eight qualities. What are the one hundred twenty-eight qualities? They are as follows. Inward examination is held together by examining emptiness and by examining intrinsic nature. Restraint of the sense faculties is held together by mindfulness and vigilance. Guarding against external objects is held together by keeping the faculties concealed and by not letting them run off. Being wary of those who are learned and realized is held together by examining one's own errors as faults and by regarding the errors of others as faults. Seeking the Dharma is held together by mastering one's own promises and by dispelling the regrets of others. Desiring the Dharma is held together by being inclined toward the Dharma and by flowing toward the Dharma. A pleasing body is held together by freedom from sleepiness and freedom from dullness. A pleasing mind is held together by astuteness and by removing adventitious afflictions. Not being conceited is held together by abandoning arrogance and by abandoning pomp. Practicing the Dharma is held together by abandoning nonvirtuous qualities and by perfecting virtuous

qualities. A body without crookedness is held together by not being harsh and by not being rough. A mind without crookedness is held together by right mindfulness and right meditative absorption. Removing the three stains is held together by meditating on the unattractive and by meditating on loving-kindness. Cultivating the three liberations is held together by the absence of a person and by the ultimate. Not being harsh is held together by benefit and happiness.

Not slandering is held together by not causing division and by reconciling those who are divided. Protecting oneself is held together by doing no wrong at all and by accumulating every kind of merit. Protecting others is held together by patience and by gentleness. Making no distinctions is held together by a mind like space and a mind like the wind. A single taste is held together by suchness and by the realm of phenomena. The dreamlike nature is held together by seeing, hearing, remembering, and knowing, and by the very nature of experiencing phenomena. The illusory nature is held together by producing and by conceptualizing. The superknowledges are held together by relying on the meaning and by relying on primordial wisdom. Skillful means is held together by looking with wisdom and by looking to sentient beings. Aspiration is held together by being free of transgression and by not concealing transgressions. Trust in the ripening of karma is held together by heedfulness in this life and by seeing the danger of misdeeds in the world beyond. Having few desires is held together by keeping to the measure of what is allowable and by being insatiable for wisdom. Contentment is held together by being easy to satisfy and easy to support. Not being agitated is held together by reaching the utmost limit and by reaching the final consummation. Not quarreling is held together by truthfulness and by delight in the Dharma. Casting off the clinging to 'I' is held together by fully understanding its cause and by completely destroying views. Abandoning the clinging to 'mine' is held together by having nothing as 'mine' and by having no possessiveness. Looking to the awakening mind is held together by not desiring the Lesser Vehicle and by compassion for all sentient beings. Relying on the seat of awakening is held together by having conquered all māras and by awakening fully and perfectly to all phenomena. Recognizing the deeds of Māra is held together by the instruction of the spiritual friend and by diligence in the Perfection of Wisdom. The blessing of the buddhas is held together by doing just as one has said and by never abandoning any sentient being. A mind that does not change is held together by a mind like the earth and by

having abandoned attachment and anger. Freedom from restlessness is held together by abandoning restlessness and regret and by examining impermanence. Being like a mountain is held together by being neither high nor low. Being unshakable is held together by not breaking one's promises and by fulfilling one's promises. Doing what ought to be done well is held together by freedom from torment and freedom from regret. Not causing torment is held together by pure moral discipline and pure meditative absorption. Truthfulness is held together by conventional truth and ultimate truth. Correctness is held together by suchness and by reality. According with dependence is held together by causes and conditions. Fully abandoning permanence and annihilation is held together by non-arising and non-cessation. Reasoning is held together by trust in the ripening of karma and by not contradicting karma. Method is held together by the mode of isolation and the mode of non-arising. The correct exertions are held together by abandoning nonvirtuous qualities and by not letting virtuous qualities go to waste. Never abandoning diligence is held together by strength of body and strength of mind. Valor is held together by enthusiasm and by overcoming others. Effort is held together by not clinging to it and by not turning back. The spiritual friend is held together by rising to greet him and by serving him. Seeking the Dharma is held together by desiring primordial wisdom and by desiring liberation. The prerequisites for calm abiding are held together by solitude of body and solitude of mind. The prerequisites for insight are held together by never being sated in seeking learning and by proper attention. The wish to listen is held together by the act of joining the palms and by bowing the body low. Showing respect is held together by truthfulness and by not deceiving. Lightness of body is held together by knowing the right measure of food and by persevering in the practice of not sleeping in the first and last watches of the night. Lightness of mind is held together by aspiration and by analysis. Disenchantment is held together by impermanence and suffering. Freedom from attachment is held together by having nothing as 'mine' and by having no possessiveness. A cause is held together by not going to waste and by turning back from its own cause. A result is held together by not failing, each in its own way, and by taking hold of the result according to one's inclination.

"Son of noble family, those sixty-four qualities are held together by these one hundred twenty-eight qualities. Son of noble family, this is a teaching of all phenomena in brief. If I were to teach at greater length than a single word, at

greater length than two words, and were to give the teaching of the Dharma for an eon or for more than an eon, the nature of phenomena would not be exhausted, nor would my eloquence be exhausted."

When this Dharma discourse, the Chapter on the Gathering of Qualities, had been taught, the bodhisattva Ratnapāṇi, in order to honor the bodhisattva Gaganagañja and this Dharma discourse, covered this great trichiliocosm with his jewel right hand. Then, at that very instant, all the flowers, incense, perfumes, garlands, ointments, powders, cloths, parasols, victory banners, pennants, music, and sounds of cymbals that there were in the worlds of the ten directions came pouring down from that jewel right hand. That rain of flowers covered this entire great trichiliocosm knee-deep, and the whole expanse of the sky was beautifully adorned with parasols, victory banners, pennants, and cloths. From those sounds of cymbals there also came verses such as these:

Rich in qualities, flourishing in qualities, filled with hundreds of qualities,
Dispelling the realms of Māra, endowed with mindfulness, intelligence, and realization,
The voice of the holy being, the supreme ascetic, comes forth in beauty.
Ranging through the ten directions, it dispels existence.
One who flourishes greatly through the excellence of utmost devotion,

He dispels a hundred existences and is free of dust and darkness;
He ferries beings, gods and humans, to the imperishable city.
Beyond existence, endowed with the ten powers, his mind is equal to space;
He utters sounds beautiful and most melodious, his countenance utterly at peace.
Without baseness, unstinting, stainless, he utterly dispels all stains;
Unequaled in the three existences, he is worshiped by gods and humans.
Beyond existence, he gives happiness to beings and works for their benefit;
He has practiced well the conduct of mindfulness, intelligence, realization, and devotion.
With the ten powers and with supreme power he crushes the powers of others;
Scattering the hostile armies, he attains the deathless state.
Beyond existence, the holy being also utters the sound of the wise.
Without going anywhere from this assembly, without stirring,
He has tamed many gods and humans throughout the ten directions.
Abiding nowhere, he abides just as his understanding is;
Without moving from the realm of phenomena, he makes the earth move.

Just as the sun's light dispels darkness and removes the dust,
So too this holy being dispels dust and darkness.
Blazing with the light of wisdom, flourishing in the glory of light,
When the Sage's light pervades, all the abodes of Māra grow dim.
Like the wind in the sky, he follows the conduct of beings;
Not abiding, without conceptualizing, free of all thought,
Following after all beings, his mind is equal to space.
To such heirs of the Victor gods and humans pay homage.
One might be able to measure the waters of the oceans of a trichiliocosm;
One might be able to describe the tracks of birds in the sky of the ten directions;
Someone might make all sentient beings of a single mind;
But the great qualities of the Sage's heirs cannot be exhausted.

When this teaching of practice in verse had been spoken, Māra the Wicked One conjured up a fourfold army and went to the courtyard of the Blessed One's assembly. Remaining outside the courtyard, he took on the form of a householder, went to where the Blessed One was, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet, and said to the Blessed One, "The bodhisattvas Gaganagañja and Ratnapāṇi, these two holy beings, possess immeasurable qualities, and likewise other bodhisattvas too display such wondrous and marvelous qualities and miracles in the world. But, Blessed One, will there be any sentient beings who trust in these miracles?"

The Blessed One said, "As much water as might be taken from the great ocean with the tip of a hair, that many sentient beings will trust in the miracles of these holy beings. Those who will not be inclined toward them will be more numerous even than the whole mass of the ocean's water."

Then, hearing these words, Māra the Wicked One was delighted, pleased, and overjoyed. Thrilled, and filled with joy, delight, and happiness, he danced and departed from the assembly.

Then the venerable Śāriputra said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, why is this man so delighted, and why is he leaving this assembly?"

The Blessed One said, "Śāriputra, that is Māra. He came into the presence of the Tathāgata in the form of a householder in order to make this Dharma discourse disappear. Having heard that only a few sentient beings will be inclined toward this Dharma discourse, he rejoiced in this way, and he leaves

this assembly exclaiming, 'The side of the ascetic Gautama is small, and my side is large!'"

Then the bodhisattva Gaganagañja said to Māra the Wicked One, "Wicked One, having shown your face, why are you going back?"

Then Māra the Wicked One thought, "If the bodhisattva Gaganagañja and the other bodhisattvas have noticed me, what need is there to mention the Tathāgata? I shall now go back to my own abode."

Then the bodhisattva Gaganagañja exercised his power so that Māra the Wicked One and his retinue remained in the middle of the sky, unable to go to their own abode. Then the bodhisattva Gaganagañja said to Māra the Wicked One, "Wicked One, since space is unobstructed, why do you not go to your own abode?"

Māra said, "Son of noble family, for you space may be no obstruction, but we see darkness. Whenever we look away, we see pitch-black darkness. When we look toward the maṇḍala of the Blessed One's assembly, then we see light everywhere."

He said, "Wicked One, so it is. It has been taught that the darkness of sentient beings who set their minds on the bright qualities is the deed of Māra."

Māra said, "Holy being, from this day on I will not do the deeds of Māra."

He said, "Among sentient beings such as you, it is hard to find one who keeps to a promise. Wicked One, come down with your retinue and listen to the Dharma and Vinaya taught by the Tathāgata."

Then Māra the Wicked One, against his will, came down with his retinue from the middle of the sky.

Then the bodhisattva Gaganagañja said to that assembly of bodhisattvas, "Sons of noble family, speak with eloquence on the Dharma doors for passing entirely beyond the paths of the deeds of Māra."

At that time the bodhisattva named Golden Mountain King spoke these words: "Those who completely reject objects are attached to the domain of Māra. Those who know that all objects are the domain of the Buddha know the domain of the Buddha. If one does not see even the domain of the Buddha, how could one see one's own domain? The bodhisattva who has thus completely transcended objects has passed entirely beyond the domain of Māra. This is a Dharma door for passing entirely beyond the domain of Māra."

The bodhisattva Ratnaśrī said: "The mind's apprehending of an object is the domain of Māra. What could Māra do to one who apprehends no phenomenon whatsoever? Such a one is found through having no basis; he is not found through reliance on anything, and he also comes to be conceived of in terms of time. That is the Dharma door called the bodhisattva's passing entirely beyond the domain of Māra."

The bodhisattva Ratnapāṇi said: "Māra finds an opening in one who has grasping, but one who grasps no phenomenon whatsoever disputes with no one. Because he is single and without duality, he does not dwell together even with his own mind and its abiding, so what need is there to speak of dwelling together with Māra? The bodhisattva who does not abide passes entirely beyond the domain of Māra."

The bodhisattva Ratnodgata said: "Whatever is a downfall is a summons, and Māra finds an opening in whatever summons. In one who does not fall, consciousness that follows after signs does not arise. The bodhisattva who abides firmly at the limit of signlessness passes entirely beyond the domain of Māra."

The bodhisattva Ratnacitta said: "The Blessed One too has said that afflictions are like reflections and mirages. What is like a reflection or a mirage has no transference and no non-transference, no coming and no going; it is neither within nor without. One who knows it as not abiding in an object and not abiding in any direction does not dwell together with any affliction. Because he does not conceptualize, he does not arouse afflictions. Because he does not conceptualize, he does not suppress afflictions. The bodhisattva who thus does not conceptualize and has abandoned all imagining passes entirely beyond the domain of Māra."

The bodhisattva Ratnākara said: "Whatever is delight is latent tendency. Whatever is displeasure is anger. One in whom there is neither delight nor displeasure will become neither attached nor hostile. Being without attachment and without hostility is called abiding in sameness. One who abides in sameness makes no phenomenon whatsoever into something separate. One who abides in non-separateness does not think in terms of same and not same, and Māra finds no opening in one who has attained the inconceivable Dharma."

The bodhisattva Jewel Relinquisher said: "The deeds of Māra rise up from the rising up of the self. What could Māra do to one who abides in the purity of the

self? Why is that? Because the self is pure, the afflictions are pure. Because the afflictions are pure, all phenomena are pure. The purity of all phenomena is the purity of space, and the bodhisattva who abides in the purity of space passes entirely beyond the domain of Māra."

The bodhisattva Dharmarāja said: "Just as one who has received royal empowerment, who possesses power and a great retinue, fears no one, in the same way a bodhisattva who has received empowerment and possesses a retinue of the precious Dharma cannot be frightened by any of the māras. Here, empowerment is the complete perfection of the ultimate qualities of a buddha. The retinue of the precious Dharma is the upholding of the teachings spoken by the buddhas of the ten directions. A bodhisattva who abides in this way is said to have passed entirely beyond every domain of Māra. This is the Dharma door called passing entirely beyond the domain of Māra."

The bodhisattva Mountain Crusher King said: "It is like this: just as wind enters through a hole, so wherever there is a hole in the mind, there Māra finds an opening. Therefore a bodhisattva should always keep his mind free of holes. Here, the mind without holes is the complete perfection of emptiness endowed with the supreme of all aspects. This is the illuminating Dharma door called the bodhisattva's passing entirely beyond the domain of Māra."

The bodhisattva Priyadarśana said: "Among all things seen, however small, seeing the Buddha and the Dharma is called the supreme of them. Here, seeing the Buddha is not seeing him as form, and not seeing him as feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness. Not seeing any phenomena at all is true seeing, and true seeing is seeing the Buddha. Seeing the Dharma is not engaging in any mental activity at all. Seeing what is unchanging is freedom from attachment, and freedom from attachment is called seeing the Dharma. The bodhisattva who thus comes to possess the seeing of the Buddha and the seeing of the Dharma passes entirely beyond the domain of Māra. That is the Dharma door called passing entirely beyond the domain of Māra."

The bodhisattva Master of Illusion said: "The deeds of Māra arise from wavering, conceit, and agitation. A bodhisattva should not create any ground from which wavering, conceit, and agitation arise. That ground is improper attention. By applying himself properly, he does not waver, is not conceited, and is not agitated. Because he does not waver, is not conceited, and is not agitated, he passes entirely beyond the domain of Māra."

The bodhisattva Guṇarājaprabhāsa said: "As many antidotes as there are, so many are the deeds of Māra. The absence of antidotes is the realm of phenomena (dharmadhātu). All phenomena are gathered together in the realm of phenomena; therefore, whoever realizes the realm of phenomena realizes all phenomena. Apart from the realm of phenomena, the deeds of Māra are not found. As the realm of phenomena is, so too are the deeds of Māra; they are not different from the suchness of the realm of phenomena. The bodhisattva who thus follows the entry into the single way passes entirely beyond the domain of Māra."

The bodhisattva Gandhahastin said: "Māra finds an opening in the weak; Māra finds no opening in those endowed with strength. Here, the weak are those who are frightened by the three doors of liberation. Those endowed with strength are those who are not frightened by the three doors of liberation: because they perceive directly, they are not frightened.

Because they realize thoroughly, they are not frightened. Because they have meditated deeply, they are not frightened; and being without fear, they pass entirely beyond the domain of Māra. That is the illuminating Dharma door called passing entirely beyond the domain of Māra."

The bodhisattva Maitreya said: "It is like this: just as the waters of the great ocean have a single taste, so in this great ocean of the wisdom of the Dharma all phenomena too have a single taste. The deeds of Māra and the activities of the Buddha are all alike in being emptiness, alike in being signless, alike in being wishless, alike in being unborn, and alike in being unarisen. The bodhisattva who has entered into the single taste passes entirely beyond the domain of Māra."

The bodhisattva Gaganagañja said: "O friends, space has passed entirely beyond all objects. Space is not an object of the eye, nor an object of the ear, the nose, the tongue, the body, or the mind. All phenomena are objects that have the essential nature of space, and body and speech are the light of wisdom that follows the sameness of space. The bodhisattva who has attained the light of wisdom passes entirely beyond the domain of Māra. That is the Dharma door called passing entirely beyond the domain of Māra."

The bodhisattva Mañjuśrī said: "Holy beings, whatever you have all explained, all of it is the deeds of Māra and the domain of Māra. Why is that? Whatever is put into letters is cognition, whereas the speech of the Buddha is without letters. As many words as there are, so many are the deeds of Māra. What

could Māra do to that which is without words? That which is without words is without cognition: it does not see self and other at all. Because there is no self and no other, it does not abide in benefiting or harming any phenomenon whatsoever. To realize it in this way is to pass entirely beyond the domain of Māra. Son of noble family, that is the Dharma door called the bodhisattva's passing entirely beyond the domain of Māra."

Then the bodhisattva Gaganagañja spoke these words to Māra the Wicked One: "Wicked One, have you heard this Dharma door for passing entirely beyond the domain of Māra?"

He replied, "I have heard it."

He asked, "Wicked One, are you able to perform the deeds of Māra against bodhisattvas who have fully entered into a Dharma way such as this?"

He replied, "Son of noble family, if I am unable to perform the deeds of Māra even against those who have heard or are listening to this Dharma door for passing entirely beyond the domain of Māra, what need is there to speak of bodhisattvas who have realized it directly through wisdom?"

Then the four gods who serve the bodhisattva, namely Endowed with Solitude, Endowed with a Joyful Host, Fragrant One, and Possessor of Mansions, spoke these words to Māra the Wicked One: "Wicked One, formerly, at the seat of awakening, right before your eyes, you came against the Blessed One with such power, such ferocity, such array, and such a retinue. Then the Blessed One struck the earth with his precious hand, which had gathered the accumulations of merit and wisdom through loving-kindness, compassion, generosity, discipline, perfect restraint, gentleness, moral discipline, learning, meditative absorption, wisdom, and diligence steadfast and blazing; the boundless, limitless world systems quaked, and you, together with your forces and your retinue, were utterly defeated. Though it happened thus right before your eyes, will you still come to perform the deeds of Māra against the Blessed One and the bodhisattvas? Perform acts of worship to the Tathāgata and his retinue of bodhisattvas!"

Then Māra the Wicked One magically emanated eighty-four thousand koṭis of jewel parasols and offered them to the Blessed One and his retinue. Carrying many different kinds of divine flowers, incense, garlands, and ointments, he scattered them toward where the Blessed One was, and he and his retinue spoke these words: "If the bodhisattva Gaganagañja will bestow this sky treasury upon us, we shall generate the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and

complete awakening."

The bodhisattva Gaganagañja said, "Wicked One, do you see this sky treasury?"

He replied, "Son of noble family, I see it. Here I see something far greater than all the arrays of the entire desire realm, than all the arrays of all the buddha fields, and than all the arrays of my own abode. There is no divine or human wealth of jewels whatsoever that is not present in it."

He said, "Wicked One, I give you all of these sky treasuries. Generate the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening!"

Then Māra the Wicked One, together with eighty-four thousand living beings, generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

At that time five hundred sons of Māra, headed by Durmukha, who had no faith and who longed for what is not the Dharma, said these words: "Even though our father has generated the mind set on awakening, we shall strive to make a Dharma discourse such as this decline."

At that time the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja: "Son of noble family, let your eloquence flow with the words of the vidyā mantra that subdues Māra, those words of your vidyā mantra by which you have established in awakening Māras as numerous as the grains of sand of the river Ganges."

Then the bodhisattva Gaganagañja at that time spoke these words of the vidyā mantra:

abatte bibatte saṃbatte sahitānusandhi duruttaraṇo nirghatani maityayukte kāruṇaniṣyante satyabati bhūrakṣe dharmanibritte dharmarakṣe akkhule nikhilini hulu hulu hulu hulu hulu tatkare tathābadite śīlaanubarti akṣayanirdeśe kleśapariṣe buddhaadhiṣṭhitedharmajvalini saṃghaanugame anuddhare antikramaṇiye nigrahaṇimārapakṣasyayuktikṛte adante aśaste svabikhayaanugame āryaguṇakare siddhisiddhibate mokṣaanukule nigrahanibarapratināṃ dārṣaṇimaraparṣata abaśantācatvāromahārājāna śakrodebānāṃindrabrahmasahapati budhaprasannānāṃ debanāga yakṣakr̄taṃparitrāṇāṃ sthāpitānsvastyayānāṃ dharmabhanakanāṃ arakṣaye saddharmasyacaparigrahaye

As soon as the bodhisattva Gaganagañja had spoken these words of the vidyā mantra, in that very instant this great trichiliocosm shook in six ways. Those five hundred sons of Māra, who had no faith and who longed for what is not

the Dharma, heard a voice from the sky saying: "Whatever māra, son of the Māra class, or god of the Māra class hears these words of the vidyā mantra and yet does not generate the mind set on awakening and does not abandon the deeds of Māra, the yakṣa Vajrapāṇi will crush his crown with a vajra that blazes all around and blazes intensely." Having heard this, those sons of Māra looked up into the sky, and they saw five hundred Vajrapāṇis, each holding a fiercely blazing vajra above each one's head. Frightened and terrified, they generated the mind set on awakening.

Then at that time the Blessed One smiled, and the venerable Ānanda asked the Blessed One the reason for that smile. The Blessed One said to him, "Ānanda, do you see these five hundred sons of Māra, who, frightened and terrified, have generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening?"

He replied, "Blessed One, I see them."

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, when Māra the Wicked One attains awakening, in that buddha field of his all of them will become bodhisattvas with various names."

Then the venerable Ānanda said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, when will Māra the Wicked One fully awaken into unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening? Once he has attained awakening, what will he be called? And what will his world system be called?"

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, this Māra the Wicked One will still go on performing the activities of Māra in the buddha fields of the ten directions. From those buddhas, the blessed ones, he will also hear this teaching of the Dharma, the vajra essence that thoroughly destroys the afflictions, and he will see the secret rites, the deportment, the qualities, the foundations of moral discipline, the conduct, the rituals, and the practices of the buddhas and bodhisattvas. By the time his awakening mind has become firm, a tathāgata called Infinite Stainless Crest will appear, and in his teaching this Māra the Wicked One will at the last still perform the deeds of Māra. Then, his roots of virtue having ripened, with a mind that is no mind he will follow the complete purity of all the light of the Buddha and the Dharma, and he will generate the awakening mind. After that he will please tathāgatas beyond number and beyond reckoning; he will honor them, revere them, esteem them, and worship them. He will go forth in the teachings of those buddhas, the blessed ones. Having gone forth, he will uphold the true Dharma throughout the three

times, and he will also ripen immeasurable sentient beings for awakening. Then, after forty-four incalculable eons, he will fully awaken into unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. In the eon called Purification, in the world system called Completely Pure Abiding, he will appear in the world as the tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha called Attainer of the Light of the Well-Abiding Dharma, endowed with knowledge and conduct, and so on up to buddha, blessed one.

"Moreover, Ānanda, that world system Completely Pure Abiding will be prosperous, flourishing, happy, blessed with good harvests, and filled with gods and humans. For example, Ānanda, just as are the enjoyments and pleasures of the gods of Tuṣita, so too will be the enjoyments and pleasures of those beings. Ānanda, the life span of the tathāgata called Attainer of the Light of the Well-Abiding Dharma will last forty intermediate eons. He will have a great assembly of śrāvakas numbering sixty-four koṭis, and a saṅgha of twelve thousand bodhisattvas. Ānanda, all those māras, sons of Māra, and gods of the Māra class who have now entered upon unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening will be born in that world system Completely Pure Abiding, and in the buddha field of that blessed tathāgata, Attainer of the Light of the Well-Abiding Dharma, that tathāgata will prophesy all of them to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

When this explanation of the prophecy concerning Māra the Wicked One had been taught, Śakra, Brahmā, and the world guardians gathered in that assembly were all amazed, and they uttered this inspired utterance: "Even though he has performed so many deeds of Māra, because seeing the Tathāgata is never fruitless, he will pass into nirvāṇa in unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Wondrous is the Dharma and Vinaya well spoken by the Buddha, the Blessed One! Blessed One, what son or daughter of noble family, one person, could take the measure of another person? Blessed One, this domain of the Buddha is not the ground of any śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha."

The Blessed One said: "So it is. It is just as you have said, friends: this is the domain of the Buddha. Yet, friends, the mind arises in dependence. I see these beings lifting their feet with attachment and setting them down free of attachment; taking up the Dharma robe with affliction and wearing it free of affliction; partaking of morsels of food with grasping and without grasping. O friends, the conduct of beings is varied. There are beings who understand when merely the heading is stated, beings who understand through detailed

explanation, and beings devoted to the words; to them the Tathāgata speaks discourses that draw each of them, as befits them, into the Dharma.

"O friends, the afflictions do not abide in an object, nor do they abide in any direction. The afflictions have no accumulation and no substance as aggregates. Because what is improper arises, afflictions arise; because what is proper arises, purification arises. Thus, if the arising of affliction is examined properly, purification will arise. It was with this in mind that I spoke these words: 'If one knows wrong view, just as it truly is, as wrong view, that is one's right view.' Wrong view has never become right view, will not become it, and does not become it. Yet when one recognizes wrong view as wrong view, and so does not abide in it, does not fully abide in it, does not engage in it, and does not fully engage in it, that is entry onto the path of right view, and this is called right view.

"O friends, the afflictions obscure; purification illuminates. The afflictions are weak; insight is strong. The afflictions are adventitious; the intrinsic nature is pure at the root. The afflictions are imagining; the intrinsic nature is free of imagining.

"O friends, it is like this: this great earth rests on water, water rests on wind, wind rests on space, and space rests on nothing. In the same way, of the earth element, the water element, the fire element, and the wind element, more powerful and more solid than these four elements is the space element within them all, which is unaccumulated. What is unaccumulated is unborn and unceasing; it abides in its own natural way. Of these, the three elements are subject to arising and destruction; they do not abide and do not last long. They appear to change, but in the space element there is no change whatsoever.

"In the same way, the aggregates, elements, and sense sources rest on karma and affliction. Karma and affliction rest on improper attention. Improper attention rests on the completely pure intrinsic nature. Therefore it is said that the mind, luminous by nature, is defiled by adventitious afflictions. Improper attention, karma and affliction, and all the aggregates, elements, and sense sources arise when they are fully gathered by causes and conditions, and cease when causes and conditions are not assembled. But in their intrinsic nature there is no cause, no condition, no assembly, no arising, and no ceasing. Here, the intrinsic nature is like the space element; improper attention is like wind; karma and affliction are like water; and the aggregates, elements, and sense sources are like the earth element. Therefore all

phenomena are said to be cut off at the root: their root is the root without essence, the root without abiding, the root of purity, the root that is no root.

"O friends, that is the illuminating Dharma door called the door of the purity of intrinsic nature. Relying on this door, bodhisattvas do not abide in any door of affliction, nor do they take pride in any door of purification. Having completely destroyed all pride, they understand the path that proceeds in conformity with the way, and they pass entirely beyond the domain of Māra. Having passed entirely beyond the domain of Māra, they become firmly established in the domain of the Buddha. Being firmly established in the domain of the Buddha, they enter the domain of all sentient beings. Having entered the domain of all sentient beings, they do not disturb the domain of the realm of phenomena. Following the realm of phenomena and attaining sameness without distinction, they attain the wisdom of omniscience."

When this teaching was explained, many bodhisattvas became free of all obscurations of karma, affliction, and phenomena, and of all outbursts of remorse, and they attained acceptance of the unborn nature of phenomena.

The Noble Request of Gaganagañja: the eighth and final fascicle.

Then the layman named Śrīgupta bowed down at the feet of the Blessed One and said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, this Dharma discourse, the door to the liberation of phenomena, was explained by the Blessed One for my sake. Why is that? Blessed One, in order to kill the Blessed One I filled the way with fire and prepared food mixed with poison. Because of that, although I have heard much Dharma from the Blessed One, I was unable to dispel my remorse. But, Blessed One, having heard this Dharma discourse, all that remorse has vanished, and light has dawned on all phenomena. Blessed One, I am without remorse and without doubt; having attained this light, I shall generate the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Blessed One, just like Māra the Wicked One, I too shall go on to distinction."

The Blessed One said: "Excellent, householder, excellent! You have understood the meaning of what I have explained. Householder, I prophesy for you that, through this mind and this superior intention, you will honor, revere, and esteem all the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the Good Eon, and worship them; in their presence you will practice the holy life, and you will also uphold their true Dharma.

After that, you will please buddhas, blessed ones, beyond all counting, and after seven hundred incalculable eons, in the eon called Utterly Stainless, you

will appear in the world as the tathāgata called Dispeller of All Outbursts, endowed with knowledge and conduct, and so on up to buddha, blessed one."

Then the layman Śrīgupta, having heard from the Blessed One the prophecy of his unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, was satisfied, delighted, and overjoyed. Filled with rapture, joy and happiness arose in him; he offered all the ornaments he was wearing to the body of the Blessed One and spoke these words: "Blessed One, in my house there are four great treasures, filled with many jewels and with gold. Of these, one great treasure I give to the women of the household, the male servants, the female servants, and the workers. One great treasure I give to all the poor and to beggars. One great treasure I offer to the Saṅgha of monks of the four directions, the monks who have come from the four directions. One great treasure I offer to the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha. Blessed One, I have become unburdened; I have no sense of 'mine' and no possessiveness. Blessed One, I request to go forth in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, to receive full ordination, and to attain the state of a monk."

The layman Śrīgupta went forth in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, received full ordination, and attained the state of a monk.

Then the bodhisattva Gaganagañja said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, when the Tathāgata has passed into parinirvāṇa, who will uphold this awakening, which was accomplished over koṭis of incalculable eons?"

Then sixty koṭis of bodhisattvas rose from that assembly, and all of them joined their palms, bowed to the Blessed One, and with one voice spoke these verses:

"Blessed One, supreme among two-footed beings,
When you have passed into nirvāṇa, we,
Giving up even body and life,
Are eager to uphold the true Dharma.

"Having given up gain and honor
And utterly renounced all clinging,
We shall never let go of this Dharma
That teaches the wisdom of the Buddha.

"In order to uphold the true Dharma,
Abuse and harsh speech
And words of slander too

We shall accept with patience.

"Having firmly taken up this way,
Reproach and threats,
Dispraise and unpleasant words,
All these we shall endure.

"Firmly set on apprehended objects,
Messengers of Māra, on Māra's side,
Monks who disparage
The true Dharma will appear.

"With corrupt discipline and evil ways,
They will associate and dwell with householders;
Greedy for honor and for gain,
They will not seek this Dharma.

"Mixing with the worldly materialists (Lokāyatas),
Greatly praising themselves
And disparaging those who are truly gentle,
Unlearned and arrogant ones will appear.

"Abandoning dwellings in the wilderness,
They will always delight in bustle;
They will be devoted to worldly spells
And firmly set in the view of the transitory collection.

"The unlearned will always be eager
To take charge of the Saṅgha's affairs;
Abandoning meditation and meditators,
They will not keep company with the Three Jewels.

"Not through learning and not through discipline
Will they seek gain within the assembly;
Again and again intent on gifts,
They will be full of thoughts and full of sorrow.

"Holding to the notion of 'mine,'
They will delight in friends, in begging and giving, and in households;
They will frequent those places
And engage in worldly talk.

"Matters of fields and matters of the household,
Buying and selling, will occupy them;
Though they own plows and harrows,
They will claim, 'We are ascetics.'

"They will act by way of apprehended objects,
Abiding in diverse views;
When they hear the Dharma of emptiness,
They will be as if at the edge of a precipice.

"Not practicing for the world beyond,
They will reject the ripening of karma;
Fully given to speaking lies,
They will hold what is not Dharma to be Dharma.

"When ascetics and kings are in turmoil,
And all is thus utterly savage
And falling into ruin, for the sake of beings
We shall uphold the true Dharma.

"They will not practice the sūtras
In harmony with one another;
Each of them will always
Take delight in his own doctrines.

"The sūtras that are profound
And possess the fruit of liberation
They will not uphold;
Instead they will engage in all kinds of talk.

"At such a time as this,
The well-spoken teachings,
Rich in meaning and in wording,
Will be utterly destroyed.

"At that time beings too
Will be utterly destroyed;
Threatened by the acts of kings,
Frightened and terrified, they will flee.

"When such a time of evil comes,
A time of ruin that knows no end,
This Dharma that the Buddha taught

We shall uphold.

"Having firmly taken up this way,
Toward beings who do not abide in the Dharma
We shall have loving-kindness,
And for them we shall have compassion too.

"Seeing beings set on gain and desire,
Whose discipline is corrupt,
We shall shed tears, thinking,
'What will become of their destiny?'

"Even if we suddenly come upon
Those who disparage the true Dharma,
We shall not revile them,
But from afar we shall seek loving-kindness.

"Fully restrained, we shall guard
Our deeds of speech as best we can;
To one firmly set in evil
We shall not speak abruptly.

"Having ripened people
With gifts of wealth and with respect,
Through a true and faultless way of conduct
We shall urge them on later.

"Abandoning household and all clinging,
With few concerns and few activities,
Keeping to remote wilderness,
We shall become like wild deer.

"Delighting in the lineage of the noble ones,
Abiding in purified discipline,
Possessed of meditative equipoise and wisdom,
We shall be free of heedlessness.

"Disciplined and at peace,
Liberated, even when we enter a village,
To those beings who seek the Dharma
We shall teach the Dharma.

"Knowing that they long for the Dharma,
We shall go even to places very far away.
Having found delight and devotion in the Dharma,
We shall also work for the benefit of beings.

"Even when we plainly see
The many delusions of beings,
Firmly established in the Dharma,
We shall carefully examine ourselves.

"Whether we are honored or not honored,
Becoming like Sumeru,
Unstained by the world,
We shall become guides of the world.

"Even when we learn of the ill repute
Of monks who have fallen from discipline,
We shall take our own deeds as our own;
Their deeds will not ripen upon us.

"When we abide in these dharmas,
Even our persecutors will feel remorse,
Saying, 'Such qualities as these
We in no way possess.'

"'We are ascetics in name only,
Without the qualities of an ascetic':
On hearing such true reproof,
They will reject this sūtra.

"Just as those whose noses and ears are cut off
Take no delight in a mirror,
So those who hear true reproof
Will reject the true Dharma.

"There will appear monks
Who uphold the true Dharma;
Though others pretend to be like them,
None of those will listen to this Dharma.

"They will deceive even kings
And will divide the multitude,
Yet through the blessing of the Buddha

Those beings will always hear the Dharma.

"In that evil time, we,
For the benefit of beings,
Giving up even body and life,
Shall uphold the true Dharma.

"In that time of great peril,
Not in mere words,
But making practice the very heart of it:
Protector, you know our intention.

"If one upholds this true Dharma,
How great is the mass of merit?
We ask the Dharmarāja, the maker of light,
Who illuminates the world."

Then the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, "Son of noble family, suppose, for example, that each of the thirty thousand world systems in the east were ground into dust, into particles the size of the finest atoms; and likewise, in the south, the west, the north, above and below, in all ten directions, each of the thirty thousand world systems were ground into the dust of the finest atoms. Then suppose that, for every one of all those atoms, one passed eastward beyond as many buddha fields as there are atoms and set down a single atom, and in this way set down all those atoms toward the east until they were used up: even so, there would be no end to the buddha fields of the east. As it is in the east, so in each of all the ten directions there are that many buddha fields. Son of noble family, what do you think? Could one ascertain the measure or the limit of the atoms of those buddha fields of the ten directions, set down in the ten directions in this way?"

He replied, "Blessed One, that could not be done, except that the Tathāgata knows it through a buddha's unobstructed wisdom."

The Blessed One said, "Son of noble family, suppose that, of all those buddha fields, all the buddha fields in which those atoms were set down became a single city, surrounded by a wall, and that this city, from the mass of water below up to the Peak of Existence, were completely filled with nothing but fine mustard seeds. Son of noble family, what do you think? Would those mustard seeds be many?"

He replied, "Blessed One, how wonderful is the way the Tathāgata has found this example! Blessed One, those beings who come to have faith on hearing this example will also be endowed with wonderful and marvelous qualities."

The Blessed One said, "Son of noble family, the Tathāgata knows perfectly that there are so many hundreds of those mustard seeds, or so many thousands, or so many hundreds of thousands, or so many of the great numbers called dense, filled, surpassing and imperturbable; or that there are as many as this buddha field, or as many as a hundred buddha fields, or as many as a thousand buddha fields, or as many as a hundred thousand buddha fields.

"Son of noble family, suppose someone who longs for awakening were to fill that many buddha fields completely with the seven precious substances and give them as a gift. Holy persons who uphold the true Dharma and abide in qualities such as these, if they uphold the true Dharma of even a single tathāgata, generate far more merit than that.

"Suppose someone were to honor, revere and esteem as many buddha blessed ones as there are mustard seeds, and make offerings to them. One who has acceptance of the profound Dharma generates far more merit than that.

"Suppose someone were to give as many unrestricted sacrificial offerings as there are mustard seeds. If another, with a mind free of anger toward all beings, delighting greatly in the Dharma and with patience, were to take seven steps, he would generate far more merit than that.

"Suppose someone were to attain the state of Śakra, of Brahmā, of a wheel-turning king and of a bodhisattva as many times as there are mustard seeds. If another, understanding that all conditioned things are impermanent and suffering, understanding that all phenomena are without self, and understanding that nirvāṇa is peace, were to generate great compassion for beings and, so that the lineage of the Three Jewels may not be cut off, give rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, he would generate far more merit than that."

Then the bodhisattva Gaganagañja said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, I pray that the Tathāgata bless this Dharma discourse, so that in the future, in times to come, this Dharma discourse may be practiced and may spread widely in Jambudvīpa."

The Blessed One said, "Son of noble family, for that purpose I shall speak words that summon the Four Great Kings. By these words of summoning the Four Great Kings will come, and they will strive to make this Dharma discourse endure for a long time, and to explain it in detail and teach it fully. These are the words of summoning:

namely: dhudhure dhidhire dhvajavati dhvaja alaṃkara avadvani śame śamavati śānatimukhe nigrahaparapakṣa anodhara uttvari vigama samapātha pāthaśuddhi pātha anugama pāthasandhi prajñāmukhe āryakule bhūtarakṣe amesaca menesaca tamasaca tatamasaca buddhapāda dharma anusandhi āryaganamukhama āryanirghatani ruśtaprasādani īśvarapadalokacittikṛta anurāgayantu imandharmasandhi vibhacantu nirukta nirdeśe pratirakṣantu dharmmadharaṇi

"Son of noble family, these are the words that summon the Four Great Kings."

Then the Four Great Kings, frightened and terrified, their hair standing on end, came to where the Blessed One was, bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, we, the Four Great Kings, shall stand by in order to guard, protect and shelter this Dharma discourse, to make it endure for a long time, and to sustain it. Wherever this Dharma discourse is practiced, any gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas or kiṃnaras who seek what is not the Dharma, we shall thoroughly subdue. The minds of those who seek the Dharma we shall fill with joy. We shall also arrange well the circle of that Dharma preacher's assembly. Where his words break off, we shall supply the link between the words. We shall also bestow eloquence. We shall also increase mindfulness, intelligence, understanding and joy."

When they had said this, the Blessed One said to those Four Great Kings, "Friends, you are my sons, born of the Dharma, arisen from the Dharma. Excellent, excellent, that you show such zeal to uphold my true Dharma! Through this cause that accords with the Dharma you will become lords of the world in the world, and, having completely passed beyond all worlds, you will attain final nirvāṇa in the noble element of nirvāṇa."

Then again the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, "Son of noble family, I shall speak words that summon Śakra, lord of the gods. Through those words of the secret mantra of knowledge, Śakra, lord of the gods, will stand by to guard this Dharma discourse and make it endure for a long time. The words are these:

namely: śubhe śubhamati śubhavyūhe dudare daridadurani dame śame upaśame khube ugaśame khabe ugakhara asomukhe dhāraṇi araddi śuśruṣe sahite abhedebhedasandhisaumesamavatesamarasmi aśe huhu hehe khurukhure antikrame debrlakṣasahehemahābhavabhasabrame āgacchaduśakrodevanāṃmantra daśaśatanayana varmakutadhara iśvara umarutpabhananivasi

"Son of noble family, these are the words that summon Śakra, lord of the gods. Summoned by these words of summoning, Śakra, lord of the gods, is to stand by in order to make this Dharma discourse endure for a long time."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, joy having arisen in him through the power of the Dharma, made all the dwellings of the realm of the Thirty-Three shake violently, and, with many hundreds of thousands of attendant gods, set out and came to where the Blessed One was. He bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, I am Śakra, lord of the gods, who holds sway over the gods of the Thirty-Three. Together with my host of attendant gods, I shall work earnestly to spread this Dharma discourse in Jambudvīpa. Those Dharma preachers and those who hold this sūtra I shall guard, protect and shelter by means of the Dharma, so that they come to no harm, so that they find joy, supreme joy and devotion, and so that, adorned with the ornaments of the Dharma, they enter villages, cities, market towns, provinces and royal palaces and fully expound this Dharma discourse. Blessed One, we shall go into the presence of those Dharma preachers in order to hear the Dharma. Even if they are angry and abusive, we shall accept it. We shall also guard, protect and shelter them from all the harms of Māra that create obstacles."

The Blessed One said, "Kauśika, excellent, excellent, that you, having attained lordship over the gods, have entered into lordship of the Dharma and roar the lion's roar in order to uphold the true Dharma of myself and of all the buddhas! Why is that? Kauśika, to uphold the true Dharma of a single tathāgata is to uphold the true Dharma of the buddha blessed ones of the past, the future and the present."

At that time the Blessed One again said to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, "Son of noble family, I shall speak words that summon Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world. Listen to the words of summoning through which Great Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, will stand by to guard this Dharma discourse. The words of summoning are these:

namely: maitre śubhamaitre dharmamaitre maitrya nusahitesamaitre sandhimaitre anugamamaitre anugakṣamaitre anuttvaramaitre satramaitre dharmamaitre anugrahamaitre apratisārimaitre ulalokanmaitre vilokanamaitre vilokanamaitre vebhyaḥ anugamanamaitre buddha adhiṣṭhānamaitre anurāgakṣamaitre anurāgakhaśamaitre dharmapratisāraṇamaitre mokhaśamaitre ono ononuroṃdhe virodhamaitre otomomaitre brahmavathamaitre dhyana alaṅkarmaitre tasya anusandhikāruṇamaitre tasya anusandhimutitamaitre tasyasanusandhi upekṣamaitre brahmavatha anugamanamaitre citta ūccilalyamaitre anusāraṇamaitre nistiraṇamaitre sarvata anuganamanamaitre āgacchatubrahma udprijya dānasukhena vyuttiṣṭhasvamadhe nitramamahāvimanāda vyavalokāya jambudvīpanakuruṣādharmmarakṣāna mātikramabuddhadhiṣṭhanoṃ

"Gaganagañja, these are the words that summon Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world."

Then Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, who was dwelling in the Brahmā world, heard, through the power of the Buddha and with his divine faculty of hearing, these words of loving-kindness, the secret mantra of knowledge blessed by the Buddha. Having heard them, he set out together with sixty-eight hundred thousand Brahmās and came to where the Blessed One was. He bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, since we have been blessed with the blessing of the Tathāgata, I am endowed with loving-kindness and compassion, and I shall work earnestly to guard this Dharma discourse. Those Dharma preachers who gather such Dharma of the Buddha as this, who hold, keep, read and explain this sūtra, or even keep it written in a book: whether they are staying in a wilderness, or on an out-of-the-way road, or in a village, a city or a market town, or in a province or the precincts of a royal palace, or whether they are giving a talk on the Dharma, if they explain this Dharma discourse at length, I shall keep them in mind. I shall guard, protect and shelter them. I shall give them enthusiasm. I shall bring their strength to perfection. I shall make their mindfulness firm. I shall sustain their intelligence. I shall help them follow understanding. I shall bestow eloquence. I shall bring those without faith to faith. I shall carry those with faith across to liberation. Blessed One, I shall act so that this Dharma way of the Tathāgata, upheld by us, spreads far and wide."

When he had said this, the Blessed One said to Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, "Excellent, excellent! Brahmā, because you uphold the true Dharma,

the Tathāgata rejoices in you. Just as I now turn it, so you too, Brahmā, before long will turn the wheel of Dharma. Just as you now uphold my true Dharma, so other Brahmās too will uphold your true Dharma."

At that time the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva mahāsattva Maitreya, "Maitreya, so that it may be held, kept and read, and taught at length and correctly to others as well; so that gratitude and acknowledgment of what the Tathāgata has done may arise; so that my intention may be fulfilled; so that the roots of virtue of beings may increase and be purified; so that bodhisattvas may obtain the light of the Dharma; so that all māras may be subdued, all non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) vanquished, and the ultimate Dharma upheld; and so that the lineage of the Three Jewels may not be cut off, I entrust to you this unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, accomplished over countless tens of millions of eons."

When he had said this, the bodhisattva Maitreya said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, for the time after the Tathāgata has passed into complete nirvāṇa, I shall guard this treasury of the unsurpassed jewel of the Dharma. Why is that? Blessed One, this is the true Dharma of myself and of the buddha blessed ones of the past, the future and the present. Blessed One, dwelling in the abode of Tuṣita, I shall work earnestly to guard such sūtras in every way, to uphold them, and to make them endure for a long time. Blessed One, in the future, in later times, whoever has such a sublime sūtra as this reach their ears, and having heard it, holds it, keeps it, reads it, teaches it at length to others and applies it themselves, that, Blessed One, should be known as the blessing of the bodhisattva Maitreya. Blessed One, at that time Māra's faction will also be stirred up. Yet as for the root of virtue by which each single pore of my body was accomplished, even if all the beings in a great trichiliocosm were to become Māra the Wicked One, they would not come near even a hundredth part of the root of virtue embraced by a single pore of mine, and so on, until they would not come near even a comparison with it. Blessed One, by the power of my merit and the power of my wisdom I shall utterly defeat the whole circle of Māra, and I shall guard this awakening that the Tathāgata accomplished over countless tens of millions of eons."

The Blessed One said, "Excellent, excellent, Maitreya! Maitreya, these four are the works of a bodhisattva. What are the four? They are: subduing Māra and all afflictions; overpowering all opponents in accordance with the Dharma; bringing beings to maturity; and upholding the true Dharma. Maitreya, these four are the works of a bodhisattva."

"Those four works are comprised in a single work. What is that one? It is this: upholding the true Dharma."

At that time the Blessed One said to the elder Mahākāśyapa and to the venerable Ānanda, "Kāśyapa and Ānanda, so that it may be held, kept and read, and taught at length and correctly to others as well, I entrust this unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening to you."

Mahākāśyapa said, "Blessed One, I shall uphold this awakening of the Tathāgata to the full extent of my might, strength and ability."

Ānanda said, "Blessed One, this Dharma discourse has been taken up by us, and through the blessing of the Tathāgata I shall make it spread far and wide."

Then the bodhisattva mahāsattva Puṇyālaṃkāra said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, consider a sūtra such as this, spoken by the Tathāgata: profound, and profound in appearance; in which all wandering is cut off; whose definitive meaning is hard to see and hard to realize; endowed with ultimate emptiness; adorned with the ornament of moral discipline; gladdening mindfulness, samādhi, certain understanding and the mind; making the light of wisdom shine; definitively showing liberation; peaceful; unstained; to be known by the wise and the realized; praised and extolled by all the buddhas; sealed with the seal of dhāraṇī and of the king of sūtras; holding unobstructed eloquence; increasing mindfulness, intelligence, understanding and devotion; not to be overpowered by Māra or by any opponent; rejecting those of corrupt discipline; firmly established in the qualities of ascetic purification, in having few possessions, in perfected restraint and in the qualities of giving; arisen from infinite good qualities. Any son or daughter of noble family who holds, takes up, keeps, reads or masters this Dharma and wisdom of all the buddhas, or teaches it at length and correctly to others, or writes it down or has it written down, or recites it aloud, or reflects on it, or examines it, or considers it properly and with certainty, or abides earnestly in it: how much merit will they generate?"

Then the Blessed One spoke these verses in reply to the bodhisattva Puṇyālaṃkāra:

"Than a bodhisattva's giving of gifts,
Having filled with jewels all the fields
Of the vast and measureless ten directions
That the buddhas behold with their buddha eye,

Whoever keeps, reads or teaches to others
A sūtra like this, most excellent and unstained,
Spoken by many buddhas:
That one's merit is supreme by far.

"Than a bodhisattva's worship of the buddhas,
Having completely filled all those fields
With flowers, fragrances, ointments and parasols,
With banners, victory banners, pendants and fine cloth,
Whoever, when the Sugata's teaching, the true Dharma,
Is perishing and coming to an end, is heedful
And upholds the true Dharma:
That one's merit is supreme by far.

"Than filling all the oceans there are
In the ten directions with fragrant sesame oil,
Making wicks the size of Sumeru,
And offering lamps to the stūpas of the Victor,
Whoever, when this lamp of the Dharma is perishing,
Knowing that these worlds are veiled in darkness,
Upholds this Dharma spoken by the Victor:
That one's merit is supreme by far.

"Than, while seeking the supreme awakening of a buddha,
Making delightful offerings arrayed from divine substances
For many tens of millions of eons
To the guides one sees in tens of millions of fields,
Whoever, to repay what the Buddha has done,
To sustain the Three Jewels,
And to lead beings into this Dharma,
Upholds the true Dharma: that one is supreme by far.

"Whatever beings I behold with my buddha eye,
If someone were to establish them all as Śakras and Brahmās,
That person's merit would not grow as great
As that of upholding the Dharma of the protectors.

"Than establishing all those beings as arhats,
Or establishing them firmly in the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas,
Whoever, having roused the mind toward awakening,

Upholds the true Dharma is more exalted still.

"If that merit had a form,
It would fill all the fields of the ten directions.
Apart from the wisdom of the supreme among humans,
There is no vessel that could hold that merit.

"Just as, though one spoke of it for thousands of tens of millions of eons,
The wisdom of the Buddha would have no end,
So too the merit of upholding
The true Dharma of the Tathāgata has no measure."

Then the bodhisattva Puṇyālaṃkāra, having heard from the Blessed One this explanation of the merit of upholding the true Dharma, was satisfied, pleased and delighted, and overjoyed; joy and happiness arose in him, and he said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, those bodhisattvas who do not strive to uphold the true Dharma are under the sway of Māra. Blessed One, all other roots of virtue, apart from upholding the true Dharma, seem to me no bigger than a mustard seed. The root of virtue of upholding the true Dharma I perceive as vast as the element of space throughout the ten directions. Blessed One, therefore, wishing for the happiness of all beings, I shall give up even body and life, and, seeking no happiness for myself, I shall put on armor in order to uphold the true Dharma."

When this Dharma discourse had been spoken, as a result concordant with the ripening of the bodhisattva Gaganagañja's merit, bodhisattvas equal in mind to the bodhisattva Gaganagañja, in measureless buddha fields of the ten directions, caused a rain of flowers to fall from the midst of the sky in order to make offerings to this Dharma discourse. And from the sky came a voice saying this: "In adorning and upholding this chapter of the Great Assembly, the bodhisattva mahāsattva Gaganagañja has done the work of a buddha."

"Those beings who are never parted from the awakening mind and who uphold this Dharma discourse will likewise adorn the true Dharma."

Then the Blessed One at that time sent forth from his body such a light that it completely filled all the buddha fields of the ten directions. When the beginning, the middle and the end of this Dharma discourse were being taught, immeasurable, countless beings gave rise to the mind set on awakening. Immeasurable, countless beings attained acceptance. Some beings were liberated in mind. In some, the Dharma eye was purified. Some

attained freedom from desire. Some secured the excellent fortune of gods and humans, and also gathered the causes for seeing other buddhas. And the Blessed One rejoiced in all of them.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the bodhisattva mahāsattva Gaganagañja, the bodhisattva mahāsattva Maitreya, the bodhisattva Full of Wonder, the bodhisattva Ratnapāṇi, the bodhisattva Ratnaśrī, the bodhisattva Guṇarājaprabhāsa, the bodhisattva Puṇyālaṃkāra, the bodhisattva Apāyajaha, the bodhisattva Dharmarāja, the venerable Śāriputra, the venerable Mahākāśyapa, the venerable Ānanda, Brahmā lord of the Sahā world, Śakra lord of the gods, the Four Great Kings, those monks, those bodhisattvas, that entire assembly, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the Great Vehicle sūtra called The Noble Request of Gaganagañja, from the chapters of the Great Assembly.

It was translated by the Indian preceptors Vijayaśīla and Śīlendrabodhi and the chief editor-translator, the monk Yeshé Dé, and was then revised and finalized according to the new standard language.

Translator's Notes

• The phrase rendered "gave entry to what is not of its own nature" (de'i rang bzhin ma yin pa la 'jug pa) is terse and its sense is uncertain. In "the Tathāgata Ratnavyūha," the Tibetan reads "rin po che bkod pa gcig pa," which might instead indicate a name such as "Single Jewel Array"; the gcig pa has been taken loosely. The bodhisattva names Lightning God, Victorious in Battle, Valiant Subduer, Far-Proclaimed, Eye of Clear Seeing and Free of Darkness could not be identified with confidence and are translated by meaning. "Rebirth-linking" renders mtshams sbyor (pratisaṃdhi).
• The tathāgata's name, here given as "rin po che bkod pa gcig pa," is explained by the text itself: in that world no jewel arises other than the jewel of the awakening mind; hence "Ratnavyūha" is followed by the gloss "the One Jewel Array." Where Śāriputra says "even if my lifespan were to last an eon," the Tibetan reads bas par, evidently a slip for bskal par, as in the bodhisattvas' parallel statement just before. The list announced as thirty-two aspects contains thirty-three clauses as the Tibetan stands; all are translated. The closing attainment ("the acceptance regarding consciousness that holds mastery over all phenomena") is terse and may name a specific kṣānti; its exact sense is uncertain.
• The flower names in the long list are rendered by their meaning; most cannot be confidently matched to Sanskrit names. "Sthala" is kept as transliterated in the Tibetan (perhaps for sthalapadma or a similar flower); "sorrow-dispelling" may stand for aśoka and "nāga flower" for nāgapuṣpa. "Great white fragrance" renders □□□□□□□□□□□ as a flower name, not in its tantric sense. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "giving explanations to whomever he meets"; the sense is somewhat uncertain.
• In the third stanza □□□□□□ is taken as a vocative epithet of the Buddha, "Kind One," not the name Maitreya. In the seventh stanza the sense of □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is uncertain; it is rendered

"never the same through the eons." Several lines of the verse praise are terse and paradoxical, and the rendering of the seventeenth and eighteenth stanzas, where the syntax runs on from one stanza into the next, is interpretive.

• "Fame" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□, which ordinarily means "verse"; here it evidently translates Sanskrit śloka in its other sense of "renown," listed beside gain and honor. The name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is given as Guṇarājaprabhāsa, a reconstruction from the Tibetan.

• "The One Whose Deeds Are Meaningful" renders □□□□□□□□□□□, taken here as an epithet of the Buddha (perhaps Amoghakarman). "The Lord of Humans" renders the bare □□, "human," which in context seems to stand for the Buddha. In the eighth stanza □□□□□□□□□□□ is obscure and is rendered "minds that hold to nothing." "The recollection of the gods" is the sixth of the standard recollections (devānusmṛti).

• The name □□□□□□□□□□, "Lamp in Hand," is given as Pradīpapāṇi; the Sanskrit is a reconstruction. "Cut off the boundary" renders □□□□□□□□, apparently referring to the decisive entry into the bodhisattva's fixed course (niyāma).

• "Not entering into every kind of birth" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally; the sense is likely that a pure aspiration keeps the bodhisattva from being driven into births by compulsion, but the wording is terse. In the closing verses, □□□□□□□□□□□□ (here "a mind of mere explanation") and □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (here "carry their conduct through to the end") are obscure and the renderings are tentative. □□□□□□□□□□□□ in the list of eight is taken in its ordinary sense of "being an authority, trustworthy," not as the epistemological term.

• In the verses, □□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as "bearing whatever comes" (□□□□□ in its sense "to bear, carry"), matching the image of the earth that bears all things, rather than as "whatever vehicle." The opening line marks the start of the second bampo (section) of the sūtra.

• □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, contrasted with the "diligence of application," is rendered "diligence of complete severance"; the text defines it as having no taking up, no casting off and no abiding, and as following the sphere of reality, so the sense is diligence that has cut off all effortful grasping. In the list of eight, the clause on awakening ("they examine awakening as having the characteristic of a thing, and so they do not perceive it") follows the Tibetan literally; the point is presumably that awakening examined as a thing is not found. □□□□□□□ is the plantain (banana) tree, a standard image of something without core.

• □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered "the mind of certain understanding," matching the earlier "patience of certain understanding of phenomena." In the list describing it, □□□□□□□ / □□□□□□ appear twice; they are rendered first as "adding and taking away" and then as "increase and decrease" to reflect the repetition.

• □□□ in the long list is rendered "a term for," taking it in the sense of Sanskrit pada (word, designation, state). Several items are compressed: "full understanding, because of the suffering of imagination" presumably means that wisdom fully understands the suffering produced by imagination, paralleling the four truths that follow (abandoning the origin, cessation, cultivation of the path). The passage ends with the announcement of verses that begin in the next piece.

• "Works upon the root of the obscurations" renders □□□□□ as written; the sense is presumably that wisdom penetrates or deals with the root of the obscurations. "The unfailing stride" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, likely reflecting Sanskrit amoghavikrama, the purposeful, unfailing gait of a buddha. "Unbarred offering sacrifice" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (Skt. nirargala yajña), the great open sacrifice of giving without restriction.

• "Sanctioned by the Buddha" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, probably reflecting Sanskrit buddhānujñāta, the form of each recollection that the Buddha approves. "Without any basis" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□, here in its non-technical sense (Skt. probably anālaya, "without a dwelling or clinging place"), not the Yogācāra storehouse consciousness.

• The name of the gateway of primordial wisdom, □□□□□□□□□□□, is obscure; it is rendered literally as "the Paired Measure," apparently referring to the bodhisattva holding together equality with nirvāṇa and active conduct. "Manifest blessing" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ as written; a reading □□□□□□□□ ("former blessing") is possible but not certain. "The great compassion he resolved upon in the past" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, understood as compassion established by former vows.
• "Relying conventionally on the understanding of others" renders □□□, which seems to mean that the Buddha's awakening is spoken of conventionally, in terms others can understand, while its nature is inexpressible. "Does not destroy any entity" renders □□□□□□□□□□□, literally "does not waste or ruin."
• "The view of the perishable collection" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (Skt. satkāyadṛṣṭi), the view of the aggregates as a self. "Its domain is the domainless" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□.
• The list of terms for a self (bdag, sems can, srog, gso ba, skyes bu, gang zag, shed las skyes, shed bu) follows the standard series ātman, sattva, jīva, poṣa, puruṣa, pudgala, manuja, mānava; "one born of Manu" and "son of Manu" render the last two. The phrase "what is not an object and yet functions as an object" (yul ma yin zhing yul byed pa) is rendered as written; it is somewhat obscure and may imply that the ultimate, while not itself an object, is that in which objects are posited.
• "It is the realm of the self, because it is pure from the very beginning" renders bdag gi dbyings as written; in this list of negations one might expect "the realm of selflessness," but the reading is kept, consistent with the earlier statement in this sūtra that the self is pure from the very beginning.
• Although twelve unbreakable things are announced, the list as it stands can be counted in more ways than one; it is translated as given. "Through the purity of his own field" renders rang gi zhing as written, where the surrounding discussion speaks of his own domain (yul).
• The "six things that bring about mutual affection" (yang dag par chags par 'gyur ba drug) are the six sāraṇīya dharmas. "Accounts of the past" renders sngon byung ba, probably the itivṛttaka genre.
• "Fame" renders tshigs su bcad pa, which normally means "verse"; here it evidently reflects Sanskrit śloka in its sense of renown, paired with gain and honor. "Free of base speech" renders tha ba med pa, whose precise sense in this list of right speech is uncertain. As in earlier lists, the items announced as "twelve" can be counted in more than one way; the list is translated as given.
• "As to wisdom, disparaging those of inferior qualities" renders the compressed phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□; it could also mean disparaging inferior teachings. In the list of things not suppressed, □□□□□ is rendered "fetters" tentatively, between the obscurations (nīvaraṇa) and the outbursts of affliction (paryavasthāna). Here □□□□□□□□□ is the verb "not dreading," not the world-name Sahā, and □□□□□□□□□ is "the ten powers," not the epithet.
• In the Saṅgha verse, the line literally reads "empty, signless, aspiration, liberated"; it is taken as the three doors of liberation, with □□□□□□□ standing in the verse for wishlessness (apraṇihita). In the verse on purity, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as "in order to set beings free"; the sense of □□□ here is not certain.
• The second line of the first verse (□□□) is compressed; it is read as saying that the bodhisattva neither holds back the Dharma nor fails to pour it out, which leads into the rain simile, but the exact sense is uncertain. The name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be matched with confidence to a Sanskrit form (perhaps Āśupratibhāna or Kṣiprapratibhāna), so it is translated as "Swift Eloquence."
• The names of the bodhisattvas □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□□□ could

not be matched with confidence to Sanskrit forms (perhaps Kālarāja, Vaidyarāja, and Apāyajaha), so they are translated by meaning, as is the lotus called □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□. Many of the gem names are poetic names of uncertain identity and are translated by meaning. The item □□□□□□□□□□□ in the list of gifts is uncertain and is rendered "small retinues."

• The bodhisattva names □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be matched with confidence to Sanskrit forms, so they are translated by meaning ("Ornament of Moral Discipline," "Universal Light"). The future buddhas' name □□□□□□□□□□ is given as Sudānta with its meaning.

• The names of the future tathāgata (Bestower of Fearlessness, perhaps Sanskrit Abhayaṃdada), the past tathāgata (King Exalted in Jewel Splendor Who Has Far Surpassed All Aspirations), the world system (Displaying All Buddhafields), and the universal monarch (Consecrated by All the Gods, perhaps Sarvadevābhiṣikta) are translated into English because their Sanskrit forms cannot be confirmed with confidence.

• The attainment of the ten thousand bodhisattvas could also be read as "the acceptance of inexhaustible wealth, of jewels in hand, and of fulfilling Gaganagañja's aspiration"; the grammar of the list is ambiguous. In the verse line "without arising and without taming," the word for "taming" is odd in context and may be a scribal variant, but it is translated as written.

• The name of the bodhisattva rendered "Full of Wonder" could not be confidently matched to a Sanskrit form and is translated from its meaning; his following remark plays on the name, literally "I am taking it as a spectacle."

• The names of the samādhis are translated from their meanings, except Vairocana and Padmavyūha. The last samādhi's name is spelled "not smiling" in the Tibetan; it is read as "unflinching," a similar-sounding word that fits the context. "Brings all theses under one's command" could also be read as "brings all commitments under one's command."

• The samādhi names are translated from their meanings, except Ratnavyūha. The Tibetan gives the totals as stated (forty thousand, then eighty thousand, then eighty-four thousand); the translation follows it without adjusting the arithmetic.

• The buddha's name, the world system "Girdle" and the grove "Array of Joy" are translated from their Tibetan meaning, since their Sanskrit forms could not be identified with confidence. The number □□□□□□□□ is rendered "trillion" by convention; its exact value varies across numeration lists. The phrase about dharmas "witnessed directly with one's own body and not left to the authority of others" reflects the stock notions of bodily witness (kāyasākṣin) and independence from others (aparapratyaya).

• In the boys' first verses, "king of healers" and "Stainless Light" are taken as two epithets of one eastern buddha from whose presence the boys came; the Tibetan could also be read as naming a buddha Bhaiṣajyarāja beside the Sugata Stainless Light. The Sanskrit of "Stainless Light" is not certain, so it is translated. The verse introducing the boys' praise uses a singular "that noble one" although both boys take hold of the Buddha's feet; this is kept as written.

• In the gods' cry, the Tibetan has an unclear syllable pair (□□□) before "as soon as this one set his mind"; it is read as part of the exclamation and not translated separately. The gods' words "will become a sky treasury" (gaganagañja) explain the origin of the bodhisattva's name. Krakucchanda is the standard Sanskrit for the Tibetan name of this buddha.

• In the section on giving in relation to consciousness, the Tibetan says the suchness of all phenomena "is suchness," whereas each of the other parallel sections says it "is not a suchness"; the text is translated as it stands in each place.

• In the last line of the section on mindfulness of phenomena, the Tibetan reads □□□□□□□ ("restrains"), which does not fit; it is translated as □□□□□□□ ("cultivates"), as in every parallel line. The abbreviated instruction "up to the giving of gifts" after the other four aggregates is kept as written, although the section concerns mindfulness of the body.

• The sentence "Because the mind is never daunted by anything, it is the armor of attaining the fearlessnesses" occurs twice in succession in the Tibetan, most likely a dittography; it is translated as it stands. The verb read as "gathering" (□□□□□□□□) is evidently a slip for □□□□□□□ / □□□□□□□, "accumulating," which the context requires.
• The clause rendered "since it does not let former vows sink out of sight" (□□□□□□□□

rab rgyal po, Sumerurāja), and Master of Illusion (mig 'phrul can). Gandhahastin renders spos kyi glang po'i bal glang, whose final element (a further word for elephant) is absorbed into the name. Ratnodgata, Ratnacitta, Ratnākara, Priyadarśana and Guṇarājaprabhāsa are standard reconstructions.

• The names of the four gods who serve the bodhisattva (tshogs bral ldan, dga' tshogs ldan, spos can, khang bzangs can) could not be identified with confidence and are translated by meaning. Durmukha renders bzhin mi sdug pa ("Ugly Face"), the name of a son of Māra known from other sūtras. "Cognition" renders rnam par rig pa (vijñapti), the conceptual communication that letters and words convey.

• The names of the future tathāgatas, eon, and world system are translated by meaning, since their Sanskrit forms could not be identified with confidence: Infinite Stainless Crest (mtha' yas dri ma med pa'i tog), Attainer of the Light of the Well-Abiding Dharma (shin tu gnas pa'i chos snang ba thob), the eon Purification (rnam par sbyong ba), and the world system Completely Pure Abiding (yongs su dag par gnas pa).

• Śrīgupta's account refers to the well-known story of the householder who tried to kill the Buddha with a fire pit and poisoned food; "filled the way with fire" renders shul zhugs kyis gtams par bgyis. The three kinds of beings are the traditional udghaṭitajña, vipañcitajña, and padaparama.

• The names of the future tathāgata and his eon are translated by meaning: Dispeller of All Outbursts (kun nas ldang ba thams cad rnam par sel ba) and Utterly Stainless (shin tu dri ma med pa). "The view of the transitory collection" renders 'jig tshogs (satkāya), the view of a real self in the aggregates.

• The verse beginning "When we abide in these dharmas" is syntactically ambiguous; the quoted words may instead be the speakers' own humble disclaimer. "Thirty thousand world systems" renders stong sum cu as written; it may stand for the usual "trichiliocosm" (stong gsum). The four large numbers (dkrigs pa, gtams pa, khyad phyin, mi 'khrugs pa) are names of high powers in the Indian numeral series; they are rendered by their literal meanings, since their exact Sanskrit equivalents and values are not certain. "Unrestricted sacrificial offerings" renders gtan pa med pa'i mchod sbyin (Skt. nirargaḍa yajña, an open sacrifice from which no one is barred).

• Kauśika is a clan name by which the Buddha addresses Śakra. "Even if they are angry and abusive, we shall accept it" leaves the angry party unstated in the Tibetan; it most naturally refers to the Dharma preachers or their audience.

• "The Great Assembly" renders 'dus pa chen po, i.e. the Mahāsaṃnipāta collection of which this sūtra forms a chapter. "In which all wandering is cut off" renders rgyu ba chad pa somewhat tentatively; it may mean the cessation of the mind's discursive movement.

• Guṇarājaprabhāsa and Apāyajaha are reconstructions of the Tibetan names Yönten Gyalpö Ö ("Light of the King of Qualities") and Ngensong Pongwa ("Abandoner of the Lower Realms"); they are the likely Sanskrit forms but not attested here. "Acceptance" renders bzod pa, here most likely acceptance (kṣānti) of the unborn nature of phenomena.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the

Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.